

Streams in the Desert 2

by L B Cowman

荒漠甘泉下

考門夫人著

July 1

My words ... will come true at their proper time. (Luke 1:20)

What the Lord has said ... will be accomplished! (Luke 1:45)

The Lord is sure to accomplish those things
A loving heart has waited long to see;
Those words will be fulfilled to which she clings,
Because her God has promised faithfully;
And, knowing Him, she ne'er can doubt His Word;
He speaks and it is done. The mighty Lord!

Bessie Porter

Matthew Henry said, "We can depend on God to fulfill His promise, even when all the roads leading to it are closed. 'For no matter how many promises God has made, they are "Yes" in Christ. And so through Him the "Amen" [so be it] is spoken by us to the glory of God' [2 Cor. 1:20]."

July 2

When you walk, your steps will not be hampered; when you run, you will not stumble. (Proverbs 4:12)

The Lord only builds a bridge of faith directly under the feet of a faithful traveler. He never builds the bridge a few steps ahead, for then it would not be one of faith. "We live by faith, not by sight" (2 Cor. 5:7).

Whether the barrier is a river, a mountain, or a gate, all a child of Jesus must do is head directly toward it. If it is a river, it will dry up as he comes near it, as long as he still forges ahead. If it is a mountain, it will be removed and "cast into the sea" (Mark 11:23 KJV), providing he approaches it with unflinching confidence.

Henry Clay Trumbull

We sit and weep in vain, while the voice of the Almighty tells us to never stop moving upward and onward. Let us advance boldly, whether it is dark and we can barely see the forest in front of us, or our road leads us through the mountain pass, where from any vantage point we can only see a few steps ahead.

God will provide guides and inns along the road, and we will discover food, clothing, and friends at every stage of our journey. And as Samuel Rutherford,

七月一日

「到了時候，這話必然應驗。」(路 1:20)

「主.....所說的話，都要應驗。」(路 1:45)

主必然會作成那些愛慕之心長久期望得見之事。

她所繫掛的話語必得成就，
皆因是她的神信實的應許。
認識祂的她從不懷疑祂的話，
說了便成就的祂，大能的主！

比西·波特

馬太·亨利說過：「我們可靠賴神來成就祂的應許，那怕所有引往之路都是閉塞不通。『神的應許，不論有多少，在基督都是是的，所以藉着祂也都是阿們的，叫神因我們得榮耀。』(林後1:20)」

七月二日

「你行走，腳步必不致狹窄。你奔跑，也不致跌倒。」(箴4:12)

主只會在信的旅者足下建築那信的橋樑。祂永不會在前面幾步來建造，否則這就不會是信的橋樑了。「因我們行事為人，是憑着信心，不是憑着眼見。」(林後5:7)

無論阻隔是河流、大山、或是閘門，所有耶穌的兒女定必要作的是向前行。這若是河流，當他走近時河流會乾枯，只要他仍然勇往直前。這若是大山，它必會被移去和「投在海裏」(可11:23)，只要他以不畏縮的信心向山走去。

亨利·奇里·湛布

當全能者是告訴我們不要停止前行上行時，那麼我們坐下哭泣便是枉然。讓我們勇往直前，那怕在黑暗中只能僅見前面的森林，那怕前路引領我們在山嶺間穿行，並且我們只能觀察到前行的幾步。

神必在沿路上提供引導和住宿，我們必能在旅途的每個階段發現食物、衣着和朋友。正如偉大的

the great Scottish minister, once stated so simply, "Whatever happens, the worst will only be a weary traveler receiving a joyful and heavenly welcome home."

selected

July 3

When a farmer plows for planting, does he plow continually? (Isaiah 28:24)

Oh, if only we would always catch the vision of the abundant harvest when the great Master Farmer comes, as He often does, to plow through our very souls—uprooting and turning under that which we thought most beautiful and leaving only the bare and the unlovely before our agonizing eyes.

selected

Why should I be frightened and surprised by the plow of the Lord, which makes deep furrows in my soul? I know He is not some arbitrary or irrational farmer—His purpose is to yield a harvest.

Samuel Rutherford

July 4

The revelation awaits an appointed time....Though it linger, wait for it; it will certainly come and will not delay. (Habakkuk 2:3)

In the captivating booklet *Expectation Corner*, one of the characters, Adam Slowman, was led into the Lord's treasure-house. Among the many wonders revealed to him there was the "Delayed Blessing Office," where God stored the answers to certain prayers until it was wise to send them.

For some who pray expecting an answer, it takes a long time to learn that delays of answers are not denials. In fact, in the "Delayed Blessing Office," there are deep secrets of love and wisdom that we have never imagined! We tend to want to pick our blessings from the tree while they are still green, yet God wants us to wait until they are fully ripe.

"The Lord longs to be gracious to you....Blessed are all who wait for him!" (Isa. 30:18). The Lord watches over us in all the difficult places, and He will not allow even one trial that is too much for us. He will use His refining fire to burn away our impurities and will then gloriously come to our rescue.

selected

蘇格蘭傳道者撒母耳·魯特福有一次曾簡明的說：「無論發生何事，最壞的情況不過是疲倦的旅者獲得一個喜樂返天家的盛大歡迎。」

選

七月三日

「那耕地為要撒種的，豈是常常耕地呢？」（賽28:24）

噢，在偉大的農夫主人來到翻犁我們靈魂時，就是祂經常作的，願我們能得見那豐盛收割的異象。祂將我們以為最美的連根拔起和翻動，在我們痛苦的眼睛留下的只有荒蕪和不可愛。

選

我何需為着我生命中帶來深深犁溝主的耙耕而恐懼和驚奇？我知祂不是那些專橫和無理取鬧的農夫，祂的目的是要有所收成。

撒母耳·路德福

七月四日

「因為這默示有一定的日期.....雖然遲延，還要等候，因為必然臨到，不再遲延。」（哈2:3）

引人入勝小書《期望角落》的主角亞當·史路文被領到主的藏寶屋，在眾多向他彰顯的奇事中有一個「延遲祝福辦公室」，神在那兒貯存了一些禱告，要等至送出的最佳時機之時才作回應。

祈望禱告蒙垂聽的人要長時間才學會延遲垂聽並非拒絕。事實上，「延遲祝福辦公室」中有的是愛和智慧的極深秘密，是我們從未想過的！我們傾向在我們的祝福在樹上還是青綠時便去摘取，然而神想我們等待到他們完全成熟時。

「耶和華必然等候.....凡等候祂的，都是有福的。」（賽30:18）神關顧我們所有的難處，祂永不容許過分的試煉臨到我們，一個也不會。祂用煉淨的火燒掉我們的雜質，必會昂然來作我們的拯救。

選

July 5

I am now going to allure her; I will lead her into the desert....There I will give her back her vineyards. (Hosea 2:14-15)

The desert is certainly a strange place to find vineyards! “I ... will make the Valley of Achor a door of hope. There she will sing as in the days of her youth.” “Achor” means “troubled,” yet the Valley of Achor is called “a door of hope.”

God knows our need for a desert experience. He knows exactly where and how to produce enduring qualities in us. The person who has been idolatrous, has been rebellious, has forgotten God, and has said with total self-will, “I will go after my lovers” (Hos. 2:5), will find her path blocked by God. “She will chase after her lovers but not catch them; she will look for them but not find them” (Hos. 2:7). And once she feels totally hopeless and abandoned, God will say, “I am now going to allure her; I will lead her into the desert and speak tenderly to her.”

What a loving God we have!

from Crumbs

We never know where God has hidden His streams. We see a large stone and have no idea that it covers the source of a spring. We see a rocky area and never imagine that it is hiding a fountain. God leads me into hard and difficult places, and it is there I realize I am where eternal streams abide.

selected

July 6

We do not know what to do, but our eyes are upon you. (2 Chronicles 20:12)

An Israelite named Uzzah lost his life because he “reached out and took hold of the ark of God” (2 Sam. 6:6). He placed his hand on it with the best of intentions—to steady it, “because the oxen stumbled” (2 Sam. 6:6)—but nevertheless, he had overstepped his bounds by touching the Lord’s work, and “therefore God struck him down” (2 Sam. 6:7). Living a life of faith often requires us to leave things alone.

If we have completely entrusted something to God, we must keep our hands off it. He can guard it better than we can, and He does not need our help. “Be still before the Lord and wait patiently for him; do

七月五日

「後來我必勸導她，領她到曠野.....我必賜她葡萄園。」（何 2:14-15）

曠野肯定找不着葡萄園！「又賜她亞割谷作為指望的門，她必在那裏歌唱，與幼年的日子一樣。」亞割的意思是麻煩，然而亞割谷被稱為「希望之門」。

神知我們在曠野經歷上的需要，祂正正知道在那裏和怎樣在我們裏頭產生堅忍的素質。拜偶像、背叛和忘記神以完全己意來說「我要隨從所愛的」（何 2:5）的人必發現她的道路被神阻隔。「她必追隨所愛的，卻追不上，她必尋找他們，卻尋不見。」（何 2:7）她一旦感到完全無望和被撇棄時，神便會說：「後來我必勸導她，領她到曠野，對她說安慰的話。」

我們有的是何等慈愛的神！

摘自《碎渣兒》

我們從不知神在那裏藏起祂的甘泉。我們看見的是大石，全不知它蓋在泉源上；所見的是嶙峋之地，永想不到埋藏在下面的活泉。神領我到艱苦之地，身在那裏時我才明白到永恆的甘泉就在那兒。

選

七月六日

「我們也不知道怎樣行，我們的眼目單仰望祢。」（代下 20:12）

以色列人烏撒失去性命是因他「伸手扶住神的約櫃」（撒下 6:6）。他向約櫃伸手出於好意，要托住它，「因為牛失前蹄」（撒下 6:6）。無論如何他因觸動神之工而越界，「神.....因這錯誤擊殺他」（撒下 6:7）。活出信心生活常需要我們在事情上放手。

我們若將某事完全交託神後，定須撒手。祂比我們更能保存它，祂也不需我們的幫助。「你當默然倚靠耶和華，耐性等候祂。不

not fret when men succeed in their ways, when they carry out their wicked schemes” (Ps. 37:7).

Things in our lives may seem to be going all wrong, but God knows our circumstances better than we do. And He will work at the perfect moment, if we will completely trust Him to work in His own way and in His own time. Often there is nothing as godly as inactivity on our part, or nothing as harmful as restless working, for God has promised to work His sovereign will.

A. B. Simpson

July 7

He made me into a polished arrow. (Isaiah 49:2)

Pebble Beach, on the California coast, has become quite famous for the beautiful pebbles found there. These stones are trapped in the arms of the merciless waves day and night. They are tossed, rolled, rubbed together, and ground against the sharp edges of the cliffs. Tourists from around the world flock there to collect the beautiful round stones. They display them in cabinets and use them to decorate their homes.

Yet a little farther up the coast, just around the point of the cliff, the quietness and peace have left the stones as they have always been—rough, unpolished, and devoid of beauty—for polish is the result of difficulties.

Since God knows what niche we are to fill, let us trust Him to shape us to it. And since He knows what work we are to do, let us trust Him to grind us so we will be properly prepared.

Nearly all of God’s jewels are crystallized tears.

July 8

They will soar on wings like eagles. (Isaiah 40:31)

We are the wingless birds, and our duties and tasks are the wings God uses to lift us up and carry us heavenward. We look at our burdens and heavy loads, and try to run from them, but if we will carry them and tie them to our hearts, they will become wings. And on them we can then rise and soar toward God.

There is no burden so heavy that when lifted cheerfully with love in our hearts will not become a

要因那道路通達的，和那惡謀成就的，心懷不平。」(詩37:7)

我們生命上也許凡事都出錯，但神比我們更清楚知道我們的處境。祂必會在完美一刻來作工，只要我們完全信靠祂，以祂的方法和按祂的時間來作工。沒有像我們方面的不動更虔誠，也沒有像我們不休止地工作更損害，因為神曾應許按祂至高的旨意來作工的。

宣信

七月七日

「祂……使我成為磨亮的箭。」(賽49:2)

在加州海岸的卵石沙灘因那兒的美麗卵石而頗具盛名。這些石頭日以繼夜地被困在無情浪花的膀臂中，他們被顛簸，翻滾，一起沖擦，撞向崖石的尖邊。來自世界各地的遊客蜂擁而至，在那裏收集美麗的圓形卵石，他們把卵石放在櫃中展覽，或放在家中作為裝飾。

然而在岸上不遠處，就在山崖的轉角處，寧靜和與世無爭叫卵石永遠是那樣粗糙、未被磨光和缺乏美麗，因為困難帶來的果效就是磨光。

既然神知我們該填補甚麼處境，就讓我們信靠祂模造我們。祂既知我們該作何工，就讓我們信靠祂來跟磨我們來裝備整齊。

幾乎所有神的珠寶都是淚的結晶。

七月八日

「他們必如鷹展翅上騰。」(賽40:31)

我們都是無翼的鳥兒，職責和工作是用神給的翅膀乘起我們往天而去。我們眼望負擔和重壓，嘗試逃離他們；若背負他們，把他們繫在心中，他們便成為翅膀，乘着他們便起來飛往神那處去。

沒有一個重擔重至我們歡欣地用心提起時是不變成祝福的。神

blessing to us. God intends for our task to be our helpers; to refuse to bend our shoulders to carry a load is to miss a new opportunity for growth.

J. R. Miller

No matter how overwhelming, any burden God has lovingly placed with His own hands on our shoulders is a blessing.

Frederick William Faber

July 9

I have chosen thee in the furnace of affliction. (Isaiah 48:10 KJV)

Doesn't God's Word come to us like a soft rain shower, dispelling the fury of the flames? Isn't it like fireproof armor, against which the heat is powerless? Then let afflictions come, for God has chosen me. Poverty, you may walk through my door, but God is already in my house, and He has chosen me. Sickness, you may intrude into my life, but I have a cure standing ready—God has chosen me. Whatever occurs in the valley of tears, I know He has chosen me.

“Do not be afraid, for I am with you” (Gen. 26:24) is His unfailing word of promise to His chosen ones who are experiencing “the furnace of affliction.”

Charles H. Spurgeon

The burden of suffering seems to be a tombstone hung around our necks. Yet in reality it is simply the weight necessary to hold the diver down while he is searching for pearls.

Julius Richter

July 10

I called him but he did not answer. (Song of Songs 5:6)

Once the Lord has given us great faith, He has been known to test it with long delays. He has allowed His servants' voices to echo in their ears, as if their prayers were rebounding from a contemptuous sky. Believers have knocked at the heavenly gate, but it has remained immovable, as though its hinges had rusted. And like Jeremiah, they have cried, “You have covered yourself with a cloud so that no prayer can get through” (Lam. 3:44).

True saints of God have endured lengthy times of

本意叫我們的工作成為我們的幫助，那麼拒絕彎下我們的肩膊來背負重擔就是錯過成長的新機會了。

J.R.米勒

任何重擔無論如何難以忍受，只要是神親手慈憐地放在我們肩頭上的，必會是一個祝福。

弗雷德里克·威廉·費柏

七月九日

「你在苦難的爐中，我揀選你。」
(賽48:10)

神的話臨到我們豈不像輕柔撲滅烈火狂怒的雨露？它豈不像火也無能為力的防火盔甲？神既選上我，就讓苦痛來到吧。貧窮你可走過我的門口，但神早已在我屋裏，祂已選上我。疾病你可侵入我的生命，但療藥早備在手，神已選上我。無論在流淚谷發生任何事，我知祂已選上我。

「不要懼怕，因為我與你同在。」(創26:24)是祂向祂選上那些經歷着「火窯之痛苦」之人的可靠應許說話。

司布真

痛苦的重擔似乎是圈掛在我們頸項上的墓碑，但事實上正正是需要那重物來叫潛水員往水底去尋找珍珠。

朱利士·力住他

七月十日

「我呼叫祂，祂卻不回答。」(歌5:6)

主一旦給了我們大信心，祂也以長久的延遲來試驗這信心而見稱。祂容許祂僕人的聲音在他們耳中迴盪，如同他們的祈禱從那輕蔑的上天彈回一樣。信徒已敲叩天門，但它依然不動聲息，如同門鉸已生了鏽般。他們如同耶利米般大呼：「你以黑雲遮蔽自己，以致禱告不得透入。」(哀3:44)

神的真實聖徒忍受長期的忍

patient waiting with no reply, not because their prayers were prayed without intensity, nor because God did not accept their pleas. They were required to wait because it pleased Him who is sovereign and who gives “according to his good purpose” (Phil. 2:13). And if it pleases Him to cause our patience to be exercised, should He not do as He desires with His own?

No prayer is ever lost, or any prayer ever breathed in vain. There is no such thing as prayer unanswered or unnoticed by God, and some things we see as refusals or denials are simply delays.

Horatius Bonar

July 11

Some time later the brook dried up because there had been no rain in the land. (1 Kings 17:7)

Elijah’s brook became completely dry. And only then, to Elijah’s patient and faithful spirit, did the word of the Lord come and say, “Go at once to Zarephath” (v. 9).

God will often extricate us from the mess we have made, because “his love endures forever” (1 Chron. 16:34). Yet if we had only been patient and waited to see the unfolding of His plan, we would never have found ourselves in such an impossible maze, seeing no way out. We would also never have had to turn back and retrace our way, with wasted steps and so many tears of shame.

“Wait for the Lord” (Ps. 27:14). Patiently wait!

F. B. Meyer

July 12

He knows the way that I take; when he has tested me, I will come forth as gold. (Job 23:10)

Faith grows during storms. Faith is that God-given ability that, when exercised, brings the unseen into plain view. It deals with the supernatural and makes impossible things possible. It grows through disturbances in the spiritual atmosphere. Storms are caused by conflicts between the physical elements, and the storms of the spiritual world are conflicts with supernatural, hostile elements. And it is in this atmosphere of conflict that faith finds its most fertile soil and grows most rapidly to maturity.

Remember, when you see a person of great

耐而得不着回應，不是因為他們的祈禱作得不夠感情，也不是因為神不接受他們的懇求。他們所需的等候是因着這能討那至高者且是賜恩者的喜悅，「為要成就祂的美意。」(腓2:13)若我們所生發的忍耐能討祂喜悅，那麼祂豈不更可按一己的想望而行事麼？

沒有祈禱會不知所踪，也沒有祈禱徒然呼出。沒有祈禱不得應允或不得神留意這回事，我們看為拒絕或否定的祈禱不過是延遲吧了。

可拉蒂斯·邦拿

七月十一日

「過了些日子，溪水就乾了，因為雨沒有下在地上。」(王上17:7)

以利亞的溪流完全乾枯了。只有到這時，神的話臨到，向以利亞忍耐和信實的靈說：「你起身往西頓的撒勒法去」(王上17:9)。

神常救我們脫離我們所造成的困境，因為「祂的慈愛永遠長存。」(代上16:34)只要我們忍耐等候來看神開展祂的計劃，我們便永不會把自己困在這不能逃脫的迷宮，不見出路。我們也永不需回頭，沿我們原路折回，枉廢了腳步和那麼多羞的眼淚。

「要等候耶和華。」(詩27:14)
當忍耐等候！

邁爾

七月十二日

「然而祂知道我所行的路。祂試煉我之後，我必如精金。」(伯23:10)

「信心是在風暴中增長的」。神所加力的信心運作起來時，將那些不可見的平白地顯露出來。信心專處理超自然的事，且使不可能的事情變成為可能。信是藉着屬靈氣氛困擾下來增長的。暴風是在物理因素的衝擊下而成的，而屬靈世界的風暴則是超自然和敵人因素的衝擊而成的。信心就在這衝擊的氛圍下找到肥沃的泥土來迅速長成。

謹記，當你見着一個屬靈偉人

spiritual stature, the road you must travel to walk with him is not one where the sun always shines and wildflowers always bloom. Instead, the way is a steep, rocky, and narrow path, where the winds of hell will try to knock you off your feet, and where sharp rocks will cut you, prickly thorns will scratch your face, and poisonous snakes will slither and hiss all around you.

The path of faith is one of sorrow and joy, suffering and healing comfort, tears and smiles, trials and victories, conflicts and triumphs, and also hardships, dangers, beatings, persecutions, misunderstanding, trouble, and distress. Yet “in all these things we are more than conquerors through him who loved us” (Rom. 8:37).

E. A. Kilbourne

July 13

God ... calls things that are not as though they were.
(Romans 4:17)

It is the very reason why “Abraham in hope believed” (v. 18). That Abraham would become the father of a child at his advanced age seemed absurd and an utter impossibility, yet God called him “the father of many nations” (Gen. 17:4) long before there was any indication of fulfillment. And Abraham thought of himself as a father, because God had said so. That is genuine faith—believing and declaring what God has said, stepping out on what appears to be thin air and finding solid rock beneath your feet.

from Crumbs

You must be like a young bird beginning to test the air with its untried wings. The fledgling may feel the same way, but it does not fall, for its wings provide support. Yet even if its wings do fail, one of its parents will sweep under it, rescuing it on strong wings.

God will rescue you in the same way. Simply trust Him, for His “right hand sustains” (Ps. 18:35). Do you find yourself asking, “But am I to step out onto nothing?” That is exactly what the bird is seemingly asked to do, yet we know that the air is there and that the air is not nearly as insubstantial as it seems. And you know that the promises of God are there, and they certainly are not insubstantial at all.

“Yes, I tell you” (Luke 12:5). Trust Him!

時，你須和他同行的不是陽光普照，花開常漫的路，而是陟斜、嶙峋和狹窄的路徑。地獄之風總試圖把你腳絆跌，尖石會割傷你，如針的荊棘會抓傷你面，毒蛇會在你四周爬行和發出嘶聲。

信心之路雖憂傷，也喜樂；受苦卻也帶來醫治的安慰；有流淚也有歡笑；有試煉也有得勝；有衝突也有勝利。且有艱難、危險、被打、迫害、誤會、困難和悲傷，「然而靠着愛我們的主，在這一切的事上，已經得勝有餘了。」(羅8:37)

E.A.翹邦

七月十三日

「使無變為有的神。」(羅4:17)

亞伯拉罕「因信仍有指望」(羅4:18)就是這原因。亞伯拉罕晚年才成為一個孩子的父親一事似乎荒誕和絕對不可能，然而神稱他為「多國之父」(創17:4)是久在有任何得成就的跡象之前。亞伯拉罕認為他自己就是一個父親，只因神是如此說。這是真的信心，相信和宣告神所曾說的，踏出走在看來虛無之上，卻發覺脚下是堅石來的。

摘自《碎渣兒》

你定須像雛鳥般開始用那未管用的翅膀來試飛。幼鳥也許有同樣的感覺，但牠是不會下跌的，因為牠的翅膀提供了支持。就算牠的翅膀不管用，其中一隻父母鳥必會伸展強翼在下承接來拯救牠。

神必以相同的方法拯救你。單單信靠祂，因祂的「右手扶持我」(詩18:35)。不要問「但我怎能向無物踏出一步？」，這正是那雛鳥似乎要問的，我們也知空氣在，空氣且絕不如看似的虛無。你也知道神的應許在，這些應許肯定絕不虛無。

「我實在告訴你們。」(路12:5) 當信靠祂！

July 14

Bind the festival sacrifice with cords to the horns of the altar. (Psalm 118:27 NASB)

There are times when life is full of promise and light, and we choose the cross; yet at other times, when the sky is gray, we run from it. Therefore it is wise to be bound to the altar.

selected

A man attended a tent revival meeting and tried to give himself to God. Every night at the altar, he would dedicate himself to the Lord. Yet as he left each evening, the Devil would come to him and convince him that since he did not feel changed, he was not truly redeemed.

Again and again he was defeated by the Adversary. Finally one evening he came to the meeting carrying an ax and a large wooden stake. After dedicating himself once more, he drove the stake into the ground where he had knelt to pray. As he was leaving the tent, the Devil came to him as usual, trying to make him believe that his commitment to God was not genuine. He quickly returned to the stake, pointed to it, and said, "Devil, do you see this stake? This is my witness that God has forever accepted me." Immediately the Devil left him, and he never experienced doubts again.

from The Still Small Voice

July 15

This is the victory that has overcome the world, even our faith. (1 John 5:4)

Trusting even when it appears you have been forsaken; praying when it seems your words are simply entering a vast expanse where no one hears and no voice answers; believing that God's love is complete and that He is aware of your circumstances, even when your world seems to grind on as if setting its own direction and not caring for life or moving one inch in response to your petitions; desiring only what God's hands have planned for you; waiting patiently while seemingly starving to death, with your only fear being that your faith might fail—"this is the victory that has overcome the world"; this is genuine faith indeed.

七月十四日

「理當用繩索把祭牲拴住，牽到壇角那裏。」（詩118:27）

當生命充滿應許和亮光時，我們會選擇十字架，但當天色灰暗時，我們卻背向十字架而逃跑。因此被拴在祭壇是明智之舉。

選

一個參加營幕復興會的男子說到他如何嘗試把自己獻身給神。每晚他到講台前來委身給主，然而每當他離開時，魔鬼總來到他處，說因着他感覺不到有改變，他便不是真的得救了。

他一次又一次被仇敵打敗。在最後一晚他帶着一柄斧頭和一條大木樁來到會場。他再一次獻上自己後，就在他跪下祈禱之處把木樁砍插在地。當他離開營幕時，魔鬼如常來到他那裏，試圖令他相信委身給神並不真誠。他速速回到樁柱那處，指向它說：「魔鬼，你見否那木樁？這就是神永遠接納我的證據。」魔鬼立刻離開他，他也不再懷疑了。

摘自《那溫柔的微聲》

七月十五日

「使我們勝了世界的，就是我們的信心。」（約壹5:4）

就算看起來你已被撇棄，祈禱就如同你的說話進入巨大穹蒼而沒有人聽見和沒有回應的聲音，你仍要信靠；就算當你的世界似乎像按它自定的方向來碾磨，不關心生命，也不因應你的代求而稍為讓步一寸時，仍要相信神的愛完全，祂察驗你的處境；只渴慕那些神手為你計劃好的；在似乎要餓死時仍忍耐等候，你唯一所要害怕的就是你的信心或者失效了。「使我們勝了世界的，就是我們的信心」，這實在是真的信心。

July 16

Because you have done this and have not withheld your son, your only son, I will ... make your descendants as numerous as the stars in the sky ... because you have obeyed me. (Genesis 22:16-18)

From the time of Abraham, people have been learning that when they obey God's voice and surrender to Him whatever they hold most precious, He multiplies it thousands of times. Abraham gave up his one and only son at the Lord's command, and in doing so, all his desires and dreams for Isaac's life, as well as his own hope for a notable heritage, disappeared. Yet God restored Isaac to his father, and Abraham's family became "as numerous as the stars in the sky and as the sand on the seashore" (v. 17). And through his descendants, "when the time had fully come, God sent his Son" (Gal. 4:4).

We surrender all our cherished hopes and die to self—then He sends overflowing joy and His "life ... that [we] might have it more abundantly" (John 10:10 KJV).

The greatest gift of all was Jesus Christ Himself.

Charles Gallaudet Trumbull

We sometimes seem to forget that what God takes from us, He takes with fire, and that the only road to a life of resurrection and ascension power leads us first to Gethsemane, the cross, and the tomb.

"After waiting patiently, Abraham received what was promised." (Heb. 6:15)

Indeed, there is nothing God will not do for those who will dare to step out in faith onto what appears to be only a mist. As they take their first step, they will find a rock beneath their feet.

F. B. Meyer

July 17

I will remain quiet and will look on from my dwelling place. (Isaiah 18:4)

Assyria is marching against Ethiopia, whose people are described as "tall and smooth-skinned" (v. 2). As the army advances, God makes no effort to stop them, and it appears as though they will be allowed

七月十六日

「你既行了這事，不留下你的兒子，就是你獨生的兒子，.....我必叫你的子孫多起來，如同天上的星，.....因為你聽從了我的話。」
(創22:16-18)

自亞伯拉罕起，人學會當遵從神的聲音，將無論甚麼他們看為最寶貴的交給神時，祂必加增他們千倍。亞伯拉罕照神的吩咐放棄他的獨生子，他這樣作是叫他在以撒生命上的渴望和夢想，並他一己期望以撒要得的顯赫繼承權都全歸泡影。但神把以撒復歸他的父親，因而亞伯拉罕的「子孫多起來，如同天上的星，海邊的沙」(創22:17)。且藉這後裔，「及至時候滿足，神就差遣祂的兒子。」(加4:4)

我們放下所有我們珍愛的希望和死己時，之後祂便送來滿溢的喜樂和得祂「更豐盛的生命。」(約10:10)

最大的恩賜是耶穌基督自己。

查理士·哥洛地·湛布

我們有時似乎忘記了神取走了我們甚麼東西了。神是用火來取的，這也是通往永遠生命和引領我們先來到客西馬尼，經過十字架和來到墳墓的唯一通道。

「亞伯拉罕既恆久忍耐，就得了所應許的。」(來6:15)

對於那些放膽往看似只得霧靄而踏出一步的人，沒有東西神不會為他們作。當他們走出第一步時，必會發現足下的是石地呢。

邁爾

七月十七日

「我要安靜，在我的居所觀看。」
(賽18:4)

被描述為「高大光滑的民」(賽18:2)的亞述大軍壓境古實。當軍隊前進時神沒有加以阻止，看來他們被容許為所欲為。神是從祂的

to do as they wish. The Lord is watching from His “dwelling place”, “before the harvest” (v. 5) the entire proud army is defeated as easily as new growth is pruned from a vine.

His silence is not to be confused with passive agreement or consent. He is simply biding His time and will arise at the most opportune moment, just when the plans of the wicked are on the verge of success, in order to overwhelm the enemy with disaster. And as we see the evil of this world, as we watch the apparent success of wrongdoers, and as we suffer the oppression of those who hate us, let us remember those miraculous words of God—“I will remain quiet and will look on.”

Yes, God does have another point of view, and there is wisdom behind His words. Why did Jesus watch His disciples straining at the oars through the stormy night? Why did He, though unseen by others, watch the sequence of anguishing events unfold in Bethany as Lazarus slowly passed through the stages of his terminal illness, succumbed to death, and was finally buried in a rocky tomb? Jesus was simply waiting for the perfect moment when He could intercede most effectively.

from Daily Devotional Commentary

July 18

The eyes of the Lord range throughout the earth to strengthen those whose hearts are fully committed to him. (2 Chronicles 16:9)

And not only is the world waiting but God Himself awaits to see who will be the most completely devoted person who has ever lived: willing to be nothing so Christ may be everything; fully accepting God's purposes as his own; receiving Christ's humility, faith, love, and power yet never hindering God's plan but always allowing Him to continue His miraculous work.

C. H. P.

George Mueller, at more than ninety years of age, in an address to ministers and other Christian workers, said, “I was converted in November 1825, but I didn't come to the point of total surrender of my heart until four years later, in July 1829. It was then I realized my love for money, prominence, position, power, and worldly pleasure was gone. God, and He alone,

「居所」觀看的，就在「收割之先」（賽18:5），他們就像新生葡萄樹被砍去一樣全軍覆沒。

我們不要誤將神的安靜與默許或同意混為一談。祂只是按兵不動，必會在最合適的時機起來，就在惡人的計劃快要勝利之時，為的是以災難來傾覆敵人。當我們看着今世的罪惡，當我們見着行惡之人的似乎得勝時，當我們忍受那些恨惡我們之人的壓逼時，我們當謹記神那些不可思議的說話：「我要安靜.....觀看。」

是的，神有另一個看法。祂話語的背後是有智慧的。為何耶穌看着門徒在風暴的晚上奮力盪槳？雖然別人看不見，為何祂卻看着百大尼的拉撒路痛苦事件一幕幕的呈現：從他致命的疾病，因病而死，至終被埋於石穴墓中？只因耶穌要等候那完美的一刻來作祂最有效的代禱。

摘自《每日靈修註釋》

七月十八日

「耶和華的眼目遍察全地，要顯大能幫助向祂心存誠實的人。」（代下16:9）

不單止世人在等候，神自己也等候來看曾活在世上的人中誰才是最完全委身的人，他甘心成為無有，好叫基督得以成為一切；他接受神的目的作為他的目的；他接受基督的謙卑、信、愛和能力，永不阻礙神的計劃，卻總是容許祂來繼續祂奇妙的工作。

C.H.P.

喬治·慕勒在九十多歲時向一群傳道者和其他的基督工人說：「我在1825年11月得救，卻要到1829年7月，即四年後才來到全心全意降服的地步。那時我才不再貪愛錢財、名譽、地位、權力和世上的欲求。神，獨有祂成為我一切中

became my all in all. In Him I found everything I needed, and I desired nothing else. By God's grace, my understanding of His sufficiency has remained to this day, making me an exceedingly happy man. It has led me to care only about the things of God.

"Before the point at which I surrendered my life, I read a little of the Scriptures but preferred other books. Yet since that time, the truth He has revealed to me of Himself has become an inexpressible blessing. Now I can honestly say from the depth of my heart that God is an infinitely wonderful Being.

selected

My prayer today is that God would make me an extraordinary Christian.

George Whitefield

July 19

Shall I not drink the cup the Father has given me? (John 18:11)

To "drink the cup" was a greater thing than calming the seas or raising the dead. The prophets and apostles could do amazing miracles, but they did not always do the will of God and thereby suffered as a result. Doing God's will and thus experiencing suffering is still the highest form of faith, and the most glorious Christian achievement.

Having your brightest aspirations as a young person forever crushed; bearing burdens daily that are always difficult, and never seeing relief; finding yourself worn down by poverty while simply desiring to do good for others and provide a comfortable living for those you love; being shackled by an incurable physical disability; being completely alone, separated from all those you love, to face the trauma of life alone; yet in all these, still being able to say through such a difficult school of discipline, "Shall I not drink the cup the Father has given me?" —this is faith at its highest, and spiritual success at its crowning point.

Great faith is exhibited not so much in doing as in suffering.

Charles Parkhurst

In order to have a sympathetic God, we must have a suffering Savior, for true sympathy comes from understanding another person's hurt by suffering the same affliction. Therefore we cannot help others who

的一切。在祂裏頭我找到凡百所需而無所愛慕。藉神恩典得知有祂便足夠至今依然不變，令我成為極快樂的人，這也使我只關心神的事情。」

「在我獻上我的生命那時，我是少讀聖經多讀其他書籍的。但自此之後，真理把祂自己向我顯明，這成為一個不可言喻的恩福。如今我能從心底來誠實地說：神是無限奇妙的一位。」

選

我今天的祈禱就是神來使我作一個非凡的基督徒。

喬治·懷特腓

七月十九日

「我父所給我的那杯，我豈可不喝呢？」（約18:11）

「喝杯」比起平靜風浪和使死人復活更偉大。先知和使徒能作奇妙的神蹟，但他們不能常按神的旨意來行事，因而接受苦果。行神的旨意和經歷痛苦仍然是最高狀態的信心，也是最榮耀基督徒的成就。

年輕的你最光明的志向被永遠破壞；每天擔負的總是困難，從不得見舒緩；只渴想別人得益處來行善和為你所愛的人來提供舒適的生活下發覺你自己被貧困所消蝕；被治不好的身體殘疾所羈絆；完全孤單，與全部所愛的人隔離，獨自面對生命的創傷。雖然在这一切當中，仍能藉着這樣艱難的訓練學校來說：「我父所給我的那杯，我豈可不喝呢？」這是最高的信，也是得冠冕程度的屬靈勝利。

不是受苦中所展示的信心就不是大信心。

查理士·百赫士

為要得同情的神，我們定須有受苦的救主，因為真的同情是藉着身同感受來明白他人所忍受的傷害。因此，我們在沒有付出一己的

suffer without paying a price ourselves, because afflictions are the cost we pay for our ability to sympathize. Those who wish to help others must first suffer. If we wish to rescue others, we must be willing to face the cross; experiencing the greatest happiness in life through ministering to others is impossible without drinking the cup Jesus drank and without submitting to the baptism He endured.

The most comforting of David's psalms were squeezed from his life by suffering, and if Paul had not been given "a thorn in the flesh" (2 Cor. 12:7 KJV), we would have missed much of the heartbeat of tenderness that resonates through so many of his letters.

July 20

Since we have a great high priest ... , Jesus the Son of God, let us hold firmly to the faith we profess.... Let us then approach the throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need. (Hebrews 4:14, 16)

Our great Helper in prayer is the Lord Jesus Christ. He is our Advocate, ever pleading our case before the Father. He is our "great high priest," whose primary ministry has for centuries been intercession and prayer on our behalf. It is He who receives our imperfect petitions from our hands, cleanses them of their defects, corrects their error, and then claims their answer from His Father. And He does so strictly on the basis of His worth and righteousness through the sufficiency of His atonement.

He has already entered "the Most Holy Place" (Ex. 26:33) on your behalf, holding up your name on the palms of His hands. The messenger is now on his way to bring you your blessing, and the Holy Spirit simply awaits your act of trust, so He may whisper in your heart the echo of the answer from the throne of God, "It is done" (Rev. 21:6).

A. B. Simpson

The Holy Spirit enlightens our mind so we may clearly see our desires, then softens our heart so we may feel them, and finally He awakens and focuses those desires toward godly things. He gives us a clear view of God's power and wisdom, provides grace "in our time of need," and strengthens our confidence in

代價來受苦之先是不能幫助別人的，因為痛苦是我們得着同情能力所付出的代價。那些想幫助別人的人定須先受苦。我們若想拯救別人，定須樂於面對十字架；沒有喝耶穌的杯和沒有降服來甘受主所受之洗的人想藉着服事他人來經驗人生最大的快樂是不可能的。

大衛所寫最令人鼓舞的詩篇都是從他受苦的生命中擠壓出來的，若不是藉賜給保羅的那一根加在他肉體上的刺（林後12:7），我們便會大大失去他眾多書信中反響着微妙感情的心跳。

七月二十日

「我們既然有一位.....大祭司，就是神的兒子耶穌，便當持定所承認的道。.....所以我們只管坦然無懼的，來到施恩的寶座前，為要得憐恤，蒙恩惠作隨時的幫助。」（來4:14,16）

最能幫助我們祈禱的是主耶穌基督。祂是我們的保惠師，常在天父面前在我們的事上作調解。祂是我們的「大祭司」，其首要職務是幾千年來替我們祈禱和代求。是祂從我們手中接去我們不完美的祈禱，洗滌當中不足之處，改正我們的錯誤，之後向祂的父索求祈禱的答覆。祂全然藉祂贖罪充足的功效而來的價值和義作為根據來作。

祂已代你進入「至聖所」（出26:33），把你的名字握在祂的手心。傳訊者如今正在途中來把恩福帶給你，聖靈正等候你簡單的信之舉動，因此祂也許在你心中將神寶座來的答覆輕聲相告：「都成了」（啟21:6）

宣信

聖靈照明我們的思想，清晰看到我們當愛慕的；之後祂柔軟我們的心來感受到這些；至終祂甦醒我們，愛慕聚焦在屬神的事上。祂叫我們清晰看見神的能力和智慧，「隨時幫助」來提供恩惠。祂叫我

His truth so we will never waver.

J. Angell James

July 21

Let me make just one more request. Allow me one more test with the fleece. (Judges 6:39)

There are three levels of faith in the Christian experience. The first is being able to believe only when we see some sign or have some strong emotion. Like Gideon, we feel the fleece and are willing to trust God if it is wet. This may be genuine faith but it is imperfect. It is continually looking to feelings or some other sign instead of the Word of God. We have taken a great step toward maturity when we trust God without relying on our feelings. It is more of a blessing when we believe without experiencing any emotion.

While the first level of faith believes when our emotions are favorable, the second believes when all feelings are absent. And the third level transcends the other two, for it is faith that believes God and His Word when circumstances, emotions, appearances, people, and human reason all seem to urge something to the contrary. Paul exercised this level of faith when he said, "When neither sun nor stars appeared for many days and the storm continued raging, we finally gave up all hope of being saved" (Acts 27:20), then nevertheless went on to say, "Keep up your courage, men, for I have faith in God that it will happen just as he told me" (Acts 27:25).

C. H. P.

July 22

Therefore will the Lord wait, that he may be gracious unto you ... blessed are all they that wait for him. (Isaiah 30:18 KJV)

The very thought of the Lord's waiting on us will give us renewed motivation and inspiration to "wait for him." It will also provide inexpressible confidence that our waiting will never be in vain.

"Why is it that He continues to wait longer and longer to offer His grace and to provide the help I seek, even after I have come and waited on Him?" He does so because He is a wise gardener who "waits for the land to yield its valuable crop" and is "patient ... for the autumn and spring rains" (James 5:7). God knows He cannot gather the fruit until it is ripe, and

們更確信真理，永不動搖。

J·安祖娜·雅各

七月二十一日

「我再說這一次，讓我將羊毛再試一次。」(士6:39)

基督徒可經驗的信心有三個階段。首階段的信是當我們看見令我們產生強烈感情的一些現象而去相信。像基甸一樣，我們摸到羊毛，若羊毛是濕時我們便欣然信靠神。這也許是真信，但不完美，因這信持續要去看望感覺或一些其他現象，而不是看望神的話。當我們不再倚重感覺來信靠神時，我們已向成功邁進一大步。在沒有經歷任何情感下的相信是更蒙福的。

第一階段的信因信和情感相調和，而第二階段的信是在完全沒有感覺下仍相信。第三階段的信更超越前兩階段，這信心就在環境、感覺、外在現象、人物和有人的理性全都似乎是相違背時仍相信神和祂的話。保羅行使這階段的信心時說：「太陽和星辰多日不顯露，又有狂風大浪催逼，我們得救的指望就都絕了。」(徒27:20)之後仍能說「所以眾位可以放心，我信神，祂怎樣對我說，事情也要怎樣成就。」(徒27:25)

C.H.P.

七月二十二日

「耶和華必然等候，要施恩給你們。……凡等候祂的，都是有福的。」(賽30:18)

神等候我們這思想給我們復甦的動機和感動來「等候祂」。這也會給我們說不出來的確信，肯定這等候永不會枉然。

為甚麼就算我已來到等候祂時，祂持續要我久等還未給我祂的恩典和我尋求的幫助呢？祂這樣是因祂是聰明的園丁，祂「忍耐等候地裏寶貴的出產，直到得了秋雨春雨。」(雅5:7)神知道生果未成熟而不採摘，祂完全知道我們何

He knows precisely when we are spiritually ready to receive blessings for our gain and His glory. And waiting in the sunshine of His love is what will ripen our soul for His blessings. Also, waiting under the clouds of trials is as important, for they will ultimately produce showers of blessings.

Rest assured that if God waits longer than we desire, it is simply to make the blessings doubly precious. Remember, He waited four thousand years, "but when the time had fully come, God sent his Son" (Gal. 4:4). Our time is in His hands, and He will quickly avenge those He has chosen, swiftly coming to our support without ever delaying even one hour too long.

Andrew Murray

July 23

Sing ... to the Lord, always giving thanks to God the Father for everything. (Ephesians 5:19-20)

No matter the source of the evil confronting you, if you are in God and thereby completely surrounded by Him, you must realize that it has first passed through Him before coming to you. Because of this, you can thank Him for everything that comes your way.

Each of us has many black dots or spots in our life, and we cannot understand why they are there or why God permitted them. But when we allow Him into our life to adjust the dots in the proper way, to draw the lines He desires, and to put rests at the proper places to separate us from certain things, then from the black dots and spots He will compose a glorious harmony.

C. H. P.

Many people owe the grandeur of their lives to their tremendous difficulties.

Charles H. Spurgeon

When an organist presses the black keys of a great organ, the notes are just as beautiful as when he presses the white ones. Yet to fully demonstrate the capabilities of the instrument, he must press them all.

selected

July 24

Then they believed his promises and sang his praise. But they soon forgot what he had done and did not wait for his counsel. In the desert they gave in to their

時靈裏準備好，為着我們的益處和神的榮耀來獲取恩福。在祂愛的陽光下來等候會叫我們的生命成熟，好蒙祂恩福。更且，在試煉的烏雲下等候是同樣重要的，因為他們會至終降下恩福的雨露。

若在渴求的事上神久等時，我們該放心，這不過叫恩福加倍寶貴。謹記祂等候了四千年，「及至時候滿足，神就差遣祂的兒子」(加 4:4)。我們的時間掌握在祂手中，祂必快快為祂的選民報仇，速來幫助我們，不會遲疑，一刻也不會。

慕安德烈

七月二十三日

「當.....口唱心和的讚美主。凡事.....常常感謝父神。」(弗5:19-20)

只要你在神裏頭，完全被祂圍繞，你必明白到就算邪惡之源就你而來，須先經過神才能來到你處。因此之故，你能為來到你處的每樣東西來感謝祂。

我們每個人不明生命中為何神容許有很多黑點斑跡存在。當我們容讓神進入我們的生命來用正確的方法調節那些黑點，隨祂喜好畫上線條，和在適當位置放上休止符把我們與某些事物阻隔時，那麼那些黑點斑跡會譜寫成榮美樂章。

C.H.P.

多人的生命不能崇高，是因他們欠缺了極大的困難。

司布真

風琴手按動大風琴的黑鍵與按動白鍵所發的音調同樣美麗。然而要全面展示那樂器的性能，他定須全部琴鍵都按動。

選

七月二十四日

「那時，他們才信了祂的話，歌唱讚美祂。等不多時，他們就忘了祂的作為，不仰望祂的指教，反倒在

craving; in the wasteland they put God to the test. So he gave them what they asked for, but sent a wasting disease upon them. (Psalm 106:12-15)

Even today we have people who live an inconsistent Christian life because they have become preoccupied with things that are external. Therefore they focus on their circumstances rather than focusing on God. And God desires that we grow in our ability to see Him in everything and to realize the importance of seemingly insignificant circumstances if they are used to deliver a message from Him.

They unabashedly doubted God when they came to the Red Sea, but when He opened the way and led them across and they saw Pharaoh and his army drowned—"then they believed." The Israelites continued to live this kind of up-and-down existence, because their faith was dependent on their circumstances.

The world says that "seeing is believing," but God wants us to believe in order to see. The psalmist said, "I would have despaired unless I had believed that I would see the goodness of the Lord in the land of the living" (Ps. 27:13 NASB).

C. H. P.

Faith is believing what we do not see, and the reward for this kind of faith is to see what we believe.
Saint Augustine

July 25

You do not realize now what I am doing, but later you will understand. (John 13:7)

"Wail, O pine tree, for the cedar has fallen ... !" (Zech. 11:2)

We should not be so quick to complain but should follow the gigantic tree as the workmen of "Hiram king of Tyre" (2 Chron. 2:3) take it down the mountainside. From there we should watch it being sailed on rafts along the blue water of the Mediterranean. And finally, we should behold it being placed as a glorious and polished beam in the temple of God. As you contemplate its final destination, seeing it in the Holy of Holies as a jewel in the diadem of the almighty King, can you honestly complain that this "crown jewel of Lebanon" was cut down, removed from the forest, and placed in such a noble setting? The cedar had once stood majestically

曠野大起慾心，在荒地試探神。祂將他們所求的賜給他們，卻使他們的心靈軟弱。」(詩106:12-15)

今天我們有人活在反覆無常的基督徒生命中，皆因他們一直被外在事物所佔據。因此他們聚焦在環境而不在神身上。神所渴想的是我們成長至我們能夠在凡事上看見祂；和明白到就算看來如何不足道的處境，只要是被用作傳遞神訊息的都有其重要性。

他們來到紅海時便毫無羞愧地質疑神，但當祂開啟了道路，領他們渡過紅海，見着法老和他的全軍都淹沒時，「那時，他們才信」。以色列人繼續活在這種起伏不平的生活方式中，因為他們的信取決於環境。

世人說「看見才信」，但神想我們的信是為了有所看見。詩人說：「我若不信在活人之地得見耶和華的恩惠，就早已喪膽了。」(詩27:13)

C.H.P.

信是相信所不見的，這種信的賞賜就是得見我們所相信的。
奧古斯丁

七月二十五日

「你如今不知道，後來必明白。」
(約13:7)

「松樹阿，應當哀號，因為香柏樹傾倒。」(亞11:2)

我們不應埋怨太快，卻應隨着「推羅王希蘭」(代下2:3)的工人們把這棵大樹從山邊往下帶走。從那裏我們該看到它在木筏上沿藍色的地中海水道漂流。至終我們應看到它被放在神的殿中成為那榮美和光亮的殿柱。當你細看它的至終目的地時，見到它在至聖所中如同全能王的冠冕上的珠寶，老實說你會否再為着這「利巴嫩的冠冕珠寶」被砍倒、從森林中被移除和放在如此尊貴之處而埋怨？這香柏樹曾尊貴地站在大自然的神

in nature's sanctuary, but "the glory of this present house will be greater than the glory of the former house" (Hag. 2:9).

"You will be a crown of splendor in the Lord's hand, a royal diadem in the hand of your God" (Isa. 62:3).

J. R. Macduff

July 26

By faith we eagerly await through the Spirit the righteousness for which we hope. (Galatians 5:5)

When we have an empty place in our heart yet will not allow it to be filled with anything less than God's best—that is the greatest kind of patience in the universe. It is the story of Job in the midst of the storm, Abraham on the road to Moriah, Moses in the desert of Midian, and the Son of Man in the Garden of Gethsemane. And there is no patience as strong as that which endures because we see "him who is invisible" (Heb. 11:27). It is the kind of patience that waits for hope. Dear Lord, You have made waiting beautiful and patience divine.

Father, give me Your divine power—the power of Gethsemane. Give me the strength to wait for hope—to look through the window when there are no stars. Even when my joy is gone, give me the strength to stand victoriously in the darkest night and say, "To my heavenly Father, the sun still shines."

George Matheson

July 27

Test me in this ... and see if I will not throw open the floodgates of heaven and pour out so much blessing that you will not have room enough for it. (Malachi 3:10)

I will never forget my mother's concise paraphrase of Malachi 3:10. The actual Bible text begins with the words "Bring the whole tithe into the storehouse" and ends with "I will ... pour out so much blessing that," in effect, "you will be embarrassed over your lack of space to receive it." But my mother's paraphrase was this: "Give all He asks and take all He promises."

Samuel Dickey Gordon

God's ability to perform is far beyond our prayers—even our greatest prayers! I have asked for a

殿中，然而「這殿後來的榮耀，必大過先前的榮耀。」(該2:9)

「你在耶和華的手中要作為華冠，在你神的掌上必作為冕旒。」(賽62:3)

J.R.麥道夫

七月二十六日

「我們靠着聖靈，憑着信心，等候所盼望的義。」(加5:5)

當我們的心中有空位時，不要容許任何東西來填滿，除了是神給最好的東西，就是在宇宙中最大的那種忍耐。例子有在衝擊中的約伯、去摩利亞路上的亞伯拉罕、在米甸曠野的摩西、和在客西馬尼園的人子。沒有忍耐是強如他們所堅忍的，因為我們得見「那不能看見的主。」(來11:27)。這種就是等待盼望的忍耐。

父啊，將祢神聖的力量——客西馬尼的力量——給我；把等候盼望——當沒有星星時仍從窗往外看——的力量給我；在最暗黑的夜晚給我力量來凱旋地站立來說：「我的天父使太陽仍在照耀。」

喬治·馬得勝

七月二十七日

「你們.....以此試試我，是否為你們敞開天上的窗戶，傾福與你們，甚至無處可容。」(瑪3:10)

我永不會忘記我母親對瑪3:10的簡潔的釋義。聖經文本開首的字眼是：「將當納的十分之一全然送入倉庫」，和以「我必會傾福與你們」為結束。到頭來，「你必會因無處可容而感無地自容」。但我母親的釋義是這樣的：「全給祂所要求的，全取祂所承諾的。」

撒母耳·迪奇·哥頓

神能力的展現遠超我們那怕是最大的祈禱！我祈求一杯水，祂

cupful, while He owns the entire ocean! I have asked for one simple ray of light, while He holds the sun! My best asking is far beyond what we could ever ask.

John Henry Jowett

July 28

His way is in the whirlwind and the storm. (Nahum 1:3)

One day I sat on the side of the mountain and watched a storm as it moved through the valley. The skies were filled with darkness, and thunder began to shake the earth. It seemed as though the lush landscape were completely changed, and its beauty gone forever. But the storm passed quickly and soon moved out of the valley.

If I had sat in the same place the following day and said, "Where is that intense storm and all its terrible darkness?" the grass would have said, "Part of it is in me." The beautiful daisy would have said, "Part of it is in me." And all the other flowers, fruits, and everything that grows in the ground would have said, "Part of the storm has produced the radiance in me."

Have you ever asked the Lord to make you like Him? Have you ever desired the fruit of the Spirit and prayed for sweetness, gentleness, and love? If so, then never fear the fierce storms that even now may be blowing through your life. Storms bring blessings, and rich fruit will be harvested later.

Henry Ward Beecher

July 29

Have you entered the storehouses ... which I reserve for times of trouble? (Job 38:22-23)

Our trials are great opportunities, but all too often we simply see them as large obstacles. If only we would recognize every difficult situation as something God has chosen to prove His love to us, each obstacle would then become a place of shelter and rest, and a demonstration to others of His inexpressible power.

God's most beautiful jewels are often delivered in rough packages by very difficult people, but within the package we will find the very treasures of the King's palace and the Bridegroom's love.

A. B. Simpson

July 30

擁有的卻是一整個海洋！我祈求一絲光線，祂卻掌管着太陽！天父所給的遠超我們從來所祈求的。

約翰·亨利·祖屈

七月二十八日

「祂乘旋風和暴風而來。」(鴻1:3)

有一天我坐在山邊，看着一個暴風如何移掃一山谷。天空滿佈黑暗，雷電開始搖動大地。繁盛的景致就像要完全改變，美麗要永遠失掉一樣。但風暴去得極快，不久便離開了山谷。

若我在第二日坐在同一地方時便會說：「那強烈風暴和它恐怖的黑暗在那裏呢？」草兒會說：

「它一部分在我裏頭。」美麗的雛菊會說：「它一部分在我裏頭。」所有其他的花兒、生果、和在地上種植的每一樣東西都會說：「暴風的一部分在我裏頭產生了作用。」

你曾否求主使你像祂？你曾否渴慕聖靈的果子，祈求親切、溫柔和愛？若有，那麼總不要害怕猛烈的風暴了，那怕可能正在吹襲你生命的那一場。風暴帶來恩福，過後便會有豐盛果子的收成。

亨利·華德·比查

七月二十九日

「你曾進入雪庫.....麼？這雪霽乃是我為降災.....的日子所預備的。」(伯38:22-23)

試煉於我們是非常的機會，我們卻一再看他們為大障礙。我們只要認清神其實選擇每個困難處境來向我們證明祂的愛，那麼每個障物便成為蔭涼安息之處，也向別人展示祂說不盡的權能。

神最美麗的珠寶常在粗糙的包裝下經十分難相處之人的手送來，但在包裝內我們必能發現王的宮殿中和新娘所愛的非常珍寶。

宣信

七月三十日

If anyone gives even a cup of cold water ... , he will certainly not lose his reward. (Matthew 10:42)

I expect to pass through this world but once. Therefore any good work, kindness, or service I can render to any person or animal, let me do it now. Let me not neglect or delay to do it, for I will not pass this way again.

an old Quaker saying

Give what you have, for you never know—to someone else it may be better than you can even dare to think.

Henry Wadsworth Longfellow

July 31

With skillful hands he led them. (Psalm 78:72)

When you are unsure which course to take, totally submit your own judgment to that of the Spirit of God, asking Him to shut every door except the right one. But meanwhile keep moving ahead and consider the absence of a direct indication from God to be the evidence of His will that you are on His path.

God often guides us through our circumstances. One moment, our way may seem totally blocked, but then suddenly some seemingly trivial incident occurs, appearing as nothing to others but speaking volumes to the keen eye of faith. And sometimes these events are repeated in various ways in response to our prayers. They certainly are not haphazard results of chance but are God opening up the way we should walk, by directing our circumstances. And they begin to multiply as we advance toward our goal, just as the lights of a city seem to increase as we speed toward it while traveling at night.

F. B. Meyer

August 1

Offer yourselves to God, as those who have been brought from death to life. (Romans 6:13)

In a sermon on consecration, the preacher knelt to pray, he said, "O Lord, You know we can trust the Man who died for us."

Upon arriving home, I went straight to my room, fell on my knees, and saw my life pass before my eyes. I was a Christian, an officer in the church, and a

「無論何人.....只把一杯涼水給這小子裏的一個喝，.....這人不能不得賞賜。」(太10:42)

我會走完今世，但只得一次。因此有甚麼善事、仁慈、對任何人或動物要作甚麼服務就要如今來作了。我不要忽略或延遲來作，因為我必不能重回這路。

一個古老貴格會的諺語

將你所有的送出去，因為你永不知道，對於收到的人來說所送出的總會比你以為的更好。

亨利·華士和夫·朗法勞

七月三十一日

「祂.....用手中的巧妙，引導他們。」(詩78:72)

當你不肯定要選那條路走時，將你一切的判斷完全呈獻給神的靈吧，求祂關上正確之門以外的每一道門。但在保持前行的那刻，要將沒有從神而來的直接指引看為你正在祂旨意的路徑上的明證。

神常時藉處境帶領我們。有時我們的前路也許似乎完全被阻塞，但隨後突然一些似乎瑣碎的事件出現，別人視為不以為然的，但在信心鋒利的眼中看為充足的明證。有時這些事件以不同的方法重覆出現來回應我們的祈禱。他們肯定不是偶發的機緣巧合，而是神藉環境的指引來開路，好叫我們來行上。當我們向着目標前行時他們越發增多，如同在我們晚上駕車向城市前行時的燈光不斷增加一樣。

邁爾

八月一日

「倒要像從死裏復活的人，將自己獻給神。」(羅6:13)

有一個論及獻身的講道，傳道者跪下祈禱說：「主啊，祢知我們可依靠為我們死的那一位。」

當抵家時，我直入房間，雙膝跪下，過往的人生在眼前經過。我是一名基督徒，在教會中有職事，

Sunday school superintendent, but I had never yielded my life to God with a definite act of my will. Yet as I thought of my own “precious” plans that might be thwarted, my beloved hopes to be surrendered, and my chosen profession that I might have to abandon—I was afraid.

I completely failed to see the better things God had for me, so my soul was running from Him. And then for the last time, with a swift force of convicting power to my inmost heart, came that searching message: “My child, you can trust the Man who died for you. If you cannot trust Him, then whom can you trust?”

J. H. M.

Life is not wreckage to be saved out of the world but an investment to be used in the world.

August 2

I will turn all my mountains into roads. (Isaiah 49:11)

God will make our obstacles serve His purposes. We all have mountains in our lives, and often they are people and things that threaten to block the progress of our spiritual life. The obstacles may be untruths told about us; a difficult occupation; “a thorn in [the] flesh” (2 Cor. 12:7); or our daily cross. And often we pray for their removal, for we tend to think that if only these were removed, we would live a more tender, pure, and holy life.

“How foolish you are, and how slow of heart ... !” (Luke 24:25). These are the very conditions we need for achievement, and they have been put in our lives as the means of producing the gifts and qualities for which we have been praying so long. We pray for patience for many years, and when something begins to test us beyond our endurance, we run from it. The only way genuine patience can be acquired is by enduring the very trials that seem so unbearable today.

Turn from your running and submit. Claim by faith to be a partaker in the patience of Jesus and face your trials in Him. There is nothing in your life that distresses or concerns you that cannot become submissive to the highest purpose. Remember, they are God’s mountains. He puts them there for a reason, and we know He will never fail to keep His promise.

且是一個主日學校長，但我還未曾用我意志上的明確行動來將生命呈獻給神。但當我想到我一己寶貴的計劃可能受阻礙，我心愛的希望可能要放棄，可能要拋棄我所選擇的職業時，我是害怕的。

我完全沒有看到神給我更好的東西，因此我的魂是想逃避祂的。至終有一說服力徹底的信息這時臨到我心至深處：「我兒啊，你若不能信靠祂可信靠為你死的那一位，你還可信靠誰呢？」

J.H.M.

生命不是從世上要救回的碎片，乃是用作世上的投資。

八月二日

「我必使我的眾山成為大道。」(賽49:11)

神必會使阻礙我們的成就祂的目的。我們全都有生命中的大山，常威脅要阻礙我們屬靈生命的人和物。障礙可能是我們的謊話、一個麻煩的職業、「一根加在我肉體上的刺」(林後12:7)、或我們每天的十字架。我們常祈求除去他們，總以為只要除去他們便可活出更溫柔、更純潔和更神聖的生命。

「無知的人哪……你們的心，信得太遲鈍了。」(路24:25)這正是我們所需改進的，他們早已放在我們生命中，為叫我們一直祈求要得的恩賜和素質。我們多年祈求忍耐，當有超乎我們忍受的東西開始試驗我們時，我們卻逃跑。得着真忍耐的唯一方法就是忍受今天那些似乎不能忍耐的試煉。

從逃離轉過來降服。用信心支取有分於耶穌的忍耐，和在祂裏頭面對試煉。在你的生命中沒有苦惱或掛心會使你不能在最高的旨意上順服。謹記，神把祂的高山放在那裏是有目的的，為叫我們認識到祂永不會不恪守祂所應許。

“God understands the way to it and he alone knows where it dwells, for he views the ends of the earth and sees everything under the heavens” (Job 28:23-24). So when we come to the foot of the mountains, we will find our way.

from Christ in Isaiah, by F. B. Meyer

August 3

Be men of courage; be strong. (1 Corinthians 16:13)

Never pray for an easier life—pray to be a stronger person! Never pray for tasks equal to your power—pray for power equal to your tasks. Then doing your work will be no miracle—you will be the miracle.

Phillips Brooks

We must remember that Christ will not lead us to greatness through an easy or self-indulgent life. An easy life does not lift us up but only takes us down. Heaven is always above us, and we must continually be looking toward it.

Some people always avoid things that are costly, or things that require self-denial, self-restraint, and self-sacrifice. Yet it is hard work and difficulties that ultimately lead us to greatness, for greatness is not found by walking the moss-covered path laid out for us through the meadow. It is found by being sent to carve out our own path with our own hands.

selected

August 4

Jesus looked up and said, “Father, I thank You that You have heard me.” (John 11:41)

Lazarus was still in his tomb, yet Jesus’ thanksgiving preceded the miracle of raising him from the dead. It seems that thanks would only have been lifted up once the great miracle had been accomplished and Lazarus had been restored to life. But Jesus gave thanks for what He was about to receive. His gratitude sprang forth before the blessing had arrived, in an expression of assurance that it was certainly on its way. The song of victory was sung before the battle had been fought. It was the Sower singing the song of harvest—it was thanksgiving before the miracle!

Praise is actually the most vital preparation to the

「神明白智慧的道路，曉得智慧的所在，因祂鑒察直到地極，遍觀普天之下。」(伯28:23-24)因此當我們來到山腳時，我們必能找到去路。

邁爾著《以賽亞書中的基督》

八月三日

「要作大丈夫，要剛強。」(林前16:13)

永不要祈求舒適的生活，卻要祈求成為更強壯的人！永不要那些等同你能力的工作，卻要祈求你工作的能力，那麼你所作的工必不會是奇蹟，你必會就是奇蹟。

腓力斯·布魯克

我們定須謹記基督必不會藉舒適或自我放縱的生活給我們偉大。一個安樂的生活不會提升我們，卻只會把我們拉低。天堂總在我們的上頭，我們定須持續望天。

有人總逃避要付代價的東西，或是那些需要自我否定、自我約束和自我犧牲的東西。然而艱辛和困難領我們成為偉大，因為走經草坪上鋪滿苔蘚的小徑不會找到偉大，而是藉我們的手開闢一己的路徑才能找到。

選

八月四日

「耶穌舉目望天說：父阿，我感謝祢，因為祢已經聽我。」(約11:41)

拉撒路雖仍在墳墓裏，耶穌的感恩卻先於死人復活這神蹟。似乎當在偉大的神蹟得成就，拉撒路得回生命之後才來感謝。但耶穌為着祂將獲取的來感謝。在恩福來臨之前祂便湧出感謝，確實地表述恩福正在來臨中的肯定。在爭戰完結前所唱得勝之歌，是播種者唱頌的收割之歌——在神蹟之前先有謝恩！

讚美事實上是運作神蹟的最

working of miracles. Miracles are performed through spiritual power, and our spiritual power is always in proportion to our faith. John

Henry Jowett

August 5

My grace is sufficient for you. (2 Corinthians 12:9)

“God was pleased” (1 Cor. 1:21) to take my youngest child from this world, under circumstances that caused me severe trials and pain.

I found that the verse “My grace is sufficient for you” was the text of next week’s Sunday school lesson, yet while trying to write the sermon, I found that in all honesty, I could not say that the words were true in my life. Therefore I knelt down and asked the Lord to make His grace sufficient for me. While I was pleading in this way, I opened my eyes and saw this exact verse framed and hanging on the wall. My mother had given it to me a few days before.

The word “is” was highlighted in bright green, while the words “my” and “you” were painted in yet another color. In a moment, a message flashed straight to my soul, coming as a rebuke for having prayed such a prayer as, “Lord, make Your grace sufficient for me.” His answer was almost an audible voice that said, “How dare you ask for something that is? I cannot make My grace any more sufficient than I have already made it. Get up and believe it, and you will find it to be true in your life.”

H. W. Webb Peploe

August 6

Awake, north wind, and come, south wind! Blow on my garden, that its fragrance may spread abroad. (Song of Songs 4:16)

It is rooted in the fact that in the same way beautiful fragrances may lie hidden in a spice plant, certain gifts may lie unused or undeveloped in a Christian’s heart. Many seeds of a profession of faith may be planted, but from some the air is never filled with the aroma of holy desires or godly deeds. The same winds blow on the thistle and the spice plant, but only one of them emits a rich fragrance.

Sometimes God causes severe winds of trial to blow upon His children to develop their gifts. Just as a torch burns more brightly when waved back and forth,

重要預備；神蹟是藉屬靈能力行出來的，而我們的屬靈能力是與我們的信心成正比例的。

約翰·亨利·祖屈

八月五日

「我的恩典夠你用的。」(林後12:9)

「神樂意」(林前1:21)從這世界取走我最年幼的孩子，這處境帶給我嚴峻的試煉和痛苦。

我知道「我的恩典是夠你用的」這經文是下星期日主日學的課題，然而當我嘗試來寫講章時，老實說，我發覺在我的生命上我不能說這是對的。因此我跪下求主來使祂的恩典足夠我用。當我這樣求時，我張眼看見掛在牆上的字框正是這經文，是母親幾日前給我的。

「是」字標以鮮綠色，而「我的」和「你」則用上別的颜色。那一刻，有一信息直閃入我魂，來譴責我竟作祈禱如：「主，使祢的恩典夠我用。」而祂的回應幾乎是一可聽之聲，說：「你豈敢求這個？我不能使我的恩典比我已作的更夠用。起來相信吧，你必會發覺這在你生命中是對的。」

H.W.韋伯·伯盧

八月六日

「北風阿，興起。南風阿，吹來。吹在我的園內，使其中的香氣發出來。」(歌4:16)

美麗的香氣藏於香料植物是一個事實，同樣地基督徒心中也許會藏有某些未用或未發展的恩賜。也許播種了很多信仰的種子，但其中一些種子不能使空氣充滿神聖渴望和虔誠行為的香氣。風同時吹過薊草和一些香料植物，但只有其中一棵發出一陣濃濃的香氣。

有時神使猛烈的試煉之風疾吹祂的孩子，為的是擴展他們的恩賜。火把來回搖動是會燒得更明亮

and just as a juniper plant smells sweetest when thrown into the flames, so the richest qualities of a Christian often arise under the strong winds of suffering and adversity. Bruised hearts often emit the fragrance that God loves to smell.

August 7

After they prayed, the place where they were meeting was shaken. And they were all filled with the Holy Spirit and spoke the word of God boldly....With great power the apostles continued to testify to the resurrection of the Lord Jesus. (Acts 4:31, 33)

Christmas Evans, a Welsh preacher of the late-eighteenth and early-nineteenth centuries, once wrote the following account in his diary.

“One Sunday afternoon I was traveling by horseback to an appointment. Suddenly as I went along a very lonely road, I was convicted of having a cold heart. I dismounted, tethered my horse to a tree, and found a secluded spot. Then, walking back and forth in agony, I reviewed my life. I waited before God in brokenness and sorrow for three hours. Finally a sweet sense of His forgiving love broke over me, and I received a fresh filling of His Holy Spirit.

“As the sun was setting, I walked back to the road, found my horse, and rode on to my appointment. The following day I preached with so much new power, to a vast gathering of people on a hillside, that revival broke out and ultimately spread through all of Wales.”

The born-again—the password of the early church—“Did you receive the Holy Spirit when you believed?” (Acts 19:2).

August 8

You are my King and my God, who decrees victories for Jacob. (Psalm 44:4)

There are no enemies to your growth in grace, or to your Christian work, that were not included in your Savior's victory. Remember, “The Lord said to Joshua, ‘Do not be afraid of them, because ... I will hand all of them over to [you]’” (Josh. 11:6). Also recall the fact that when you resist your enemies, they “will flee from you” (James 4:7). And remember what Joshua said to the people: “Do not be afraid; do not be discouraged. Be strong and courageous” (Josh. 10:25). The Lord is with you, “mighty men of valour” (Josh. 1:14 KJV), and

的，同樣地當將一株紅柳植物拋入火焰中燒時，會發出最甜美香氣，因此在受苦和逆境之強風中的基督徒常激起最豐碩的素質。受傷的心常散發出神愛聞的馨香。

八月七日

「禱告完了，聚會的地方震動，他們就都被聖靈充滿，放膽講論神的道.....使徒大有能力，見證主耶穌復活。眾人都蒙大恩。」（徒4:31,33）

十八世紀末十九世紀初的威爾士傳道人克瑞斯馬·伊凡思在他的日記中有以下的記事：

「一個星期日下午我騎馬去赴會。當我在幽靜的路上走時，我為着冰冷的心認罪。我下馬，把馬繫綁在一棵樹，之後找到一僻靜之處。那時在痛苦中踱步，來來回回，檢視我的生命，用了三小時在沮喪和憂愁中在神面前等候。最後祂饒恕的愛這甜美的感覺忽爾臨到，我便從新得着神聖靈的充滿。」

「當太陽下山時，我按原路而回，找回馬匹，馳馬赴會。之後一日的傳講是滿有新能力，山邊聚滿群眾，復興爆發，至終延展至整個威爾士。」

「重生」是早期教會的入門密碼——「你們信的時候，受了聖靈沒有？」（徒19:2）

八月八日

「神阿，祢是我的王，求祢出令，使雅各得勝。」（詩44:4）

你在恩中成長和為主作工都不會有敵人，因這些都不包含在救主的勝利中。謹記「耶和華對約書亞說：不要因他們懼怕.....我必將他們交付以色列人全然殺了。」（書11:6）也要回想當你抗拒敵人時，他們便「離開你們逃跑了」（雅4:7）這事實。當記取約書亞對民眾說：「不要懼怕，也不要驚惶。應當剛強壯膽。」（書10:25）「一切大

you are mighty because you are one with the Mightiest. So claim victory!

Count Christ's victory as yours and gather the spoils of the war. Neither the giant "descendants of Anak" (Num. 13:33) nor fortified cities need intimidate or defeat you. You are a part of the conquering army. Claim your share in the Savior's victory.

from Joshua, by F. B. Meyer

August 9

Blessed are those whose strength is in you....As they pass through the Valley of Baca, they make it a place of springs. (Psalm 84:5-6)

Comfort is not given to us when we are lighthearted and cheerful. We must travel the depths of emotion in order to experience comfort—one of God's most precious gifts. And then we must be prepared to become coworkers with Him.

When the shadows of night—needed night—gather over the garden of our souls, when leaves close up and flowers no longer reflect any sunlight within their folded petals, and when we experience even the thickest darkness, we must remember that we will never be found wanting and that the comforting drops of heavenly dew fall only after the sun has set.

August 10

Yet when he heard that Lazarus was sick, he stayed where he was two more days. (John 11:6)

"Jesus loved Martha and her sister and Lazarus" (v. 5). It is as if God were teaching us that at the very heart and foundation of all His dealings with us, no matter how dark and mysterious they may be, we must dare to believe in and affirm His infinite, unmerited, and unchanging love. Yet love permits pain to occur.

Mary and Martha never doubted that Jesus would quickly avert every obstacle to keep their brother from death, "yet when he heard that Lazarus was sick, he stayed where he was two more days."

Jesus refrained from going not because He did not love them but because He did love them. It was His love alone that kept Him from hurrying at once to their beloved yet grief-stricken home.

能的勇士」(書1:14)啊，主與你們同在，你們有能力因與你們同在的最大能。那麼索取勝利吧！

以基督的勝利為你的勝利來聚斂戰利品。「偉人的後裔」(民13:33)或堅城不能恫嚇或擊敗你，你是得勝軍隊的一部分。在基督的得勝中索求你的分吧！

摘自邁爾著的《約書亞》

八月九日

「靠祢有力量.....的，這人便為有福。他們經過流淚谷，叫這谷變為泉源之地。」(詩84:5-6)

安慰不是在我們心情愉快和歡欣時才給我們的。我們定須進入感情的深處才能經驗安慰，就是神其中一個最寶貴的恩賜。之後我們定須準備好成為祂的同工。

當夜影——難過的晚上——濃罩我們的生命花園時，當葉兒閉合，花兒不再在他們摺合的花瓣中反照日光，甚至當我們所經歷的是最厚密的黑暗時，我們定須謹記我們永不會落在缺乏中，安慰的天露滴濕只會在日落後降下。

八月十日

「(然而)聽見拉撒路病了，就在所居之地，仍住了兩天。」(約11:6)

「耶穌素來愛馬大，和她妹子，並拉撒路。」(約11:5)就如神教導我們，在心中的祂處理我們一切事件的基礎上，無論他們如何黑暗和神秘，我們定須敢於相信和確知祂的愛無限、不求回報和不變的，然而愛也容許痛苦發生。

馬利亞和馬大在耶穌會排除萬難趕快來叫她們兄弟不死上毫無懷疑，「(然而)聽見拉撒路病了，就在所居之地，仍住了兩天。」

耶穌忍住不去，不是因為祂不愛他們，相反正因祂真的愛他們，就是只因祂這愛使祂不立時趕去到他們這可愛卻極為悲痛之家。

August 11

Though the fig tree does not bud and there are no grapes on the vines, though the olive crop fails and the fields produce no food, though there are no sheep in the pen and no cattle in the stalls, yet I will rejoice in the Lord, I will be joyful in God my Savior. (Habakkuk 3:17-18)

It is as if the writer were actually saying, "Even if I am forced to undergo the extreme condition of not knowing where to find my next meal, and although my house is empty and my fields yield no crops and I see the evidence of divine pestilence where I once saw the fruits of God's plentiful provision, 'yet I will rejoice in the Lord.'"

Oh, by God's grace, may they be deeply etched on the tablets of each of our hearts! Although the above verse is very concise, it nevertheless implies or expresses the following thoughts of the writer: that in his time of distress he would flee to God; that he would maintain his spiritual composure under the darkest of circumstances; and that in the midst of everything, he would delight himself with a sacred joy in God and have cheerful expectations of Him.

Heroic confidence! Glorious faith!
Unconquerable love!

Philip Doddridge

August 12

He has given us his very great and precious promises. (2 Peter 1:4)

A shipbuilder erects a boat to sail the seas and to weather the storms.

Do you believe that some of His promises are counterfeit, similar to a life vest that looks good in the store but is of no use in the sea?

We have all seen swords that are beautiful but are useless in war, or shoes made for decoration but not for walking. Yet God's shoes are made of iron and brass, and we can walk all the way to heaven in them, without ever wearing them out. And we could swim the Atlantic a thousand times in His life vest, with no fear of ever sinking. His Word of promise is meant to be tried and tested.

There is nothing Christ dislikes more than for His

八月十一日

「雖然無花果樹不發旺，葡萄樹不結果，橄欖樹也不效力，田地不出糧食，圈中絕了羊，棚內也沒有牛。然而我要因耶和華歡欣，因救我的神喜樂。」（哈3:17-18）

這就如同作者真的說：「就算我被逼來經受不知在何處找到下一餐，雖然我家徒四壁，田地不出土產，從前見到神豐富供應果子之處如今但見神而來的禍害，這等嚴峻的情況，『然而我要因耶和華歡欣』。」

噢，願神施恩，讓這些深深蝕刻在我們每人心中的匾額上！雖然文首經節是這樣簡潔，但它畢竟道出或表達作者的心意：在他絕望之時可逃往神處；在最黑暗的處境下仍持守他屬靈的沉靜；在萬事萬物中，因着在神裏頭有神聖的喜樂和對祂有歡欣的期望而高興。

這是崇高的確信！榮耀的信心！不可征服的愛！

腓力·陶德瑞

八月十二日

「祂已將又寶貴又極大的應許賜給我們。」（彼後1:4）

造船者裝嵌一艘船是要啟航出海，抵禦暴風的。

你是否以為神的應許虛假，如同一些救生衣在倉存時看起來合用，但在海上卻一無是處？

我們全都見過美麗但在戰場上毫無用處的劍器，也見過只合裝飾不合走路的鞋子。神的鞋子是用鐵用銅來製造的，穿上他們叫我們直奔天家去，總不會穿破。穿上祂的救生衣能泳渡大西洋一千遍，總不怕溺沒。祂應許的話是經得起試驗和試煉的。

沒有像公開承認祂卻不用祂

people to publicly profess Him and then not use Him.

Charles H. Spurgeon

How can God say no to something He has promised?

August 13

If clouds are full of water, they pour rain upon the earth. (Ecclesiastes 11:3)

It is true that for a while the dark clouds hide the sun, but it is not extinguished and it will soon shine again. Meanwhile those clouds are filled with rain, and the darker they are, the more likely they are to bring plentiful showers.

How can we have rain without clouds? Our troubles have always brought us blessings, and they always will, for they are the dark chariots of God's bright and glorious grace. Before long the clouds will be emptied, and every tender plant will be happier due to the showers. Our God may drench us with grief, but He will refresh us with His mercy. Our Lord's love letters often come to us in dark envelopes. His wagons may rumble noisily across the sky, but they are loaded with benefits. And His rod blossoms with sweet flowers and nourishing fruits. So let us not worry about the clouds. Instead, let us sing because May flowers are brought to us through April clouds and showers.

O Lord, "clouds are the dust of [your] feet" ! (Nah. 1:3).

Charles H. Spurgeon

August 14

You would have no power over me if it were not given to you from above. (John 19:11)

Someone who was passing through the deep water of affliction wrote a friend:

Isn't it glorious to know that no matter how unjust something may be, even when it seems to have come from Satan himself, by the time it reaches us it is God's will for us and will ultimately work to our good?

"And we know that in all things God works for the good of those who love him" (Rom. 8:28). Think of what Christ said even as He was betrayed: "Shall I not drink the cup the Father has given me?" (John 18:11).

Hannah Whitall Smith

的子民更叫基督不喜悅。

司布真

神怎會在應許的事上說不？

八月十三日

「雲若滿了雨，就必傾倒在地上。」
(傳11:3)

黑雲會把太陽一時藏起來是真的，但不是要熄滅它，它仍會再次照耀。這時那些雲滿載雨水，雨雲越烏黑，他們便越發可能帶來大量的雨灑。

我們怎會有無雨的雲？我們的困惑總會為我們帶來恩福，總會，因他們是神光明榮耀恩典的黑暗戰車。不多久雲兒必清空，每棵嬌嫩植物會因雨露而變得高興。我們的神會用憂傷浸泡我們，但祂必會用憐憫叫我們復甦。我們主充滿愛的信件常在黑暗信封中寄來，祂的馬車也許橫過天際隆隆作響，但滿載恩澤。祂的杖必芬芳花開，結成果實，因此讓我們不要擔憂雲兒了，反而我們來歌唱吧，因為四月的雲雨必會帶來五月的花兒。

主啊，「雲彩是祢腳下的塵土。」(鴻1:3)

司布真

八月十四日

「若不是從上頭賜給你的，你就毫無權柄辦我。」(約19:11)

有一個正經歷苦痛之深水的人寫給一個朋友以下的話：

無論事情看起來如何不公，甚或似乎是出於撒但自己的，就在它臨到我們之時，它必然是神的旨意，至終必會帶給我們益處。

「我們曉得萬事都互相效力，叫愛神的人得益處。」(羅8:28)
「我父所給我的那杯，我豈可不喝呢？」(約18:11)

漢娜·韋滔·史勿夫

August 15

We must go through many hardships to enter the kingdom of God. (Acts 14:22)

The best things in life are the result of being wounded. Wheat must be crushed before becoming bread, and incense must be burned by fire before its fragrance is set free. The earth must be broken with a sharp plow before being ready to receive the seed. And it is a broken heart that pleases God.

If you aspire to be a person of consolation, if you want to share the priestly gift of sympathy, if you desire to go beyond giving commonplace comfort to a heart that is tempted, and if you long to go through the daily exchanges of life with the kind of tact that never inflicts pain, then you must be prepared to pay the price for a costly education—for like Christ, you must suffer.

Frederick William Robertson

August 16

I waited patiently for the Lord. (Psalm 40:1)

Waiting is much more difficult than walking, for waiting requires patience, and patience is a rare virtue. We enjoy knowing that God builds hedges around His people, when we look at the hedge from the aspect of protection. But when we see it growing higher and higher until we can no longer see over it, we wonder if we will ever get out of our little sphere of influence and service, where we feel trapped. Sometimes it is hard for us to understand why we do not have a larger area of service, and it becomes difficult for us to “brighten the corner” where we are. But God has a purpose in all of His delays. “The steps of a good man are ordered by the Lord” (Ps. 37:23 KJV).

Next to this verse, in the margin of his Bible, George Muellermade this note: “And the stops too.” It is a sad mistake for someone to break through God’s hedges. It is a vital principle of the Lord’s guidance for a Christian never to move from the spot where he is sure God has placed him, until the “pillar of cloud” (Ex. 13:21) moves.

from Sunday School Times

It requires much more courage to stand and wait and still not lose heart or lose hope, to submit to the

八月十五日

「我們進入神的國，必須經歷許多艱難。」（徒14:22）

生命中最好的東西都是受傷所致的。麥子在作成麵包前定須壓碎，香料定須被燃燒才會釋放芬芳，泥土定須被尖犁所耕耙才準備好接收種子。同樣地一個破碎的心才會討神喜悅。

你若立志作一孤獨的人，你若想有分於傳教士嘗受的同情，你若渴望超越那些向受試煉的心靈給予平常安慰的人，你若期望用從不帶來痛苦的老練來過每日的交往時，那麼你定須準備好付上學習上的沉重代價，因為若要像基督的話，你定須受苦。

弗雷德裏克·威廉·魯賓斯坦

八月十六日

「我曾耐性等候耶和華。」（詩40:1）

等候比起走路難得多，因為等候需要忍耐，而忍耐是稀有的品德。我們樂於見到神在祂子民四圍築起樹籬，因我們看這樹籬為某方面的保護。但當樹籬越發增高，叫我們不能越籬外望時，因着感到被困，我們便會想着離開我們這細小的影響和服事範圍了。有時我們很難明白我們為何不能有更大的服事領域，對我們來說要在所在處「照明角落」是困難的。但神在祂所有的遲延上總是有目的的。「義人的腳步，被耶和華立定。」（詩37:23）

在喬治·慕勒的聖經寫着這筆記：「停步也是。」有人破樹籬而出，這是一無可救藥的錯誤。神引導一個基督徒時是永不會把他從神放置之處挪移的，這是一不可或缺的原則，除非「雲柱」（出13:21）移動。

摘自《主日學報》

站穩等待且不沮喪或失去盼望，降服於神的旨意，放棄工作的

will of God, to give up opportunities for work and leave honors to others, and to be quiet, confident, and rejoicing while the busy multitude goes happily along their way.

The greatest life is: “after you have done everything, to stand” (Eph. 6:13).

J. R. Miller

August 17

I have faith in God that it will happen just as he told me. (Acts 27:25)

A steamship captain who was a very devoted Christian said, “I had been on the bridge for twenty-four straight hours when George Mueller of Bristol, England, who was a passenger on board, came to me and said, ‘Captain, I need to tell you that I must be in Quebec on Saturday afternoon.’ ‘That is impossible,’ I replied. ‘Very well,’ Mueller responded, ‘if your ship cannot take me, God will find some other way, for I have never missed an engagement in fifty-seven years. Let’s go down to the chartroom to pray.’

“‘Mr. Mueller,’ I said, ‘do you realize how dense the fog is?’ ‘No,’ he replied. ‘My eye is not on the dense fog but on the living God, who controls every circumstance of my life.’

“He then knelt down and prayed one of the most simple prayers I’ve ever heard. As I looked at him, he said, ‘Captain, I have known my Lord for fifty-seven years, and there has never been even a single day that I have failed to get an audience with the King. Get up, Captain, and open the door, and you will see that the fog is gone.’ I got up, and indeed the fog was gone. And on Saturday afternoon George Mueller was in Quebec for his meeting.”

selected

August 18

The Lord alone led him. (Deuteronomy 32:12)

*A little while, and we will meet again
The loved and lost; but in the rapturous joy
Of greetings, such as here we cannot know,
And happy song, and heavenly embraces,*

*And tender recollections rushing back
Of life now passed, I think one memory*

機會，將榮譽讓與別人，在繁忙群眾沿途上開心行走時來安靜和確信所需的勇氣大得多。

「成就了一切，還能站立得住。」(弗6:13)是最偉大的生命。

J.R.米勒

八月十七日

「我信神，祂怎樣對我說：事情也要怎樣成就。」(徒27:25)

一十分虔誠的基督徒蒸氣船船長說：「當來自英國布里斯托的乘客喬治·慕勒來跟我說話時，我已站在駁橋上足有二十四小時。他說：『船長，我需告訴你我必須在星期六下午去到奎北克。』我回答說：『這是沒有可能的。』慕勒回應說：『既是這樣，你的船若不能載我去，神必會找到別的方法，因為五十七年來我未曾失過一次約。讓我們下去海圖室祈禱吧！』」

「我說：『慕勒先生，你知否霧現在多濃密？』『不，』他答道：『我眼不看濃霧，只看永活神，掌管我生命每個處境的那位。』」

「之後他便跪下作了一個我從未聽過很簡單的祈禱。當我望着他時，他說：『船長，我認識我的主有五十七年了，未曾有一日我不能與我的王到會眾處。起來吧，船長，打開門，你必會見到雲霧已散。』於是我起來，霧真的散了。在星期六下午喬治·慕勒去到奎北克他的聚會處。」

選

八月十八日

「耶和華獨自引導他。」(申32:12)

不多久我們必會與
所愛和失去之人重聚，
與如今我們不認識的人相見。
快樂之歌，天上的擁抱。

如今掠過的是生命溫馨的回憶。
我想有一比其餘更珍貴

*More dear and sacred than the rest, will rise,
And we who gather in the golden streets,
Will oft be stirred to speak with grateful love
Of that dark day Jesus called us to climb
Some narrow steep, leaning on Him alone.*

There is never a majestic mountain without a deep valley, and there is no birth without pain.

Daniel Crawford

August 19

Sorrowful, yet always rejoicing. (2 Corinthians 6:10)

Sorrow was beautiful, but his beauty was the beauty of the moonlight shining through the leafy branches of the trees in the woods.

Joy was beautiful, too, but hers was the radiant beauty of a summer morning.

Sorrow longingly said, "We can never be united as one." Yet even as Sorrow spoke, he and Joy became aware of someone standing beside them. In spite of the dim light, they sensed a kingly Presence, and suddenly a great and holy awe overwhelmed them. They then sank to their knees before Him.

"I see Him as the King of Joy," whispered Sorrow, "for on His head are many crowns, and the nailprints in His hands and feet are the scars of a great victory. And before Him all my sorrow is melting away into deathless love and gladness. I now give myself to Him forever."

"No, Sorrow," said Joy softly, "for I see Him as the King of Sorrow, and the crown on His head is a crown of thorns, and the nailprints in His hands and feet are the scars of terrible agony. I also give myself to Him forever, for sorrow with Him must be sweeter than any joy I have ever known."

"Then we are one in Him," they cried in gladness, "for no one but He could unite Joy and Sorrow." Therefore they walked hand in hand into the world, to follow Him through storms and sunshine, through winter's severe cold and the warmth of summer's gladness, and to be "sorrowful, yet always rejoicing."

August 20

Jacob was left alone, and a man wrestled with him till daybreak. (Genesis 32:24)

As Jacob "fell" from his old life, he fell into the

*更神聖的回憶會升起，
就是我們聚集在黃金街道的人
必會常因感恩的愛激動下來說到
耶穌呼召我們在黑暗之日登
又窄又陟斜的山路，獨倚祂同行。*

永不會有沒深谷的高山，也沒有不經歷痛苦而誕生的生命。

但以理·哥馥

八月十九日

「似乎憂愁，卻是常常快樂的。」
(林後6:10)

憂愁是美麗的，但那是月光穿越林中樹木樹葉枝桠般的美麗。

喜樂是美麗的，但她的美麗是散發夏日清晨之美麗的光芒。

憂傷渴望地說：「我們永不能合而為一。」就在憂愁說着時，他和喜樂都察覺到有人站在旁邊。雖然光線暗淡，他們感知是王者的來臨，一個大而神聖的敬畏忽爾漫過他們，他們於是屈膝跪在祂面前。

憂傷輕聲說：「我見到的祂是喜樂之王，在祂頭上有極多冠冕，祂手脚上的釘痕都是重大勝利的傷痕。在祂面前我所有的憂傷正在溶化和成為不死的愛和歡欣，我如今將我自己永遠呈獻給祂。」

喜樂柔聲說：「憂傷呀，不，我見到的祂是憂傷之王，在祂頭上的冠冕是荊棘之冕，祂手祂脚的釘痕都是極度痛苦的傷痕。我也叫我自己永遠獻給祂，因為與祂一起的憂傷總比我認識的喜樂更甜美。」

他們同聲歡呼：「那麼我們在祂裏頭是合一的了，因獨有祂能叫喜樂憂傷連合。」於是他們牽手步向世界，隨祂經過風暴和陽光，經過凜冽的寒冬和歡欣暖夏，成為「似乎憂愁，卻是常常快樂的。」

八月二十日

「只剩下雅各一人。有一個人來和他摔跤，直到黎明。」(創32:24)

當雅各跌離他的舊生命時，是

arms of God, clinging to Him but also wrestling until his blessing came. His blessing was that of a new life, so he rose from the earthly to the heavenly, the human to the divine, and the natural to the supernatural. From that morning forward, he was a weak and broken man from a human perspective, but God was there. And the Lord's heavenly voice proclaimed, "Your name will no longer be Jacob, but Israel, because you have struggled with God and with men and have overcome" (v. 28).

If God has called us to His highest and best, each of us will have a time of crisis, when all our resources will fail and when we face either ruin or something better than we have ever dreamed. But before we can receive the blessing, we must rely on God's infinite help. We must be willing to let go, surrendering completely to Him, and cease from our own wisdom, strength, and righteousness. We must be "crucified with Christ" (Gal. 2:20) and yet alive in Him. God knows how to lead us to the point of crisis, and He knows how to lead us through it.

And may it bring you into all that is meant by the revelation of "the Mighty One of Jacob" (Isa. 60:16)! There is no way out but God.

August 21

He brought me out into a spacious place; he rescued me because he delighted in me. (Psalm 18:19)

What is this "spacious place"? What can it be but God Himself—the infinite Being through whom all other beings find their source and their end of life? God is indeed a "spacious place." And it was through humiliation, degradation, and a sense of worthlessness that David was taken to it.

Madame Guyon

I carried you on eagles' wings and brought you to myself. Exodus 19:4

August 22

The rest were to get there on planks or on pieces of the ship. In this way everyone reached land in safety. (Acts 27:44)

It is a common misconception that the Christian's walk of faith is strewn with flowers and that when God intervenes in the lives of His people, He does so in such a wonderful way as to always lift us out of our

跌在神的手臂中，既纏且摔跤，直至他的祝福來到為止。他的祝福是一新生命，因此他從屬地升進屬靈；由屬人升進神聖；由自然升進超自然。從那一刻起，於人看他是軟弱和破碎的人，但神在那裏。神自天上宣佈說：「你的名不要再叫雅各，要叫以色列，因為你與神與人較力，都得了勝。」(創32:28)

神若呼召我們到祂至高至榮美之處，我們每一個便來到所有倚靠都失效的關鍵時刻，所面對的不是敗落便是比從來能夢想更好的東西。在我們得着祝福前，定須靠賴神無限的幫助。我們須放手，完全降服於祂，停止一己智慧、力量和義。我們必須「與基督同釘十字架」(加2:20)，卻仍在祂裏面活。神知如何領我們來到這關鍵時刻，祂也知如何領我們經過。

但願這把你領進「雅各的大能者」(賽60:16)所啟示的全面意義！除了神之外別無出路。

八月二十一日

「祂又領我到寬闊之處。祂救拔我，因祂喜悅我。」(詩18:19)

「寬闊之處」是甚麼？除了所有存在物從中得着他們的供應和生命歸宿的神自己這位無限者之外，還會是誰？神真的是「寬闊之處」。大衛是藉着屈辱、貶降和感到無價值來被帶到那處的。

蓋恩夫人

「我如鷹將你們背在翅膀上，帶來歸我。」(出19:4)

八月二十二日

「其餘的人，可以用板子，或船上的零碎東西上岸。這樣眾人都得了救上了岸。」(徒27:44)

常有誤解以為基督徒信心之路花香常漫，以為有神介入其生命之人亦一樣在困難的環境中總會因神奇的方法而得以脫離。但事實

difficult surroundings. In actual fact, however, the real experience is quite the opposite.

Because of his testimony given in Damascus, Paul was hunted down by persecutors and forced to flee for his life. God worked a simple way of escape for Paul: "His followers took him by night and lowered him in a basket through an opening in the wall" (Acts 9:25).

We see him left for days to toss upon a stormy sea and compelled to protect a treacherous sailor. And finally, once his deliverance comes, it is not by way of some heavenly ship sailing from the skies to rescue this illustrious prisoner. Nor is there an angel who comes walking on the water to still the raging sea. There is no supernatural sign at all of surpassing greatness being carried out, for one man is required to grab a piece of the mast to survive, another a floating timber, another a small fragment of the shipwreck, and yet another is forced to swim for his life.

God's promises and His providence do not lift us from the world of common sense and everyday trials, for it is through these very things that our faith is perfected. And it is in this world that God

loves to interweave the golden threads of His love with the twists and turns of our common, everyday experiences.

from Hard Places in the Way of Faith

August 23

By faith Abraham ... obeyed and went, even though he did not know where he was going. (Hebrews 11:8)

This is faith without sight. Seeing is not faith but reasoning. When crossing the Atlantic by ship, how had our course been so precisely plotted? Every day, our captain had taken his instruments, looked to the sky, and determined his course by the sun. He was sailing using heavenly lights, not earthly ones.

And the steps of faith often lead to total uncertainty or even darkness and disaster, but the Lord will open the way and often makes the darkest of midnight hours as bright as the dawning of the day.

from Days of Heaven upon Earth

Remember, after the words "In the beginning" (Gen. 1:1) comes the word "God." It is our first step

上，經驗上倒是恰恰相反的。

因着大馬色所作的見證，保羅被迫害者追捕，被逼逃命。神用一個簡單的方法來叫保羅得逃脫：「他的門徒就在夜間，用筐子把他從城牆上縋下去。」（徒9:25）

我們見到他多日來在風暴的海洋中拋來拋去，被迫要保護一個不忠的水手。最終他的解救來到，卻不是藉差來的天船來拯救這著名的囚犯，亦不是藉着在水上走來的天使來平靜風浪。沒有顯赫事件，沒有超自然的景象發生，只見一人需抓住桅杆來保命，另一個抓着一根浮木，又一個抓着船隻殘骸的破件，更有人逼住要泅水保命。

神的應許和帶領不會叫我們脫離世人的常理和每天的試煉，因為正正是藉着這些東西來叫我們的信心得完全的。神就喜愛在今世用祂愛的金線與我們日常共同經歷的線擰扭在一起。

摘自《信心之路》的《艱難之地》

八月二十三日

「亞伯拉罕因着信……遵命出去，……出去的時候，還不知往哪裏去。」（來11:8）

這是不見的信心。看見不是信心，而是情理。有一次我乘船橫渡大西洋。我們的走向何以如此精確計算？原來船長每天用儀器望向天際，藉太陽決定方向。他不是利用地上而是天上的光來航行的。

信心的步履時常引往全不肯定，甚至黑暗和災難中去，然而主必會開闢前路，時常使午夜最黑暗的時刻變成如日出之光明。

摘自《在地若天的生活》

謹記「起初」之後就是「神」這個字（創1:1）。這就是我們信

of faith that turns the key in the lock of His powerhouse. It is true that God helps those who help themselves, but He also helps those who are helpless. So no matter your circumstance, you can depend on Him every time.

August 24

I have received full payment and even more. (Philippians 4:18)

There are Christians who seem to blossom when their material circumstances become the most harsh and severe. They grow in the darkness and shade.

When he wrote the above verse, he was a prisoner in Rome. The primary mission of his life appeared to have been broken. But it was in this persistent darkness that flowers began to show their faces in bright and fascinating glory.

Among those treasures were such wonderful things as Christ's grace, love, joy, and peace, and it seemed as though they had needed the circumstance of darkness to draw out their secret and inner glory. The dark and dingy prison had become the home of the revealed truth of God, and Paul began to realize as never before the width and the wealth of his spiritual inheritance.

"The desert and the parched land will be glad; the wilderness will rejoice and blossom" (Isa. 35:1).

John Henry Jowett

August 25

Before this faith came, we were held prisoners ... , locked up until faith should be revealed. (Galatians 3:23)

God still causes us to be "locked up until faith" is learned. Our own nature, circumstances, trials, and disappointments all serve to keep us submissive and "locked up" until we see that the only way out is His way of faith. Moses attempted the deliverance of his people by using self-effort, his personal influence, and even violence. So God "locked [him] up" for forty years in the wilderness before he was prepared for His work.

Paul and Silas were called of God to preach the gospel in Europe. In Philippi they were "severely flogged, they were thrown into prison, and the jailer ... fastened their feet in the stocks" (Acts 16:23-24). They were "locked up" to faith. They trusted God and

心的第一步，轉動鎖匙來開啟祂能源庫之門。神幫助那些幫助自己的人是對的，但祂也幫助那些無助之人。因此無論你環境如何，你也能在每刻倚靠祂。

八月二十四日

「但我樣樣都有，並且有餘。」(腓4:18)

有基督徒在他們物質環境變得嚴峻和艱難時生命似乎更璀璨。他們在漆黑和幽暗中生長。

當他寫以上的經文時，他是在羅馬作囚犯的。他生命的首要任務似乎已被破壞了。但就在這持久的黑暗中花兒開始展現他們臉上的光明和使人艷羨的榮耀。

在這些寶藏中有美妙的東西，例如基督的恩惠、愛、喜樂與和平，這些似乎都需要黑暗的環境來提取出他們奧妙和內裏的榮耀。黑暗和骯髒的囚牢已成為神彰顯真理的居室。保羅開始明瞭到他屬靈生命從來未知曉的深度和豐盛。

「曠野和乾旱之地，必然歡喜；沙漠也必快樂，又像玫瑰開花。」(賽35:1)

約翰·亨利·祖屈

八月二十五日

「但這因信得救的理還未來以先，我們被看守在律法之下，直圈到那將來的真道顯明出來。」(加3:23)

神一直使我們被看守直至學會信。我們自己的天性、環境、試煉和失望全都使我們降服和被看守，直至我們得見唯一的出路就是信神這路。摩西嘗試藉一己之力，個人的影響力甚至藉暴力來拯救他的人民，因此神把他看守在曠野四十年，來準備作祂的工作。

保羅和西拉被呼召到歐洲傳福音。他們在腓立比被「打了許多棍，便將他們下在監裏，囑咐禁卒嚴緊看守。……兩腳上了木狗。」(徒16:23-24) 他們被看守至信。就在

sang praises to Him in their darkest hour, and God brought deliverance and salvation.

The apostle John was also “locked up” to faith, when he was banished to the Isle of Patmos. And if he had never been sent there, he would never have seen such glorious visions of God.

Praise Him “that in all things God works for the good of those who love him” (Rom. 8:28) and that He “acts on behalf of those who wait for Him” (Isa. 64:4). God will send you blessings and help, and will reveal truths to you that otherwise would never have come your way. And many others will also receive great insights and blessings because you were “locked up” to learn the way of faith.

C. H. P.

August 26

It is not in me. (Job 28:14)

You can never expect to keep an eagle in the forest. You might be able to gather a group of the most beautiful birds around him, provide a perch for him on the tallest pine, or enlist other birds to bring him the choicest of delicacies, but he will reject them all. He will spread his proud wings and, with his eye on an Alpine cliff, soar away to his own ancestral halls of rock, where storms and waterfalls make their natural music.

Our soul longs to soar as an eagle and will find rest with nothing short of the Rock of Ages. Its ancestral halls are the halls of heaven, made with the rock of the attributes of God. And the span of its majestic flight is eternity! “Lord, YOU have been our dwelling place throughout all generations” (Ps. 90:1).

J. R. Macduff

August 27

He took him aside, away from the crowd. (Mark 7:33)

Even the most majestic bird, which soars higher than all others and endures the longest flights, will sink into despair when placed in a cage, where it is forced to helplessly beat its wings against its prison bars.

To see Paul in prison is to see another side of life. He even signed his name to his letters—not as the prisoner of Festus, nor of Caesar, and not as a victim of the Sanhedrin, but as “a prisoner for the Lord” (Eph. 4:1).

他們最黑暗之時他們信靠神而歌唱讚美祂，神也帶給他們釋放和拯救。

當使徒約翰被放逐到拔摩海島時，他也被看守在信裏頭。他若不是送到那裏，他永遠不得看見神如此榮耀的異象。

為着「我們曉得萬事都互相效力，叫愛神的人得益處」(羅8:28)和「為等候祂的人行事」(賽64:4)來讚美祂。神必會差來恩福和幫助，必會向你揭示真理，否則困難永不會臨到你。也有多人因着你在被看守而學會信的方法，和得着極大的領悟。

C.H.P.

八月二十六日

「不在我內。」(伯28:14)

你從未曾想到在森林中飼養鷹鳥。你也許能聚集一群最美麗的鳥兒來環繞牠，為牠提供最高的松樹作為牠的棲木，或徵募其他雀鳥為牠帶來最上選的美味，但牠會全部拒絕。牠必會伸展其驕傲之翼，把眼目注視阿爾卑斯其中一個山崖，飛向牠祖上的群石禮堂，那裏風暴和瀑布成為牠們天然的音樂。

我們的靈魂期望如鷹翔，除了萬古磐石外，便找不到安息之所。鷹兒的古老禮堂是天家的禮堂，是用神屬性之石造成的，其王者之飛翔延展至永遠！「主阿，祢世代代作我們的居所。」(詩90:1)

J.R.麥道夫

八月二十七日

「耶穌領他離開眾人，到一邊去。」(可7:33)

當比其他雀鳥飛得更高更長更尊貴的雀鳥被放進鳥籠時也會墮進絕望中，被逼無助地用翅膀拍打籠枝。

看着在囚房中的保羅得見生命的另一面。他在信件中的署名不是非斯都的囚犯，不是該撒的囚犯，也不是公會所逼害的，而是「為主被囚的」(弗4:1)。

For twelve long years, John Bunyan's voice was silenced in an English jail in Bedford. Yet it was there he wrote the greatest work of his life, *Pilgrim's Progress*—read by more people than any other book except the Bible. He once said, "I was at home in prison, and my great joy led me to sit and write and write." And the darkness of his long captivity became a wonderful dream to light the path of millions of weary pilgrims.

Madam Guyon, the sweet-spirited French saint, endured a lengthy time behind prison walls. And like the sounds of some caged birds whose songs are more beautiful as a result of their confinement, the music of her soul has traveled far beyond her dungeon walls to remove the sadness of many discouraged hearts.

S. C. Rees

August 28

There He tested them. (Exodus 15:25)

I once visited the testing room of a large steel mill. I was surrounded by instruments and equipment that tested pieces of steel to their limits and measured their breaking point. Some pieces had been twisted until they broke, and then were labeled with the level of pressure they could withstand. Some had been stretched to their breaking point, with their level of strength also noted. Others had been compressed to their crushing point and measured. Because of the testing, the manager of the mill knew exactly how much stress and strain each piece of steel could endure if it was used to build a ship, building, or bridge.

God wants us to be like these toughened pieces of steel, able to endure twisting and crushing pressure to the utmost without collapse.

J. H. M.

It is quite easy for us to talk and to theorize about faith, but God often puts us into His crucible of affliction to test the purity of our gold and to separate the dross from the metal. How happy we are if the hurricanes that blow across life's raging sea have the effect of making Jesus more precious to us! It is better to weather the storm with Christ than to sail smooth waters without Him.

J. R. Macduff

本仁·約翰因着囚於英國百得福監獄十二年而閉口，然而他就在那裏寫下他生命中最偉大的著作《天路歷程》，讀者人數除了聖經外比任何書籍更多。有一次他說：「在獄中就像在家一樣，我的大喜樂使我坐下寫完又寫。」他長期囚禁的黑暗成為一奇妙的夢來照明百萬計疲乏天路客的路途。

美好靈性的法國聖徒蓋因夫人在囚室中忍受很長的年日，就像被囚籠中的鳥因牢籠的緣故使他們的歌兒越發美妙，蓋因夫人生命的旋律越過囚牢的圍牆而行，除去眾多受挫心靈的憂傷。

S.C.利士

八月二十八日

「耶和華在那裏……試驗他們，」
(出15:25)

有一次我走訪一間大鋼鐵工場的測試房。環繞我的儀器和器材，都是用來測試每件鋼鐵的極限和量度他們的折破點。有一些被扭曲至折斷，之後標上他們能耐得住的壓力程度，有一些被壓和量度他們的毀壞點。藉着測試，工場的經理便清楚知道用來造船、大廈或橋樑的每件鋼鐵能耐上多少力度和拉力。

神想我們像那些強韌的鋼鐵件，能耐得住扭動和擠壓至極而不至崩斷。

J.H.M.

引經據典來談及信頗容易，但神常把我們放入祂痛苦的熔爐中來測試我們金子的純度，和將金屬中的浮渣分隔出來。吹襲我們生命怒海上的颶風叫耶穌於我們更珍貴時，這是何等快樂啊！與基督一起來經受暴風總好過祂不同在的情況下風平浪靜的航行。

J.R.麥道夫

August 29

Carrying his own cross. (John 19:17)

A weary woman who thought that the cross she must bear surely was heavier than those of other people, so she wished she could choose another person's instead. The most beautiful one was covered with jewels and gold. "This I could wear with comfort," she said. So she picked it up, but her weak body staggered beneath its weight. The jewels and gold were beautiful, yet they were much too heavy for her to carry.

The next cross she noticed was quite lovely, with beautiful flowers entwined around its sculptured form, but beneath the flowers were large thorns that pierced and tore her skin.

Finally she came to a plain cross without jewels or any carvings and with only a few words of love inscribed on it. When she picked it up, it proved to be better than all the rest, and the easiest to carry. And as she looked at it, she noticed it was bathed in a radiance that fell from heaven. Then she recognized it as her own old cross. She had found it once again, and it was the best of all, and the lightest for her.

from Glimpses through Life's Windows

August 30

Others went out on the sea in ships; they were merchants on the mighty waters. They saw the works of the Lord, his wonderful deeds in the deep. (Psalm 107:23-24)

Remember, our faith is always at its greatest point when we are in the middle of the trial, and confidence in the flesh will never endure testing. Fair-weather faith is not faith at all.

Charles H. Spurgeon

August 31

Blessed are those who have not seen and yet have believed. (John 20:29)

How important it is for God to keep us focused on things that are unseen, for we are so easily snared by the things we can see! If a bird is going to fly, it must stay away from fences and trees, trusting the buoyancy of its wings. And if it tries to stay within easy reach of the ground, it will never fly very well.

God had to bring Abraham to the end of his own

八月二十九日

「*背着自己的十字架。*」(約19:17)

一個疲憊的婦人想到她所背負的肯定重過他人的十字架，因此她想望能選擇別人的十字架。她選擇那最美麗的一個是鑲滿珠寶和黃金的。她便說：「這個我能舒服地背負。」於是她去拿起，但她軟弱的身軀在其重量下搖晃。珠寶和金子是美麗的，但於她來說背負實在太沉重了。

第二個她所留意的十字架頗為可愛，四圍刻滿美麗的花兒，但在花兒下面有大荊棘刺破她的皮膚。

最後她來到一個平平無奇，既沒珠寶或雕刻，只寫上幾個愛的字詞的十字架。她拿起它，證實好過其餘一切，也最輕易背負。她看見和注意到它沐浴在從天來的光中，之後她察覺它就是她本來的舊十字架。她再次找着它，它也是眾多十字架中最好，最輕省的。

摘自《窺探生命之窗》

八月三十日

「*在海上坐船，在大水中經理事務的。他們看見耶和華的作為，並祂在深水中的奇事。*」(詩107:23-24)

謹記，我們的信總是在我們來到試煉時才去到頂峰，肉體中的確定永不能忍受試煉。風平浪靜的信心完全不是信心。

司布真

八月三十一日

「*那沒有看見就信的，有福了。*」(約20:29)

我們太容易陷在我們可見事物的圈套中，因此神叫我們持續聚焦在不可見事物何等重要！雀鳥要飛翔便須離開樹籬，相信牠雙翼的浮力；牠若嘗試與地面保持可觸碰的距離時，便永不會飛得好。

神要領亞伯拉罕來到他能力

strength and let him see that with his own body he could do nothing. He had to consider his own body “as good as dead” (Heb. 11:12) and then trust God to do all the work. When he looked away from himself and trusted only God, he became “fully persuaded that God had power to do what he had promised” (Rom. 4:21).

A. B. Simpson

September 1

I will build you with stones of turquoise. (Isaiah 54:11)

The stones in the wall said, “We have come from mountains far away—from the sides of rugged cliffs. Fire and water have worked on us for ages but have only produced crevices. Yet human hands like yours have made us into homes where children of your immortal race are born, suffer, rejoice, find rest and shelter, and learn the lessons that our Maker and yours is teaching. But to come to the point of being used for this purpose, we have endured much. Dynamite has torn at our very heart, and pickaxes have broken and split us into pieces. Often as we lay disfigured and broken in the quarry, everything seemed to be without design or meaning. But gradually we were cut into blocks, and some of us were chiseled with sharper instruments until we had a fine edge. Now we are complete, are in our proper places, and are of service.

September 2

It has been granted to you ... to suffer for him. (Philippians 1:29)

Richard Baxter, the seventeenth-century Puritan preacher, once said, “O God, I thank You for the discipline I have endured in this body for fifty-eight years.” And he certainly is not the only person who has turned trouble into triumph. Soon the school of our heavenly Father will close for us, for the end of the school term is closer every day. May we never run from a difficult lesson or flinch from the rod of discipline. Richer will be our crown, and sweeter will heaven be, if we cheerfully endure to the end. Then we will graduate in glory.

Theodore L. Cuyler

的盡頭，讓他得見他自己身體無可作為了。他必須看他一己的身體「彷彿已死的人」（來11:12），便在一件事上完全信靠神了。當他不再看自己，只信靠神時，他便變得「滿心相信，神所應許的必能作成。」（羅4:21）

宣信

九月一日

「我必以彩色安置你的石頭，以藍寶石立定你的根基。」（賽54:11）

牆上的石頭說：「我們來自遠方高山那巍峨的懸崖邊。火與水世紀以來作工在我們身上，但只做成裂縫。然而像你有的人手把我們改造，放進家室中，你不朽種族的兒女在那裏出生、受苦、歡欣，找到安息和蔭庇，學會了造你造我之創造主的教訓。但若要進而去到在這目的下被使用這點時，我們定須忍受更多。炸藥在我們心中炸裂，鶴咀鎚把心鋤開，破成碎片。我們在石坑中長時在破相和碎裂下攤放着，每一個似乎都沒設計和意義。但漸漸地我們被分割成石料，我們有些被更鋒利的器具削鑿，直至我們邊錘圓滑了。如今我們完備了，安放合適的地方，有用武之地了。

九月二日

「因為你們蒙恩……要為祂受苦。」（腓1:29）

十七世紀清教徒傳道者李察·巴克斯特曾說：「神啊，為着五十八年來祢叫我在這身體上所忍受的管教來感謝祢。」肯定他不是唯一一人能把困難變成勝利。不久天父的學校會為我們而關閉，因為學期結束一天近似一天了。願我們永不逃避困難的課堂，在管教杖下退縮；我們若歡欣忍耐到底，那麼冠冕便更榮美，天家必會甜美了，那時我們便會在榮耀中畢業。

西奧多·L·佳拿

The world's finest china is fired in ovens at

世上最優美的瓷器最少在爐

least three times, and some many more. It is necessary to fire the china three times so the gold, crimson, and other colors are brighter, more beautiful, and permanently attached.

Cortland Myers

September 3

He saw the disciples straining at the oars. (Mark 6:48)

Straining and striving does not accomplish the work God gives us to do. Only God Himself, who always works without stress and strain and who never overworks, can do the work He assigns to His children. When we restfully trust Him to do it, the work will be completed and will be done well. And the way to let Him do His work through us is to so fully abide in Christ by faith that He fills us to overflowing.

A man who learned this secret once said, "I came to Jesus and drank, and I believe I will never be thirsty again. My life's motto has become 'Not overwork but overflow,' and it has already made all the difference in my life."

There is no straining effort in an overflowing life, and it is quietly irresistible. It is the normal life of omnipotent and ceaseless accomplishment into which Christ invites each of us to enter—today and always.

from Sunday School Times

September 4

When you hear them sound a long blast on the trumpets, have all the people give a loud shout; then the wall of the city will collapse and the people will go up, every man straight in. (Joshua 6:5)

Of all "the secret[s] of the Lord" (Ps. 25:14 KJV), I do not believe there are any more valuable than the secret of this "loud shout" of faith. "The Lord said to Joshua, 'See, I have delivered Jericho into your hands, along with its king and its fighting men'" (Josh. 6:2).

No one would normally believe that a shout could cause city walls to fall. Yet the secret of their victory lay precisely in just that shout, for it was the shout of faith.

God had declared, "I have delivered Jericho into your hands," and faith believed this to be true. And many centuries later the Holy Spirit recorded this triumph of faith in the book of Hebrews as follows: "By faith the walls of Jericho fell, after the people had

中燒過三遍，有些更多。需要火燒三次來使金色、緋紅色和其他顏色更鮮明、更美麗和更永久黏附。

科特蘭·邁爾斯

九月三日

「看見門徒，因風不順，搖櫓甚苦。」(可6:48)

勞苦和奮力不能作成神給我們作的工。惟有從來在沒有壓力和緊張下作工和永不會過勞的神自己能作成祂指派給祂兒女的工作。當我們安心信靠祂來作時，那工必會完成，且會做得好。讓祂藉我們作成祂工，就是用信來完全住在基督裏，讓祂充滿我們至溢瀉。

一個學會這秘訣之人曾說：「我來到耶穌處飲用，相信我永不再渴。我生命的座右銘『不是過勞，而是滿溢』，自此我生命便完全改變了。」

滿溢生命中沒有勞苦拉力，而有靜中堅強。基督邀請我們每個進入事事皆能和不停成就工夫的正常生命，今日如是，永遠如是。

摘自《主日學報》

九月四日

「他們吹的角聲拖長，你們聽見角聲，眾百姓要大聲呼喊，城牆就必塌陷，各人都要往前直上。」(書6:5)

在「耶和華的秘密」(詩25:14)中，沒有比耶和華對約書亞所說信的呼喊更有價值。「看哪！我已經把耶利哥和耶利哥的王，並大能的勇士都交在你手中。」(書6:2)

通常沒有人會相信呼喊能叫城牆倒塌。然而他們得勝的秘密正正在於呼喊，因為那是信心的呼喊。

神曾宣告：「我已經把耶利哥交在你手中。」信心相信這是真的。多個世紀後聖靈在希伯來書記錄這信心的得勝：「以色列人因着信，圍繞耶利哥城七日，城牆就倒

marched around them for seven days” (Heb. 11:30).
Hannah Whitall Smith

September 5

Blessed are all who wait for him! (Isaiah 30:18)

We often hear about waiting on God, which actually means that He is waiting until we are ready. There is another side, however. When we wait for God, we are waiting until He is ready.

Some people say, and many more believe, that as soon as we meet all His conditions, God will answer our prayer. They teach that He lives in an eternal now, that with Him there is no past or future, and that if we can fulfill all He requires to be obedient to His will, immediately our needs will be met, our desires satisfied, and our prayers answered.

A petition presented to God is like a seed dropped into the ground. Forces above and beyond our control must work on it until the actual accomplishment of the answer.

from The Still Small Voice

And Patience was willing to wait.

from Pilgrim's Progress

September 6

You remain. (Hebrews 1:11)

There are so many people sit alone so much, but there is someone who is unseen and just within their reach. But for some reason, they don't realize His presence. The rain or thick fog outside, the lack of sleep and the intense pain, seem to affect their mood and blur their vision so they do not realize His presence.

So recognize the presence of the Master. He is here, close to you, and His presence is real. Recognizing will also help your ability to realize but is never dependent upon it.

Samuel Dickey Gordon

September 7

God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in trouble. (Psalm 46:1)

“Why didn't God help me sooner?” “I will be with him in trouble, I will deliver him and honor him” (Ps.

塌了。」(來11:30)
漢娜·韋滔·史勿夫

九月五日

「凡等候祂的，都是有福的。」(賽30:18)

我們常聽人說等候神，其實是祂等候我們，直到我們準備好。但有另一方面的。當我們等候神時，我們是在等候直至祂準備好。

有人說和多人相信，我們一旦符合神的條件時，祂必會垂聽我們的祈禱。他們教導說祂活在永存的現今，就是說於祂來說是沒有過去和未來的；並且我們若能在一切事上服從祂的旨意時，我們必立時得所需，願望得滿足，祈禱得回應。

向神獻上的祈求就像落在地上的種子一樣，必須有在我們上頭和我們控制能力以外的能力來作工，直到這代求得着實在的成就。

摘自《那溫柔的微聲》

忍耐是樂意等候的。

摘自《天路歷程》

九月六日

「祢卻要長存。」(來1:11)

有太多人久久獨坐，然而有一個看不見卻在他們可接觸的範圍內。但為着某些原因，他們不知道祂的同在。外頭的雨水或厚霧、睡眠不足和劇烈痛楚似乎都影響到他們的情緒，弄至他們視覺模糊，因而不知道祂的同在。

承認主的同在吧。祂就在這裏，與你相近，因此祂的同在是真實的。承認也必會使你有知道的能力，不過不用再倚賴它吧了。

撒母耳·迪奇·哥頓

九月七日

「神是我們的避難所，是我們的力量，是我們在患難中隨時的幫助。」(詩46:1)

「為何神不早點來幫助我？」
「他在急難中，我要與他同在。我

91:15). He will be with you in trouble all day and through the night. Afterward He will take you out of it, but not until you have stopped being restless and worried over it and have become calm and quiet. Then He will say, "It is enough."

There is a sweet joy and a real value in difficulties, for He regards them not as difficulties but as opportunities.

selected

When God tests you, it is a good time to test Him by putting His promises to the test and then claiming from Him exactly what your trials have made necessary.

There are two ways of getting out of a trial. One is simply to try to get rid of the trial, and then to be thankful when it is over. The other is to recognize the trial as a challenge from God to claim a larger blessing than we have ever before experienced, and to accept it with delight as an opportunity of receiving a greater measure of God's divine grace.

In this way, even the Adversary becomes a help to us, and all the things that seem to be against us turn out to assist us along our way. "In all these things we are more than conquerors through Him who loved us" (Rom. 8:37).

A. B. Simpson

September 8

Thou hast enlarged me when I was in distress. (Psalm 4:1 KJV)

The psalmist is declaring that the sorrows of life have themselves been the source of life's enlargement.

When Joseph, who had only experienced the glitter of gold, was in the dungeon, "iron entered his soul."

Your life will be enlarged in proportion to the amount of iron you have endured, for it is in the shadows of your life that you will find the actual fulfillment of your dreams of glory.

George Matheson

If Joseph had never been Egypt's prisoner, he would have never been Egypt's governor. The iron chain that bound his feet brought about the golden chain around his neck.

要搭救他，使他尊貴。」(詩91:15) 你遇上困難時祂終日終夜必與你同在，把你從中帶出來，就在你停止坐立不安和終日擔憂，已平靜安穩之時。那時祂必說：「夠了。」

困惑中是有甜美的喜樂和其價值的，因為祂不以他們為困難，而是機會。

選

當神試煉我時，這也是試驗祂的好時機，試驗一下祂的應許。正正照所受的試煉來向祂索求便變得有其需要。

有兩個方法得脫離試煉。其一簡單不過，嘗試除去那試煉，當試煉過去後便獻上感謝。另一方法是認定那試煉是來自神的挑戰，叫你索求我們從未經驗過的大恩福，欣然接受那試煉作為一個機遇來獲取神更大程度的聖恩。

這樣的話，連仇敵魔鬼也成為我們的幫助，所有似乎與我們作對的東西轉過來沿途幫助我們。「然而靠着愛我們的主，在这一切的事上，已經得勝有餘了。」(羅8:37)

宣信

九月八日

「我在困苦中，祢曾使我寬廣。」(詩4:1)

詩人宣稱人生憂傷本身成為人生擴展之源。

當前期只經歷過金子光輝的約瑟在囚牢中時，「鐵進入了他的生命」。

你生命的擴展與你曾受的苦成正比，因為是你生命中所投的黑影才能找着你夢想榮耀的真正成就。

喬治·馬得勝

若約瑟未曾作過埃及的囚犯，他便永不能成為埃及的宰相。是鎖銬他的鐵鍊為他帶來圍繞他頸項的金鍊。

September 9

Some [seed] fell on rocky places, where it did not have much soil. It sprang up quickly, because the soil was shallow. (Matthew 13:5)

The shallow people are those who “did not have much soil”—those who have no real purpose in life and are easily swayed by a tender appeal, a good sermon, or a simple melody.

When a Roman soldier was told by his guide that if he insisted on taking a certain journey, it would probably be fatal, he answered, “It is necessary for me to go—it is not necessary for me to live.”

Once God has deepened us, He can give us His deepest truths, His most profound secrets, and will trust us with greater power.

September 10

The Lord will fulfill his purpose for me. (Psalm 138:8)

When a person who suffers reaches a point where he can be calm and carefree, inwardly smiling at his own suffering, and no longer asking God to be delivered from it, then the suffering has accomplished its blessed ministry, perseverance has “finish[ed] its work” (James 1:4), and the pain of the Crucifixion has begun to weave itself into a crown. It is in this experience of complete suffering that the Holy Spirit works many miraculous things deep within our soul. In this condition, our entire being lies perfectly still under the hand of God; every power and ability of the mind, will, and heart are at last submissive; a quietness of eternity settles into the entire soul.

He can now let the circumstances be what they may, and continue to seek only God and His will, with the calm assurance that He is causing everything in the universe, whether good or bad, past or present, to work “for the good of those who love him” (Rom. 8:28).

from Soul Food

The main thing is to suffer without becoming discouraged.

François Fénelon

九月九日

「有落在土淺石頭地上的。土既不深，發苗最快。」(太13:5)

淺薄的人「土既不深」，他們沒真正的生命目標，輕易被一個親切的呼籲、一堂好講道、或一簡單的旋律所動搖。

當一個羅馬士兵被指揮官問到若硬要他走某個可能致命的旅程時會如何，他回答說：「我必須要去，但我不是必須去活。」

神一旦使我們進深，必會給我們祂最深的真理和最深度秘訣，也必會把更大的能力交託我們。

九月十日

「耶和華必成全關乎我的事。」(詩138:8)

當一個受苦的人來到他能夠平靜和處之泰然，內裏笑向他一己的受苦，不再求神來叫他得脫離這苦時，那麼這苦已成就它賜恩的任務，堅忍已「成功」(雅1:4)，釘十字架的痛楚已開始把自己編織成為一個冠冕了。就是這樣經歷完全的受苦叫聖靈在我們的生命深處作成很多奇妙的工作。在這情況下，我們的整位完全在神的手下靜止，思想、意志和心的每一個力量和能力都至終呈獻，一個永恆的寧靜居住在整個生命之中。

他如今能任讓環境如何，繼續但尋求神和祂的旨意，平實確定是祂使宇宙中的無論善惡、過去或現在的萬事萬物，作成「叫愛神的人得益處」(羅8:28)

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摘自《靈魂的食物》

在不致沮喪下受苦才是大事。

范哥·費尼南

September 11

After waiting patiently, Abraham received what was promised. (Hebrews 6:15)

Abraham was tested for a very long time, but he was richly rewarded. The Lord tested him by delaying the fulfillment of His promise. Satan tested him through temptation, and people tested him through their jealousy, distrust, and opposition to him. Sarah tested him through her worrisome temperament. Yet he patiently endured, not questioning God's truthfulness and power or doubting God's faithfulness and love. Instead, Abraham submitted to God's divine sovereignty and infinite wisdom. And he was silent through many delays, willing to wait for the Lord's timing. Having patiently endured, he then obtained the fulfillment of the promise.

selected

September 12

Who is this coming up from the desert leaning on her lover? (Song of Songs 8:5)

As one man prayed, he asked the Lord for various blessings, just as you or I would, and he thanked the Lord for many blessings already received, just as you or I would. But he closed his prayer with this unusual petition: "And O Lord, support us! Yes, support us on every leaning side!"

He saw God as always walking alongside the Christian, ready to extend His mighty arm to steady the weak on "every leaning side."

September 13

In the morning ... come up.... Present yourself to me there on top of the mountain. (Exodus 34:2)

Blessed is the day when the morning is sanctified—set apart to God! Successful is the day when the first victory is won in prayer! Holy is the day when the dawn finds me on the mountaintop with God!

Joseph Parker

My mother made it a habit every day, immediately after breakfast, to spend an hour in her room, reading the Bible, meditating over it, and praying to the Lord. That hour was like a blessed fountain from which she drew the strength and

九月十一日

「這樣，亞伯拉罕既恆久忍耐，就得了所應許的。」(來6:15)

亞伯拉罕被試煉了一段長時間，但得的也是豐富的獎賞。主藉遲延成就祂所應許的來試煉他，撒但藉引誘來試探他，人們也試探他，是藉他們對他的嫉妒、猜疑和反對。撒拉藉着使人厭煩的脾氣來試探他。然而他耐性地忍受，不質問神的誠信和權力，也不質疑神的信實和愛。反之，亞伯拉罕降服於神的神聖主權和無限智慧。在眾多的遲延中他都是沉默的，甘心按主的定時來等候。因着耐性的忍受，他使得着應許的成就。

選

九月十二日

「那靠着良人從曠野上來的，是誰呢？」(歌8:5)

有一個人祈禱，像你我一樣為着不同的恩福來祈求主；像你一樣為眾多已得的恩福來感謝主。但他禱告的結束有這不尋常的祈求：「主啊，支持我們！是的，在每一個傾跌的那邊支持我們！」

他見到神如常的傍着基督徒在行走，準備好伸出祂大能的膀臂在「傾跌的那邊」穩托每個弱者。

九月十三日

「明日早晨，你要預備好了，上西乃山，在山頂上站在我面前。」(出34:2)

因早晨撥留給神而得聖化之日是何等蒙福！藉祈禱而得第一項勝利的那日是何等成功的一日！黎明時在山頂與神相會的一日是何等神聖的一日！

約瑟·柏加

我母親有一個每天的習慣，在早餐後立即用一個小時進到她的房子中，讀聖經，默想和禱告主。這小時就像一個恩泉，使她從中汲取力量和甜美，叫她準備好來完成

sweetness that prepared her to complete all her tasks. It also enabled her to maintain a genuine peacefulness in spite of the normal trying worries and pettiness that so often accompany life in a crowded neighborhood.

I never saw her lose her temper or speak even one word in anger. I never heard her participate in idle gossip or make a disparaging remark about another person. In fact, I never saw in her even the hint of an emotion unbecoming to someone who had drunk from “the river of the water of life” (Rev. 22:1) and who had eaten of “the living bread that came down from heaven” (John 6:51).

Frederick William Farrar

Give God the fresh blossom of the day. Never make Him wait until the petals have faded.

September 14

If anyone would come after me, he must deny himself and take up his cross and follow me. (Mark 8:34)

The cross that my Lord calls me to carry may assume many different shapes. I may have to be content with mundane tasks in a limited area of service, when I may believe my abilities are suited for much greater work. I may be required to continually cultivate the same field year after year, even though it yields no harvest whatsoever. I may be asked of God to nurture kind and loving thoughts about the very person who has wronged me and to speak gently to him, take his side when others oppose him, and bestow sympathy and comfort to him. I may have to openly testify of my Master before those who do not want to be reminded of Him or His claims. And I may be called to walk through this world with a bright, smiling face while my heart is breaking.

He draws close to me in order to mature my wisdom, deepen my peace, increase my courage, and supplement my power. All this He does so that through the very experience that is so painful and distressing to me, I will be of greater use to others. And then I will echo these words of one of the Scottish Covenantors of the seventeenth century, imprisoned for his faith by John Graham of Claverhouse—“I grow under the load.”

Alexander Smellie

她所有的工作。這也使她能保持一真正的平安，就算在擁擠的鄰舍中，生活伴隨的日常難忍罣慮和瑣事中也能夠。

我從沒見她發脾氣，甚至一個發怒的字詞也未曾出過她口。我從未聽過她講別人是非，或作出貶損他人的描述。事實上我從未見她有任何不體面的感情流露，她就是這樣的一個飲於「一道生命水的河」（啟22:1）和吃「從天上降下來生命的糧」（約6:51）的人。

弗特烈·威廉·法拉

將一日之清新綻放給神，不要使祂等到花瓣都凋殘之時。

九月十四日

「若有人要跟從我，就當捨己，背起他的十字架來跟從我。」（可8:34）

主呼召我去背負的十字架可能有很多不同的體現。我可能滿足於在有限範圍下的塵世事務，而我也許相信我的能力是適合於大得多的工作。我也許需要年復一年持續耕種同一塊田地，甚或它毫無收成。神也許要求我向誤解我的人培育仁慈和愛心的思想，和柔聲跟他說話，在他人反對他時站在他那方，給予他同情和安慰。我也許要在那些不願提及神和祂主張的人面前公開見證我的主。我也許被呼召在心碎時以光明和微笑在世上行走。

祂就近來為的是使我在智慧上成熟，在平安上進深，增加我的勇氣，增補我的能力。祂作的這一切為叫我藉着這些如此痛苦和苦惱的經歷來叫我於別人更有用。那時我便會不斷重覆一個十七世紀被囚蘇格蘭長老會擁護者加拿候士之約翰·加威的信心宣言：「我在重擔下成長。」

亞歷山大·史美利

September 15

Awake, north wind, and come, south wind! Blow on my garden, that its fragrance may spread abroad. (Song of Songs 4:16)

The juice of the aloe plant has a bitter taste but is soothing when applied to the skin, so it tells us of the sweetness of bitter things, the bittersweet, having an important application that only those who have used it will understand. Myrrh is symbolic of death, having been used to embalm the dead. It represents the sweetness that comes to the heart after it has died to self-will, pride, and sin.

What inexpressible charm seems to encircle some Christians, simply because they carry upon their pure countenance and gentle spirit the imprint of the cross! It is the holy evidence of having died to something that was once proud and strong but is now forever surrendered at the feet of Jesus.

Finally, frankincense was a fragrance that arose only after being touched with fire. It symbolizes a person's heart whose sweetness has been brought forth by the flames of affliction until the holy, innermost part of the soul is filled with clouds of praise and prayer.

from The Love-Life of Our Lord

September 16

Hide in the Kerith Ravine. (1 Kings 17:3)

And happy is the person who can reply to the Lord, "Your will is also mine. Therefore I run to hide myself in You. 'I long to dwell in your tent forever and take refuge in the shelter of your wings' [Ps. 61:4]."

Lancelot Andrews, a bishop of the Church of England and one of the translators of the King James Bible of 1611, experienced his "Kerith Ravine," in which he spent five hours of every day in prayer and devotion to God. John Welsh, a contemporary of Andrews, and a Presbyterian who was imprisoned for his faith by James VI of Scotland, also had his "ravine." He believed his day to be wasted if he did not spend eight to ten hours of isolated communion with God. David Brainerd's "ravine" was the forests of North America while he served as a pioneer missionary to the American Indians during the eighteenth century. And Christmas Evans, a preacher of the

九月十五日

「北風阿，興起。南風阿，吹來。吹在我的園內，使其中的香氣發出來。」(歌4:16)

沉香植物的汁液味苦，但當敷用在皮膚上時卻能減輕痛楚，因此它向我們述說苦物中的甜美——苦甜，於那些明白之人來說有着重要的應用價值。沒藥象徵死亡，一直以來用來裹屍防腐，它描繪臨到在一己意願、驕傲和罪上死的心中的甜美。

有一些基督徒有似乎說不出的魅力，只因他們展露他們十字架所刻劃的純潔面容和溫馴的靈！這是在從前是驕傲和強悍下已死的明證，如今已永遠降服在耶穌的腳前。

最後，乳香是只有在火燒下才發出其香氣的。這象徵着某人心中的甜美已因哀傷的火焰被帶到充滿讚美和祈禱煙雲的神聖，生命最深入之處。

摘自《愛——我們主的生命》

九月十六日

「藏在約但河東邊的基立溪旁。」(王上17:3)

能對主說「祢的旨意就是我的旨意，因此我跑來把自己藏在祢裏頭」的是快樂的人。「我要永遠住在祢的帳幕裏。我要投靠在祢翅膀下的隱密處。」(詩61:4)

其中一個1611年聖經英皇欽定本的翻譯者聖公會的蘭斯洛特·安德魯斯(Lancelot Andrews)主教，每天花五小時去祈禱敬拜神來經歷基立溪旁。與他同時代的長老會約翰·威爾殊，為信仰被蘇格蘭的詹姆士六世囚禁也成了他的深溪。他以為沒花八至十小時與神單獨相交的是浪費的一天。大衛·布萊納的溪旁就在北美洲的森林，他在十八世紀那時作為先驅服事那些美國印第安人。而十八世紀末，十九世紀初的傳道者克瑞斯

late-eighteenth and early-nineteenth centuries, had his long and lonely journeys through the hills of Wales.

The Isle of Patmos, the solitude of the Roman prisons, the Arabian Desert, and the hills and valleys of Palestine are all as enduringly memorable as those experienced by the people who have shaped our modern world.

Our Lord Himself lived through His “Kerith Ravine” in Nazareth, in the wilderness of Judea, amid the olive trees of Bethany, and in the solitude of the city of Gadara. So none of us is exempt from a “ravine” experience, where the sounds of human voices are exchanged for the waters of quietness that flow from the throne of God, and where we taste the sweetness and soak up the power of a life “hidden with Christ” (Col. 3:3).

From Elijah, by F. B. Meyer

September 17

He is the Lord; let Him do what is good in His eyes. (1 Samuel 3:18)

Perhaps the circumstances causing my sorrows will not be removed and my situation will remain the same, but if Christ is brought into my grief and gloom as my Lord and Master, He will “surround me with songs of deliverance” (Ps. 32:7). To see Him and to be sure that His wisdom and power never fail and His love never changes, to know that even His most distressing dealings with me are for my deepest spiritual gain, is to be able to say in the midst of bereavement, sorrow, pain, and loss, “The Lord gave and the Lord has taken away; may the name of the Lord be praised” (Job 1:21).

Seeing God in everything is the only thing that will make me loving and patient with people who annoy and trouble me. Then I will see others as the instruments God uses to accomplish His tender and wise purpose for me, and I will even find myself inwardly thanking them for the blessing they have become to me. Nothing but seeing God will completely put an end to all complaining and thoughts of rebellion.

Hannah Whitall Smith

September 18

馬·伊凡思在威爾士的山間作他長長孤單的旅程。

拔摩海島、偏僻的羅馬監獄、阿拉伯曠野、巴勒斯坦的山區和山谷，全都永誌不忘，這些人的經驗也曾塑造我們現今的世界。

我們主自己活在拿撒勒、猶大曠野、伯大尼的橄欖樹間，和獨自在加大拉城祂自己的基立溪旁。因此我們無人可免於溪旁的經歷，那兒人聲換作靜靜的流水，從神的寶座流出來；在那兒我們得嘗甜美，汲取「與基督一同藏在神裏面」(西 3:3) 的生命大能。

摘自邁爾著的《以利亞》

九月十七日

「這是出於耶和華，願祂憑自己的意旨而行。」(撒 3:18)

也許致使我憂傷的環境沒有被移除，我所處的處境依然不變，若帶我進入憂傷和悲哀的是作為我主和主人的基督時，祂必會「以得救的樂歌，四面環繞我。」(詩 32:7) 得見和確定祂的智慧和能力永不失誤，祂的愛永不改變，認識祂最叫我苦痛的舉動必是為着我最深屬靈的益處，以致在喪親、憂傷、痛苦和損失中能說「賞賜的是耶和華，收取的也是耶和華。耶和華的名是應當稱頌的。」(伯 1:21)

唯一使我們愛和忍耐那些使我愁煩和苦惱的人的是在凡事上得見神。那麼我必會看別人為神用來叫我成就祂親切和智慧目的的工具，我甚至察覺到我自己內裏為着他們來感謝，因為他們已成為我的祝福。除了得見神之外，沒有別的東西能完全結束所有埋怨和反叛的思想。

漢娜·韋滔·史勿夫

九月十八日

Where there is no vision, the people perish. (Proverbs 29:18 KJV)

Waiting upon God is vital in order to see Him and receive a vision from Him. And the amount of time spent before Him is also critical. For God's vision to be impressed on our hearts, we must sit in stillness at His feet for quite a long time. Remember, the troubled surface of a lake will not reflect an image.

Seeing God always transforms human life. Jacob "crossed the ford of the Jabbok" (Gen. 32:22), saw God, and became Israel. Seeing a vision of God transformed Gideon from a coward into a courageous soldier. And Thomas, after seeing Christ, was changed from a doubting follower into a loyal, devoted disciple.

William Carey, English pioneer missionary of the eighteenth century who is considered by some to be the Father of Modern Missions, saw God and left his shoemaker's bench to go to India. David Livingstone saw God and left everything in Britain behind to become a missionary and explorer, following the Lord's leading through the thickest jungles of Africa during the nineteenth century.

Dr. Pardington

And whenever the sounds of the world subside in our soul, we hear the whispering of God. Yes, He continues to whisper to us, but we often do not hear Him because of the noise and distractions caused by the hurried pace of our life.

Frederick William Faber

September 19

My Father is the gardener. (John 15:1)

And whenever a time of deep pruning comes and the knife cuts deeply and the pain is severe, what an inexpressible comfort it is to know: "My Father is the gardener."

When the new gardener came to a large greenhouse here, he cut them completely down to the stalk. I allowed him to do so, and we had no grapes for two years, but now clusters of luscious grapes are hanging on each side."

J. R. Miller

September 20

Did I not tell you that if you believed, you would see the

「沒有異象，民就放肆。」（箴 29:18）

若要想得見神和得着從祂而來的異象，等候神是必不可少的。在祂面前所用時間的多寡也是關鍵的，因神的異象印在我們心中，我們定須長時間靜坐祂腳前。謹記，弄皺的湖面必不能反照影像。

得見神總能改換人生。雅各「過了雅博渡口」（創32:22）後得見神，成為以色列。得見神的異象改換基甸，由一個懦夫變成為一個勇敢的士兵。多馬得見基督之後便由一猜疑的追隨者變成為一個忠心、獻身的門徒。

被認為是現代宣教工作之父十八世紀的英國宣教士先驅威廉·克理，得見神和離開造鞋的工作枱而往印度去。十九世紀的大衛·李文斯敦得見神和離開英國的一切東西，成為一個宣教士和探險家，跟着主的引導穿越厚密的非洲森林。

栢定騰博士

每當世界的聲音在我們的魂裏沉寂下來時，便得聽神的微聲。是的，祂持續向我們細語，但我們常時聽不到祂，因我們生命中急促的步伐造成噪音和分心。

弗雷德里克·威廉·費柏

九月十九日

「我父是栽培的人。」（約15:1）

每當修剪至深的時刻來到時，刀鋒深切，痛苦劇烈，但當知道「我父是栽培的人」時是說不出來的安慰。

當新園丁來到大溫室時，完全割下所有葡萄直至留下梗枝，兩年來都沒有葡萄，帶來如今兩旁掛滿甘甜的葡萄串。」

J.R. 米勒

九月二十日

「我不是對你說過，你若信，就必

glory of God? (John 11:40)

Mary and Martha could not understand what their Lord was doing. Each of them had said to Him, "Lord, if you had been here, my brother would not have died." (vv. 21,32).

Abraham could not understand why God would ask him to sacrifice his son, but he trusted Him. Then he saw the Lord's glory when the son he loved was restored to him. Moses could not understand why God would require him to stay forty years in the wilderness, but he also trusted Him. Then he saw when God called him to lead Israel from Egyptian bondage.

Joseph could not understand his brothers' cruelty toward him, the false testimony of a treacherous woman, or the long years of unjust imprisonment, but he trusted God and finally he saw His glory in it all. And Joseph's father, Jacob, could not understand how God's strange providence could allow Joseph to be taken from him. Yet later he saw the Lord's glory when he looked into the face of his son, who had become the governor for a great king and the person used to preserve his own life and the lives of an entire nation.

J. H. M.

September 21

I consider everything a loss compared to the surpassing greatness of knowing Christ Jesus my Lord. (Philippians 3:8)

This is its solemn message: "You must die in order to live. You must refuse to consider your own comfort and well-being. You must be crucified, not only to your desires and habits that are obviously sinful but also to many others that may appear to be innocent and right. If you desire to save others, you cannot save yourself, and if you desire to bear much fruit, you must be buried in darkness and solitude."

When the words are from Jesus, may I remind myself that it is my great privilege to enter into "the fellowship of sharing in his sufferings" (Phil. 3:10) and I am therefore in great company. May I also remind myself that all the suffering is designed to make me a vessel suitable for His use. And may I remember that His Calvary blossomed into abundant fruitfulness, and so will mine.

看見神的榮耀麼？」(約11:40)

馬利亞和馬太不明白主所作的。他們各自曾對祂說：「你若早在這裏，我兄弟必不死。」(約11:21,32)

亞伯拉罕不能明白為何神要他獻上他的兒子，但他信靠祂。之後他得見主的榮耀，就在他得回所愛的兒子之時。摩西不明白為何神需要他留在曠野四十年，但他也信靠祂。之後祂得見神，就在祂被呼召去領以色列人脫離埃及為奴之家時。

約瑟不明白他的兄弟為何如何殘忍對待他，那個奸詐婦人的假見證，和長年不公平的囚禁；但他信靠神和最終得見這一切當中神的榮耀。而約瑟的父親雅各不明白神何等奇妙的旨意能容許約瑟從他處被帶離，然而之後他得見主的榮耀，就在他得見他兒子的臉面時，他已成為一個偉大國王的宰相，也成為保存他自己和整個國度的生命之人。

J.H.M.

九月二十一日

「我也將萬事當作有損的，因我以認識我主基督耶穌為至寶。」(腓3:8)

其嚴肅信息是：「你定須死才能得生，你定須拒絕想到你一己的舒適和好處。不只在你的熱愛和習慣所作明顯的罪惡上，在眾多可能似乎是無害和正直的事上你也定須釘十字架。你若渴想拯救別人，你便不能救自己；你若渴想結更多果子，你定須被埋在黑暗和孤獨中。」

既然話是出於耶穌的口，那麼我當提醒自己「曉得和祂一同受苦」(腓3:10)是我的重大殊榮，我也因此有眾多的同路人。我也當提醒自己這一切的痛苦是設計來使我成為一合祂用的器皿。我當謹記祂的加略山最終能長出纍纍的果子，我的加略山也是一樣。

Pain leads to plenty, and death to life—it is the law of the kingdom!

from In the Hour of Silence

Do we call it dying when a bud blossoms into a flower?

selected

September 22

Satan has asked to sift you as wheat. But I have prayed for you, Simon, that your faith may not fail. (Luke 22:31-32)

Our faith is the center of the target God aims at when He tests us, and if any gift escapes untested, it certainly will not be our faith. There is nothing that pierces faith to its very marrow—to find whether or not it is the faith of those who are immortal—like shooting the arrow of the feeling of being deserted into it. And only genuine faith will escape unharmed from the midst of the battle after having been stripped of its armor of earthly enjoyment and after having endured the circumstances coming against it that the powerful hand of God has allowed.

Faith must be tested, and the sense of feeling deserted is “the furnace heated seven times hotter than usual” (Dan. 3:19) into which it may be thrown. Blessed is the person who endures such an ordeal!

Charles H. Spurgeon

Paul said, “I have kept the faith” (2 Tim. 4:7), but his head was removed! They cut it off, but they could not touch his faith. This great apostle to the Gentiles rejoiced in three things: he had “fought the good fight,” he had “finished the race,” and he had “kept the faith.” So what was the value of everything else? The apostle Paul had won the race and gained the ultimate prize—he had won not only the admiration of those on earth today but also the admiration of heaven. So why do we not live as if it pays to lose “all things ... that [we] may gain Christ” (Phil. 3:8)? Why are we not as loyal to the truth as Paul was? It is because our math is different—he counted in a different way than we do. What we count as gain, he counted as loss. If we desire to ultimately wear the same crown, we must have his faith and live it.

痛苦帶來豐富，死亡帶來生命，這就是天國的律！

摘自《寧靜時刻》

我們會否稱花蕾盛放開花為死亡呢？

選

九月二十二日

「西門，西門，撒但想要得着你們，好篩你們，像篩麥子一樣。但我已經為你祈求，叫你不至於失了信心。」（路22:31-32）

當神試驗我們時，我們的信就是祂瞄準的靶心，若有任何恩賜是未經試驗的話，這肯定不會是出於我們的信心。為要找尋那些人的信是否不死的信時，能刺入信心精髓的沒有像將自情感拔出的箭反射出去。唯一的真信能叫人在戰場上被剝去其地上歡樂的軍裝，和在神權能之手的容許下，在與他為敵的環境上堅忍後能全身而退和毫無損傷。

信定須受試煉，被拋棄的感覺要被拋進比尋常更加七倍燒熱的火窖（但3:19）中。能忍受如此嚴峻考驗的人是有福的！

司布真

說「所信的道我已經守住了」（提後4:7）的保羅是被斬頭的！他們能斬他頭，但不能觸碰他的信。這偉大的外邦人使徒在三件事上歡欣：他打過美好的仗，跑盡當跑的路，守住所信的道。萬事於他還有甚麼價值？使徒保羅已勝出賽跑，贏得至終獎賞。不單得今天地上眾人的，且得天上的欽佩。為何我們活的不是丟棄「萬事……為要得着基督」（腓3:8）的生命？為何不能像保羅般持守真理？是因我們有不同算計，他算計的方法跟我們不相同。我們看為得的他看為失。我們若渴慕至終得戴上相同的冠冕，就定須有和活出他的信。

September 23

Whoever believes in me, as the Scripture has said, streams of living water will flow from within him. (John 7:38)

If you will give the blessing you have received, planning your life around greater service and being a blessing to those around you, then you will quickly find that the Holy Spirit is with you. He will bestow blessings to you for service, giving you all He can trust you to give away to others.

No music is as heavenly as that made by an aeolian harp. As the breath of heaven floats over the strings, notes that are nearly divine float upon the air, as if a choir of angels were wandering about and touching the strings.

from Days of Heaven upon Earth

When the apostles “were filled with the Holy Spirit” (Acts 2:4), they did not lease the Upper Room and stay there to hold holiness meetings. They went everywhere, preaching the gospel.

Will Huff

Where is your brother Abel? Genesis 4:9

September 24

When they came to the border of Mysia, they tried to enter Bithynia, but the Spirit of Jesus would not allow them to. (Acts 16:7)

There have been times when I have experienced the same thing. Sometimes I have been interrupted in what seemed to be quite productive work. And at times, opposition came and forced me to go back, or sickness came and forced me to rest in some isolated place.

During such times, it was difficult for me to leave my work unfinished when I believed it was service done in the power of His Spirit. But I finally remembered that the Spirit requires not only a service of work but also a service of waiting. I came to see that in the kingdom of Christ, there are not only times for action but times to refrain from action. And I also came to learn that a place of isolation is often the most useful place of all in this diverse world. Its harvest is more rich than the seasons when the corn

九月二十三日

「信我的人，就如經上所說：從他腹中要流出活水的江河來。」(約 7:38)

你要施出已得的恩福，在生命上計劃去作更大的服事，和成為你四圍之人的祝福，那麼你必會很快便發覺聖靈就在你裏頭。祂必會給予你恩福來服事，盡將祂所能託付你的給你，為叫你送出給別人。

沒有像風豎琴所生成的音樂那麼屬天。當天之氣息流經弦線時，空中便泛起幾乎是神聖的音符，如同一隊漫遊的天使在彈撥弦線。

摘自《在地若天的日子》

當使徒們「被聖靈充滿」(徒 2:4)後，他們不是永久租用那上面的樓房，留在那裏舉行那神聖的聚會，而是到處去傳揚福音。

韋理·胡夫

「你兄弟亞伯在哪裏？」(創 4:9)

九月二十四日

「到了每西亞的邊界，他們想要往庇推尼去，耶穌的靈卻不許。」(徒 16:7)

我也曾多次經歷相同的情況。有時是在看來頗為有建設性的工作上受干擾。反對時不時來到強逼我折返，或是病痛來到強逼我在僻靜之處休息。

在那些時候，要我留下我相信是以聖靈的能力來作的工作未完成是困難的。但至終我相信聖靈所需求的不單止是工作上的服事，且是等待上的服事。我漸漸明白到在基督的國度中不單止有行動的時刻，且有不行動的時刻。我亦學會了一個獨處的地方通常是在這形形色色的世界中最有用的地方。穀物和酒最豐盛的季節都不及收割

and wine were the most abundant. So I have learned to thank the blessed Holy Spirit that many a beautiful Bithynia had to be left without a visit from me.

Dear Holy Spirit, my desire is still to be led by You. Nevertheless, my opportunities for usefulness seem to be disappointed, for today the door appears open into a life of service for You but tomorrow it closes before me just as I am about to enter. Teach me to see another door even in the midst of the inaction of this time. Help me to find, even in the area of service where You have closed a door, a new entrance into Your service. Inspire me with the knowledge that a person may sometimes be called to serve by doing nothing, by staying still, or by waiting. And when I remember the power of Your “gentle whisper” (1 Kings 19:12), I will not complain that sometimes the Spirit allows me not to go.

George Matheson

September 25

Why must I go about mourning? (Psalm 42:9)

Can you find any reason why you are so often mourning instead of rejoicing? Why do you allow your mind to dwell on gloomy thoughts? Who told you that night will never end in day? Who told you that the winter of your discontent would continue from frost to frost and from snow, ice, and hail to even deeper snow and stronger storms of despair?

Don't you know that day dawns after night, showers displace drought, and spring and summer follow winter? Then, have hope! Hope forever, for God will not fail you!

Charles H. Spurgeon

September 26

We live by faith, not by sight. (2 Corinthians 5:7)

As believers, “we live by faith, not by sight”—God never wants us to live by our feelings. Our inner self may want to live by feelings, and Satan may want us to, but God wants us to face the facts, not feelings. He wants us to face the facts of Christ and His finished and perfect work for us. And once we face these precious facts, and believe them simply because God says they are facts, He will take care of

來得豐富，因此我學會了感謝施恩聖靈，就在祂叫我留下眾多的美麗庇推尼不去時。

親愛的聖靈啊，我仍渴望得着祢的帶領。雖然顯為有用的機會似乎幻滅，因着為祢而作的生命服事的門今天似乎是打開的，但明天當我要進去時就在我面前關閉。教導我得見另一道門，甚或祢叫我在這時要落在毫無活動中。幫助我就算在祢已關上門的事奉領域中找到服事祢的新門口。以人所認知的也許人有時會被呼召來不作事或保持不動或等待來服事來指示我。當我記取祢「微小的聲音」（王上 19:12）時，我便不會埋怨為何有時聖靈不許我前行了。

喬治·馬得勝

九月二十五日

「我為何因仇敵的欺壓時常哀痛呢？」（詩42:9）

你能否找到為何你經常悲傷而非歡笑的原因？為何你容許意念停駐在沮喪的思緒中？是誰告訴你黑夜不會完結轉為白日？是誰告訴你你不快的冬天會持續結霜又結霜，又雪又冰又雹，甚至是更厚的雪和更凜冽的絕望風暴？

你既知黑夜盡頭便是黎明，雨露必取代乾旱，冬天過後便是春天夏天，那麼，當心存盼望！永遠盼望，因為神是不會辜負你的。

司布真

九月二十六日

「因我們行事為人，是憑着信心，不是憑着眼見。」（林後5:7）

神從不希望作為憑信不憑眼見之信徒的我們活在感覺中。我們內裏的己也許想靠感覺而活，撒但亦如是，但神希望我們面對事實，並非感覺。祂想我們面對基督的事實和祂為我們作祂作成及完美的的工作。我們一旦面對這些珍貴的事實，因着神如是說而簡單相信，那

our feelings.

Yet God never gives us feelings to enable or encourage us to trust Him, and He never gives them to show us that we have already completely trusted Him. God only gives us feelings when He sees that we trust Him apart from our feelings, resting solely on His Word and His faithfulness to His promise. And these feelings that can only come from Him will be given at such a time and to such a degree as His love sees best for each individual circumstance.

Therefore we must choose between facing our feelings or facing the facts of God. Our feelings may be as uncertain and changing as the sea or shifting sand. God's facts, however, are as certain as the Rock of Ages Himself—"Jesus Christ ... the same yesterday and today and forever" (Heb. 13:8).

September 27

I have found a ransom for him. (Job 33:24)

Divine healing is actually divine life. It is the lordship of Christ over the body—or the life of Christ in the framework of the human body. It is the union of the parts of our bodies with His very body, exhibiting His life flowing throughout our bodies. It is as real as His risen and glorified body. And it is as reasonable as the fact that He was raised from the dead, is a living person with an actual body, and sits today as an understanding soul at God's right hand.

That same Christ, with all His attributes and mighty power, belongs to us. We are members of His body, His flesh, and His bones, and if we will only believe this and receive it, we may actually draw our life from the very life of the Son of God. Dear God, help me to know and to live this verse: "The body is ... for the Lord, and the Lord for the body" (1 Cor. 6:13).

A.B. Simpson

"The Lord your God is with you, He is mighty to save" (Zeph. 3:17). This was the verse that initially brought the truth of divine healing to my mind and my worn-out body more than twenty years ago.

"The Lord your God" (Luke 10:27). If the Lord is my God, then all that is in almighty God is mine. It all resides within me to the extent that I am willing and able to appropriate Him and all that belongs to Him. "God, whose name is the Lord Almighty" (Jer. 32:18),

麼祂必會也顧到我們的感覺。

神從不為叫和鼓勵我們信靠祂而給我們感覺，也從不為要顯給我們看我們已完全信靠祂而給予感覺。神只會在祂得見我們在感覺以外來信靠祂時給我們感覺，因那時我們單單安息在應許的話語和信實上。而這些來自祂的感覺只會在每一個別情況按祂的愛所認為是合適的時間和程度來給予的。

因此我們必須在面對我們的感覺還是神的事實之間取捨。我們的感覺像海洋或流沙般不穩定和變動；神的事實卻穩如「耶穌基督，昨日今日一直到永遠是一樣的」(來13:8)萬古磐石祂自己。

九月二十七日

「我已經得了(他的)贖價。」(伯33:24)

神聖醫治其實是神聖生命，是讓主掌管身體，或者說基督的生命進入體中。這是我們的身體與祂身體的聯合，藉我們的身體來流露祂的生命，這就與祂活出榮耀的身體同樣的真實。這也如同祂已從死裏復活，有一實在身體的活人，今天以一穎悟的生命坐在神右邊的事實同樣合情合理。

屬於我們的是有着祂一切屬性和大能的同一位基督。我們是祂骨肉身子的肢體，只要我們相信和接受這個，便能實在由神子的生命中提取我們的生命。神啊，幫助我們認識和活出「身子……乃是為主；主也是為身子」(林前6:13)。

宣信

二十多年前「耶和華你的神，是施行拯救，大有能力的主。」(番3:17)這經文首次將這神聖醫治的真理帶進我的思想和衰殘的身體。

「主你的神」(路10:27)。主若是我的神，那麼全能神的一切都屬我。甚至可以說所有屬神的東西只要我願意也能夠向祂取為己用了。「是至大全能的神，耶和華

is indeed the all mighty God and is my inside God.

September 28

In me ... peace. (John 16:33)

There is a vast difference between pleasure and blessedness. Paul experienced imprisonment, pain, sacrifice, and suffering to their very limits, yet through it all he was blessed. All the beatitudes became real in his heart and life, in the midst of his difficult circumstances.

Paganini, the great Italian violinist, once stepped onstage only to discover there was something wrong with his violin.

Then he played as never before, and beautiful music flowed from that inferior instrument until the audience was so enraptured that their enthusiastic applause nearly lifted the ceiling of the concert hall.

Dear tested and tried believer, it is your mission to walk onto the stage of this world in order to reveal to all of heaven and earth that the music of life lies not in your circumstances or external things but in your own soul.

September 29

I am a man of prayer. (Psalm 109:4)

All too often we are in a “holy” hurry in our devotional time. How much actual time do we spend in quiet devotion on a daily basis? Can it be easily measured in minutes?

George Whitefield, the English preacher who was one of the leading figures in the eighteenth-century American revival known as the Great Awakening, once said, “I have spent entire days and weeks lying prostrate 伏 on the ground, engaged in silent or spoken prayer.” And the words of another person, whose life confirmed his own assertion, were these: “Fall to your knees and grow there.”

It has been said that no great work of literature or science has ever been produced by someone who did not love solitude. It is also a fundamental principle of faith that no tremendous growth in holiness has ever been achieved by anyone who has not taken the time frequently, and for long periods, to be alone with God.

from The Still Hour

是祢的名。」(耶32:18)全能的神真是我裏頭的神。

九月二十八日

「在我裏面有平安。」(約16:33)

快樂和蒙福有着偌大的差別。保羅經歷監禁、痛苦、犧牲和受苦至極，然而這一切是叫他蒙福的。所有的恩福是在他心中、生命和困難環境中成真的。

偉大的小提琴手巴格利尼(Paganini)有一次在踏出表演台前發覺他的小提琴出了問題。

之後他如同無事發生般演奏，悠揚的音樂從那次等的樂器中流出，聽眾因狂喜致使熱烈掌聲幾乎把音樂廳的天花板都揭開。

受試煉的親愛信徒啊，你的任命就是走到今世的台前來向天和地揭示不是在四圍的環境和外在的事物中，而是在你自己生命中的音樂。

九月二十九日

「我專心祈禱。」(詩109:4)

我們常在靈修時刻中「神聖」忽忽。我們實在每天花上多少時間來作寧靜靈修？會否只是數分鐘？

被稱為大復興的十八世紀美國復興中其中一個領導人物喬治·懷特腓有一次說：「我曾花上數天甚至數星期伏在地上，從事無聲或開聲的祈禱。」另一個生命證明他一己確信的人說：「屈膝禱告來成長。」

曾有人說不愛獨處的人從不會生產出偉大的文學或科學之工。信心的基本原則亦相同，未曾恆常花長時間來與神獨處的人是不能達至神聖上驚人的成長的。

摘自《寧靜時刻》

September 30

He guarded him ... like an eagle that stirs up its nest and hovers over its young, that spreads its wings to catch them and carries them on its pinions. The Lord alone led him; no foreign god was with him. (Deuteronomy 32:10-12)

Our almighty God is like a parent who delights in leading the tender children in His care to the very edge of a precipice and then shoving them off the cliff into nothing but air. He does this so they may learn that they already possess an as-yet-unrealized power of flight that can forever add to the pleasure and comfort of their lives. Yet if, in their attempt to fly, they are exposed to some extraordinary peril, He is prepared to swoop beneath them and carry them skyward on His mighty wings.

from The Song of Victory

When God places a burden upon you, He places His arms underneath you. There once was a little plant that was small and whose growth was stunted, for it lived under the shade of a giant oak tree. The little plant valued the shade that covered it and highly regarded the quiet rest that its noble friend provided. Yet there was a greater blessing prepared for this little plant.

Do you understand that God may take away your comforts and privileges in order to make you a stronger Christian? Is He developing in you the qualities of a soldier by shoving you into the heat of the battle? Should you not then use every gift and weapon He has given you to become a conqueror?

Charles H. Spurgeon

October 1

It was good for me to be afflicted. (Psalm 119:71)

One of the finest arrays of living color I have ever seen was just above the great Saint Bernard Hospice near the ten-thousand-foot summit of Mont Cenis in the French Alps. The entire face of one expansive rock was covered with a strikingly vivid yellow lichen, which shone in the sunshine like a golden wall protecting an enchanted castle.

As I write these words, I have two specimens of the same type of lichen before me. One is from this Saint Bernard area, and the other is from the wall of a

九月三十日

「耶和華……保護他……又如鷹攪動巢窩，在雛鷹以上兩翅搨展，接取雛鷹，背在兩翼之上。這樣，耶和華獨自引導他，並無外邦神與他同在。」（申32:10-12）

我們全能的神就像一個喜悅引導幼弱兒女的父母，悉心帶他們到懸崖邊，猛然推他們離崖墮空。祂這樣作為使他們學會早已擁有卻還未知曉的能力，就是能叫他們的生命永遠添上歡愉和安慰的飛翔能力。然而在他們嘗試飛行中若面對某些不尋常的危險時，祂是隨時準備好撲接他們，用大力雙翼載他們衝天飛的。

摘自《得勝之歌》

當神安置重擔在你身上時，祂同時將祂雙臂放在你下面。從前有一株細小植物，矮小並發育不良，因它長在一棵大橡樹的蔭下。那株小植物珍愛那遮蔽它的蔭庇，高度評價那寧靜的平安是它這尊貴的朋友所提供的。然而有一更大的祝福早已為這株弱小植物預備。

你知不知神取走你的舒適和善待，也許為使你成為更強壯的基督徒呢？祂是否藉推你進入熾烈戰事中來孕育你士兵的素質？你豈不應從此用每一個祂給你的恩賜和武器來成為一個得勝者麼？

司布真

十月一日

「我受苦是與我有益，為要使我學習祢的律例。」（詩119:71）

我所見其中展現最美活潑的色彩就是在法國阿爾卑斯山脈仙尼斯山萬呎山峰附近的聖班納德救濟院之上，在一大塊磐石上的整個表面都佈滿奪目生趣盎然的黃色苔蘚，在陽光照耀下就像魔幻城堡的護城金牆。

當我記下這些時，前面就放着兩種同類苔蘚的樣本，一個來自聖班納德，另一個來自蘇格蘭城堡牆

Scottish castle, which is surrounded by sycamore trees. The difference in their form and coloring is quite striking. The one grown amid the fierce storms of the mountain peak has a lovely yellow color of a primrose, a smooth texture, and a definite form and shape. But the one cultivated amid the warm air and the soft showers of the lowland valley has a dull, rusty color, a rough texture, and an indistinct and broken shape.

Until the storms and difficulties allowed by God's providence beat upon a believer again and again, his character appears flawed and blurred. Yet the trials actually clear away the clouds and shadows, perfect the form of his character, and bestow brightness and blessing to his life.

October 2

He took them with him and they withdrew by themselves. (Luke 9:10)

In order to grow in grace, we must spend a great deal of time in quiet solitude. Contact with others in society is not what causes the soul to grow most vigorously. In fact, one quiet hour of prayer will often yield greater results than many days spent in the company of others. It is in the desert that the dew is freshest and the air is the most pure.

Andrew Bonar

October 3

After the earthquake came a fire....And after the fire came a gentle whisper. (1 Kings 19:12)

God's voice is directed to the ear of love, and true love is intent upon hearing even the faintest whisper. Yet there comes a time when His love ceases to speak, when we do not respond to or believe His message. "God is love" (1 John 4:8), and if you want to know Him and His voice, you must continually listen to His gentle touches.

So when you are about to say something in conversation with others, and you sense a gentle restraint from His quiet whisper, heed the restraint and refrain from speaking. And when you are about to pursue some course of action that seems perfectly clear and right, yet you sense in your spirit another path being suggested with the force of quiet conviction, heed that conviction.

God will seem to work against Himself, so simply

上被篠懸樹所圍繞的。他們形態上和色彩的不同也頗令人側目，生在烈風山巔之中的有着報春花可愛的黃色，有平滑的素質和明確的輪廓和形狀。但那個在溫暖空氣和低地山谷微雨滋養的苔蘇有的卻是不起眼像生的顏色，質地粗糙，形態破損不起眼。

信徒一次又一次受神旨意臨到的風暴和難處時，他的外表看來是殘缺和斑污。但試煉更能把黑雲陰暗除去，叫他的性格得以完全，賦與他生命的光明和恩福。

十月二日

「耶穌就帶他們暗暗的離開那裏。」(路9:10)

我們若要在恩典中成長，定須花大量時間在靜處中。在社會上與人的交往並非造成生命越發變得富有活力的原因，事實上一小時安靜的祈禱常能產生比與眾人同夥多日更大的果效。沙漠中的露水是最清新的，空氣是最純潔的。

安德魯·邦立

十月三日

「地震後有火.....火後有微小的聲音。」(王上19:12)

神的聲音向愛之耳講說，真愛叫人連最細小的微聲也能聽見，但有時祂的愛停止說話，因我們不回應或相信「神就是愛」(約壹4:8)祂這信息。你若想認識祂和祂的聲音，你定須持續聆聽祂那溫柔安慰之聲。

因此，當你想與人交談而自祂安靜微聲中感到神的禁止時，就聽從這禁止來不再說話吧。當你要採取似乎是完全清楚和正直的行動時，但在你靈內感到那靜中制止之力提議你另闢蹊徑時，聽從這制止吧。

神會作似乎違背祂自己的

listen, obey, and trust Him, even when it appears to be the greatest absurdity to do so. Ultimately, “we know that in all things God works for the good of those who love him” (Rom. 8:28).

from Way of Faith

October 4

The Lord blessed the latter part of Job's life more than the first. (Job 42:12)

Job found his legacy through the grief he experienced. He was tried that his godliness might be confirmed and validated. At last he cried, “Now my eyes have seen you” (v. 5).

If I experience the presence of God in His majesty through my pain and loss, so that I bow before Him and pray, “Your will be done” (Matt. 6:10), then I have gained much indeed. God gave Job glimpses of his future glory, for in those weary and difficult days and nights, he was allowed to penetrate God's veil and could honestly say, “I know that my Redeemer lives” (Job 19:25). So truly: “The Lord blessed the latter part of Job's life more than the first.”

from In the Hour of Silence

Trouble never comes to someone unless it brings a nugget of gold in its hand. Apparent adversity will ultimately become an advantage for those of us doing what is right, if we are willing to keep serving and to wait patiently.

selected

It is from suffering that the strongest souls ever known have emerged; the world's greatest display of character is seen in those who exhibit the scars of sorrow; the martyrs of the ages have worn their coronation robes that have glistened with fire, yet through their tears and sorrow have seen the gates of heaven.

Chapin

October 5

Some time later the brook dried up. (1 Kings 17:7)

The education of our faith is incomplete if we have yet to learn that at God's providence works through loss, that there is a ministry to us through failure and the fading of things, and that He gives the gift of

工，所以只管聆聽，順服和信靠祂，那怕這看起來是絕對荒謬。到底「我們曉得萬事都互相效力，叫愛神的人得益處」（羅8:28）。

摘自《信心之路》

十月四日

「這樣，耶和華後來賜福給約伯比先前更多。」（伯42:12）

約伯經歷憂傷後有所得，他的被試煉叫他的敬虔得以確立和認同。他最終呼叫說：「現在親眼看見祢。」（伯42:5）

我若在痛苦和損失中經驗神君尊的同在來俯伏祂面前說「願祢的旨意成就」（太6:10）時，我真的多有得着。神讓約伯瞥見他將來的榮耀，就在他那些疲憊和困難的日與夜，他獲許穿透神的帕子而能誠實地說：「我知道我的救贖主活着」（伯19:25），誠然「耶和華後來賜福給約伯比先前更多」。

摘自《聆靜一刻》

困難不會臨到某人，除非困難帶同金礦塊。外在的不幸終會成為我們這些作得對之人的裨益，只要我們願意一直事奉和忍耐等候。

選

忍受苦難才能冒出人所認知最堅強的生命。世上最偉大性格的展示顯在那些有傷痛疤痕的人身上。過往世代的殉教者已穿上他們有火光閃爍的加冕禮袍子，而透過他們的眼淚和憂傷得見天家之門。

澤賓

十月五日

「過了些日子，溪水就乾了。」（王上17:7）

若我們還要藉損失來學習神供應之工，就是我們要作藉失敗和失去世物作的職事，而祂所賜的是空無一物時，我們在信上還未受

emptiness. It is, in fact, the material in securities of life that cause our lives to be spiritually established. The dwindling brook at the Kerith Ravine, where Elijah sat deep in thought, is a true picture of each of our lives. "Sometime later the brook dried up" —this is the history of our yesterdays, and a prophecy of our tomorrows.

One way or the other, we must all learn the difference between trusting in the gift and trusting in the Giver. The gift may last for a season, but the Giver is the only eternal love. The Kerith Ravine was a difficult problem for Elijah until he arrived at Zarephath, and suddenly everything became as clear as daylight to him. God's hard instructions are never His last words to us, for the woe, the waste, and the tears of life belong to its interlude, not its finale. If the Lord had led Elijah directly to Zarephath, he would have missed something that helped to make him a wiser prophet and a better man—living by faith at Kerith.

F. B. Meyer

October 6

He did not open his mouth. (Isaiah 53:7)

If we could only see the blessings that lie hidden in our trials, we would say like David, when Shimei cursed him, "Let him curse....It may be that the Lord will ... repay me with good for the cursing I am receiving today" (2 Sam. 16:11-12).

Some Christians are easily turned away from the greatness of their life's calling by pursuing instead their own grievances and enemies. May God grant us more of the Spirit of Christ, who, "when they hurled their insults at him, ... did not retaliate....Instead, he entrusted himself to him who judges justly" (1 Peter 2:23). "Consider him who endured such opposition from sinful men, so that you will not grow weary and lose heart" (Heb. 12:3).

A. B. Simpson

October 7

Who among you fears the Lord and obeys the word of his servant? Let him who walks in the dark, who has no light, trust in the name of the Lord and rely on his God. (Isaiah 50:10)

The first thing to do is nothing. This is a difficult thing for our lowly human nature to do. There is a

教。事實上這些失去就是我們賴以維生的東西，使我們屬靈的生命得以建立。坐在基立谷快要流乾的溪旁沉思的以利亞是我們每一個人生命的真實寫照。「過了些日子，溪水就乾了。」這是我們昨天的故事，也是我們明天的預告。

無論如何，我們定須學會信賴恩賜與和信賴賜恩者的分別。恩賜也許持續一時，但賜恩者給的是永恒的愛。基立溪旁是以利亞的困難，直至他來到撒勒法，所有事情便明如日光。神嚴厲的指引總不是祂給我們未了的話，因生命中的悲痛、荒涼和眼淚都屬插曲，而非終曲。若主直接領以利亞到撒勒法，他便錯過那些能幫助他成為更智慧的先知和在基立活在信上更得神喜悅的人了。

邁爾

十月六日

「祂卻不開口。」(賽53:7)

我們若能看見藏於試煉背後的恩福，便會像大衛在被示每咒詛時說：「由他咒罵吧.....或者耶和華見我遭難，為我今日被這人咒罵，就施恩與我。」(撒下16:11-12)

一些基督徒很容易背離他們人生偉大的呼召，反去追求他們一己的不滿和仇敵。願神給我們更多基督的靈，祂是「被罵不還口，受害不說威嚇的話，只將自己交托那按公義審判人的主」(彼前2:23)的那位。「那忍受罪人這樣頂撞的，你們要思想，免得疲倦灰心。」(來12:3)

宣信

十月七日

「你們中間誰是敬畏耶和華聽從他僕人之話的。這人行在暗中，沒有亮光，當倚靠耶和華的名，仗賴自己的神。」(賽50:10)

首要作的就是不要作，於我們這些卑微的人類天性來說，作任何

saying, “When you’re rattled, don’t rush.”

The right thing is simply to trust God, however, prevents Him from doing anything for us. If the darkness covering us strikes terror in our hearts and we run back and forth, seeking in vain to find a way of escape from the dark trial where God’s providence has placed us, then the Lord cannot work on our behalf. Only the peace of God will quiet our minds and put our hearts at rest. We must place our hand in His as a little child and allow Him to lead us into the bright sunshine of His love. He knows the way out of the dense, dark forest, so may we climb into His arms, trusting Him to rescue us by showing us the shortest and most reliable road.

Dr. Pardington

October 8

Do not be anxious about anything. (Philippians 4:6)

Worry only destroys the effectiveness of lives that would otherwise be useful and beautiful. Being restless and having worries and cares are absolutely forbidden by our Lord, who said, “So do not worry, saying, ‘What shall we eat?’ or ‘What shall we drink?’ or ‘What shall we wear?’” (Matt. 6:31).

Darlow Sargeant

“Be still, and know that [Jehovah is] God” (Ps. 46:10)! “The Holy One of Israel” (Ps. 89:18) will defend and deliver His own. We can be sure that His every word will stand forever, even though the mountains may fall into the sea. He deserves our total confidence.

selected

October 9

The Lord longs to be gracious to you; he rises to show you compassion. (Isaiah 30:18)

Dear Christian, do not say, “Where are all the swallows? They are all gone—they are dead.” No, they are not dead. They have simply skimmed across the deep, blue sea, flying to a faraway land; but they will be back again soon.

Child of God, do not say, “All the flowers are dead—the winter has killed them, so they are gone.” No! Although the winter has covered them with a white coat of snow, they will push up their heads again

事都是困難的。

該作的不過是信靠神，但憂慮阻止祂為我們作工。若覆蓋我們的黑暗叫我們的心驚恐而進退失據，尋找種種方法逃離神定旨給我們這黑暗的試誘上徒勞時，這時神不能為我們作甚麼。惟有神的平安才能安靜我們的心思，使我們的心安穩。我們定須像小孩般把我們的手放在神手中，讓祂帶領我們進入祂愛的明光中。祂知迷霧和黑暗森林的出路，所以讓我們爬上祂的手臂，信靠祂來拯救我們，指示我們那最短和最可靠之路。

栢定騰博士

十月八日

「應當一無掛慮。」(腓4:6)

擔憂只會破壞生命的效率，而不是有用和美麗。坐立不安、擔憂和為世事操勞絕對是神所禁止的，祂說：「所以不要憂慮，說：吃甚麼？喝甚麼？穿甚麼？」(太6:31)

達勞·沙展

「你們要休息，要知道我是神。」(詩46:10)「以色列的聖者」(詩89:18)必保護拯救屬祂的人。即使大山往海中下沉，我們肯定祂的每一句話必永遠立定，祂配得我們完全的信靠。

選

十月九日

「耶和華必然等候，要施恩給你們；必然興起，好憐憫你們。」(賽30:18)

親愛的基督徒，不要說「所有燕子去了那裏？牠們全都不在，都死了。」不，牠們不是死了，牠們只不過擦過那既深且藍的海洋飛向那遙遠之地，不久便會再次回來。

神的孩子啊，不要說「所有花兒都死了，冬天已殺死它們。所以它們都不在了。」不，雖然冬天在它們上面蓋了一襲白雪之衣，但它

and will be alive very soon.

O believer, do not say that the sun has burned out, just because a cloud has hidden it. No, it is still there, planning a summer for you; for when it shines again, it will have caused those clouds to have dropped their April showers, each of them a mother to a sweet mayflower.

Above all, remember—when God hides His face from you, do not say that He has forgotten you. He is simply waiting for a little while to make you love Him more. And once He comes, you will rejoice with the inexpressible “joy of the Lord” (Neh. 8:10). Waiting on Him exercises your gift of grace and tests your faith. Therefore continue to wait in hope, for although the promise may linger, it will never come too late.

Charles H. Spurgeon

October 10

Do not fret. (Psalm 37:1)

I believe that this verse is as much a divine command as “You shall not steal” (Ex. 20:15).

When we worry and fret, we are a constant annoyance. This psalm not only says, “Do not fret because of evil men” but leaves no room for fretting whatsoever.

Any physician can tell you that a fit of anger is more harmful to your system than a fever and that a disposition of continual fretting is not conducive to a healthy body. The next step down from fretting is being quick-tempered, and that amounts to anger. May we set it aside once and for all and simply be obedient to the command “Do not fret.”

Margaret Bottome

October 11

... dying, and yet we live on. (2 Corinthians 6:9)

When an early frost came, I found that the radiant beauty of the blossoms had withered. It appeared that every plant I thought the winter had destroyed had replanted fifty to take its place.

As it is in the plant world, so it is in God's kingdom. Through death came everlasting life. Through crucifixion and the tomb came the throne and the palace of the eternal God. Through apparent defeat came victory.

So do not be afraid of suffering or defeat. It is

們會再次伸出頭兒，不久生氣再現。

信徒啊，不要說太陽已燒盡，它不過是被雲兒遮蓋，它仍在，為你安排了要來的夏天呢。當它再次照耀時，必會使那些雲兒滴下它們四月的驟雨，每次雨露都是甜美五月之花的母親。

最要緊謹記當神向你藏起祂的臉面時，不要說祂已忘記你，祂只稍等一會兒來使你愛祂更多，祂一旦歸來，你必樂在口舌不能說盡的「主的喜樂」(尼8:10)中。等待祂給你恩典和試驗你的信心。所以要持續在盼望中等候，雖則應許也許徘徊未到，但它總不會遲來。

司布真

十月十日

「不要.....心懷不平。」(詩37:1)

我相信本節與「不可偷盜」(出20:15)的命令同等神聖。

當我們憂心和煩躁時，便多時落在煩惱中，詩篇不單說「不要為作惡的心懷不平」，且總不給煩躁留地步。

任何一個醫生都會告訴你發一陣怒比起發燒更損害身體，持續煩躁的性格不會帶來健康的身體。低煩躁一級的是急躁，等同於憤怒。我們何不一次過把煩躁丟在一旁，就來順從這命令吧。

瑪嘉烈·博滕美

十月十一日

「似乎要死卻是活着的。」(林後6:9)

初霜來臨，我發現燦美的花兒已凋謝，我以為冬天所摧毀的每顆植物已有五十棵重新長在原處。

在植物的世界如何，在神國亦如何。永生是經過死亡才來到的。經過釘十字架和墳墓後，來到的是永生神的寶座和宮殿。經過外表的失敗後要來的就是勝利。

所以不要害怕受苦和失敗，是

through being “struck down, but not destroyed” (2 Cor. 4:9) and through being broken to pieces, and those pieces being torn to shreds, that we become people of strength. And it is the endurance of one believer that produces a multitude.

Henry Ward Beecher

October 12

Joseph’s master took him and put him in prison....But ... the Lord was with him ... and gave him success in whatever he did. (Genesis 39:20-21, 23)

When God allows us to go to prison because of our service to Him, it is nearly the most blessed place in the world that we could be, because He goes with us. Joseph seems to have known this truth. He did not sulk, become discouraged and rebellious, or engage in self-pity by thinking “everything was against him.” If he had done so, the prison warden would never have trusted him.

Lord Jesus, when the prison door closes behind me, keep me trusting in You with complete and overflowing joy. Give Your work through me great success, and even in prison make me “free indeed” (John 8:36).

selected

October 13

Do not be anxious about anything. (Philippians 4:6)

“Do not be anxious about anything, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God.” We are to take everything, living all day long in holy fellowship with our heavenly Father and our precious Lord Jesus.

“By prayer and petition”—earnestly pleading, persevering and enduring, and waiting, waiting, waiting on God.

“With thanksgiving”—always laying a good foundation. Even if we have no possessions, there is one thing for which we can always be thankful—that He has saved us from hell. We can also give thanks that He has given us His Holy Word, His Holy Spirit, and the most precious gift of all—His Son.

“And the peace of God, which transcends all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus” (Phil. 4:7).

George Mueller, from *Life of Trust*

「打倒了，卻不至死亡。」(林後 4:9) 是經過破成斷片，這些斷片再被搗碎，我們才能成為有力的人。一個信徒的忍耐能生出眾人的忍耐。

亨利·華德·比查

十月十二日

「(約瑟的主人)把約瑟下在監裏.....但耶和華與約瑟同在.....耶和華使他所作的盡都順利。」(創 39:20-21,23)

當神因為我們服事祂而容許我們下監時，這幾乎是世上我們能到最蒙福的地方，因為祂是與我們同去的。約瑟似乎學懂了這真理，他沒有因為沮喪、叛逆、或想到「事事與他作對」便在自憐中而愠怒。若他是這樣，司獄便不會信任他了。

主耶穌啊，當監門在我後面關上時，保守我以完全和充溢的歡欣來信靠祢。藉我作成祢偉大成功的工作，就算在獄中也使我「真自由」(約8:36)。

選

十月十三日

「應當一無掛慮。」(腓4:6)

「應當一無掛慮，只要凡事藉着禱告、祈求和感謝，將你們所要的告訴神。」(腓4:6)要帶去的是凡事，整天活在與我們的天父和我們寶貴的主耶穌的神聖契合中。

「藉着禱告和祈求」——誠摯地懇求，堅持，忍耐和在神面前等候，等候，等候。

「感謝」總是一個好的根基。那怕我們一無所有，仍有一事我們總可感謝的，就是祂已救我們出離地獄。我們也可因祂曾給我們祂的聖言、祂的聖靈、和其中最寶貴的——祂的兒子來感謝祂。

「神所賜出人意外的平安，必在基督耶穌裏，保守你們的心懷意念。」(腓4:7)

摘自慕勒的《信靠的生命》

October 14

Suddenly an angel of the Lord appeared and a light shone in the cell. He struck Peter on the side and woke him up. "Quick, get up!" he said, and the chains fell off Peter's wrists. (Acts 12:7)

This is the way God works. In our darkest hour, He walks to us across the waves, just as an angel came to Peter's cell when the day of Peter's execution dawned. And when the scaffold was completed for Mordecai's execution, the king's sleeplessness ultimately led to his action favoring God's favored race. (See Est. 6.)

F. B. Meyer

In Joseph's life, we see God work through a fellow prisoner, later through a dream, and finally through lifting Joseph from a prison to the position of governor. And the length of Joseph's prison stay gave him the strength and steadiness he needed as governor. It is always safe to trust God's methods and to live by His clock.

Samuel Dickey Gordon

God in His providence has a thousand keys to open a thousand different doors in order to deliver His own, no matter how desperate the situation may have become. May we be faithful to do our part, which is simply to suffer for Him, and to place Christ's part on Him and then leave it there.

George MacDonald

Difficulty is actually the atmosphere surrounding a miracle, or a miracle in its initial stage. Yet if it is to be a great miracle, the surrounding condition will be not simply a difficulty but an utter impossibility. And it is the clinging hand of His child that makes a desperate situation a delight to God.

October 15

The sacrifices of God are a broken spirit; a broken and contrite heart, O God, you will not despise. (Psalm 51:17)

It was not until Jacob's natural strength was broken, when "his hip was wrenched" (Gen. 32:25) at Peniel, that he came to the point where God could clothe him with spiritual power. And it was not until

十月十四日

「忽然有主的一個使者，站在旁邊，屋裏有光照耀。天使拍彼得的肋旁，拍醒了他，說：快快起來。那鐵鍊就從他手上脫落下來。」(徒12:7)

這是神工作的方法，在我們最無望時，祂像天使在行刑早上之前來到彼得的囚室般在波濤上向我們處走來。當末底改的行刑架裝嵌好時，王的無法入睡至終帶來有利於神喜悅的民族之舉(參斯6章)。

邁爾

從約瑟的人生中我們得見神是藉着一名囚犯來作工，之後藉着夢，最終藉着提約瑟出監來到作宰相之位。約瑟坐監的年日給他的是作為宰相的力量和堅毅。信靠神的方法和活在祂的安排上總是穩妥的。

撒母耳·迪奇·哥頓

按神旨意祂有千條鑰匙開啟千扇門扉，為叫屬祂的人得拯救，那怕他們所處的環境多麼惡劣。我們所當作的分就是信靠，簡單來說就是為祂受苦，並將基督的分放回祂身上，之後便留它在那處好了。

喬治·麥當勞

困難其實是環繞神蹟的氣氛，或是神蹟的最初階段。若這是一大神蹟，那麼周圍的情況便不止是困難，且是絕對不可能了。這是祂兒女依賴能令那惡劣的處境變成神所喜悅的東西的牽手了。

十月十五日

「神所要的祭，就是憂傷的靈。神阿，憂傷痛悔的心，祢必不輕看。」(詩51:17)

雅各若不是在毘努伊勒「大腿窩.....扭了」(創32:25)，就是他的天然能力被破壞，神便不會用聖靈的能力披在他身上。摩西若不是

Moses struck the rock at Horeb, breaking its surface, that cool “water [came] out of it for the people to drink” (Ex. 17:6). It was not until Gideon’s three hundred specially chosen soldiers “broke the jars that were in their hands” (Judg. 7:19), which symbolized brokenness in their lives, that the hidden light of the torches shone forth, bringing terror to their enemies. It was once the poor widow broke the seal on her only remaining jar of oil and began to pour it that God miraculously multiplied it to pay her debts and thereby supplied her means of support. (See 2 Kings 4:1-7.) It was not until Esther risked her life and broke through the strict laws of a heathen king’s court that she obtained favor to rescue her people from death. (See Est. 4:16.) It was once Jesus took “the five loaves ... and broke them” (Luke 9:16) that the bread was multiplied to feed the five thousand. Through the very process of the loaves being broken, the miracle occurred. It was when Mary broke her beautiful “alabaster jar of very expensive perfume” (Matt. 26:7), destroying its future usefulness and value, that the wonderful fragrance filled the house. And it was when Jesus allowed His precious body to be broken by thorns, nails, and a spear that His inner life was poured out like an ocean of crystal-clear water, for thirsty sinners to drink and then live. It is not until a beautiful kernel of corn is buried and broken in the earth by DEATH that its inner heart sprouts, producing hundreds of other seeds or kernels. And so it has always been, down through the history of plants, people, and all of spiritual life—God uses BROKEN THINGS.

Those who have been gripped by the power of the Holy Spirit and are used for God’s glory are those who have been broken in their finances, broken in their self-will, broken in their ambitions, broken in their lofty ideals, broken in their worldly reputation, broken in their desires, and often broken in their health. Yes, He uses those who are despised by the world and who seem totally hopeless and helpless, just as Isaiah said: “The lame will carry off plunder” (Isa. 33:23).

October 16

Let us throw off everything that hinders and the sin that so easily entangles, and let us run with perseverance the race marked out for us. (Hebrews

在何烈擊打磐石，擊碎磐石的表面，水便不會流出來使百姓可以喝了（出17:6）。基甸和他三百個特選的精兵若不「打破手中的瓶」（士7:19）（這瓶象徵他們的生命），那麼隱藏的火把便不能照耀，叫敵人驚懼了。從前那寡婦若不揭開她僅餘的油瓶和開始倒油，神便不會奇妙地將油倍增來叫她可以還債，因而她維生所需得以供應。（參王下4:1-7）若以斯帖不去冒生命危險來違例闖進不信神之王的宮廷，那麼她便不能蒙恩典來拯救她的百姓出離死亡了。（參斯4:16）那一次耶穌若不是「拿着這五個餅.....擘開」（路9:16），那麼這些餅不能倍增餵飽那五千人了。藉餅被擘開的過程，神蹟便出現了。馬利亞若不是打破那「瓶至貴的真哪噠香膏」（可14:3），摧毀它將來的用處和價值，那麼那香氣便不會充滿房子。耶穌若不讓祂寶貴的身體為荊棘、釘子和槍所刺破，那麼祂內裏的生命便不會倒出，像一明亮如水晶之汪洋的水便不會叫乾渴的罪人得喝而得活了。一粒美麗的麥子若不被埋在泥土上死去，那麼它裏面便不會萌生上百的種子子粒來了。這同樣也發生在植物、人類和所有屬靈生命上，神是使用破碎了的東西的。

被聖靈能力抓住的是為神的榮耀而被神使用的人，他們在他們的經濟、己意、雄心、崇高的理想、世界的聲望、願望和常時在他們的健康上都是破碎的。是的，神用那些世人所藐視，似乎完全絕望、無助的人，正如以賽亞說：「瘸腿的把掠物奪去了。」（賽33:23）

十月十六日

「我們當放下各樣的重擔，脫去容易纏累我們的罪，存心忍耐，奔那擺在我們前頭的路程。」（來12:1）

12:1)

A heavy heart is indeed a weight that will surely drag us down in our holiness and usefulness. The failure of the children of Israel to enter the Promised Land began with their complaining, or as the Word says it, "All the Israelites grumbled" (Num. 14:2). It may have started with a faint desire to complain and be discontent, but they allowed it to continue until it blossomed and ripened into total rebellion and ruin.

We should never give ourselves the freedom to doubt God or His eternal love and faithfulness toward us in everything.

selected

The Devil has two very masterful tricks. The first is to tempt us to become discouraged, for then we are defeated and of no service to others, at least for a while. The other is to tempt us to doubt, thereby breaking the bond of faith that unites us with the Father. So watch out! Do not be tricked either way.

G. E. M.

I like to cultivate the spirit of happiness! It retunes my soul and keeps it so perfectly in tune that Satan is afraid to touch it. Satan is always wary of interfering with me when my heart is full of the happiness and joy of the Holy Spirit. My plan is simply to shun the spirit of sadness as I would normally shun Satan, but unfortunately I am not always successful.

October 17

May I never boast except in the cross of our Lord Jesus Christ, through which the world has been crucified to me, and I to the world. (Galatians 6:14)

They were people who were living to themselves. Their hopes, promises, and dreams still controlled them, but the Lord began to fulfill their prayers. They had asked for a repentant heart and had surrendered themselves with a willingness to pay any price for it, and He sent them sorrow. They had asked for purity, and He sent them sudden anguish. They had asked for meekness, and He had broken their hearts. They had asked to be dead to the world, and He killed all their living hopes. They had asked to be made like Him, so

沉重的心實在是拉倒我們不再聖潔和被神使用的重力。進入應許地的以色列人的失敗始於埋怨，或如經文所說：「以色列眾人……發怨言」（民14:2）。開始時只是來投訴不滿地方的微弱渴望，但他們容許這個繼續，直至它開花結果，長成完全的叛逆敗落。

我們永不要讓我們隨意來懷疑神或在任何事上懷疑祂向我們永恆的愛和信實。

選

魔鬼有兩個拿手詭計：一、誘導我們沮喪，就在我們至小有一會兒曾不肯服事他人上失敗；二、誘導我們懷疑，在那裏弄斷聯於天父信的連繫。所以要小心！不要被這詭計得逞。

G.E.M.

我喜愛培育快樂之靈！它重新調度我的生命，使生命保持在完美的調度下，就是撒但也害怕來觸碰它。撒但總會留神地在我心充滿聖靈的歡欣和喜樂時騷擾我。我的方法就是簡單地躲避那傷心之靈，正如我經常躲避撒但一樣，但不幸的是我不是總能成功的。

十月十七日

「但我斷不以別的誇口，只誇我們主耶穌基督的十字架，因這十字架，就我而論，世界已經釘在十字架上；就世界而論，我已經釘在十字架上。」（加6:14）

為自己而活之人的盼望、承諾和夢想仍管控他們，但主開始垂聽他們的禱告。他們祈求悔改的心，獻上自己，甘付任何代價，因此祂給他們憂慮；他們祈求純潔，祂便給他們突如其來的鬍怒；他們祈求仁慈，祂便破碎他們的心；他們祈求在地上死，祂卻叫他們一切的希望幻滅；他們祈求像祂，因此祂把他們放入火爐中，「如煉淨銀子

He placed them in the fire “as a refiner and purifier of silver” (Mal. 3:3), until they could reflect His image. They had asked to help carry His cross, yet when He held it out to them, it cut and tore their hands.

They found it easier to obey than to suffer, to work than to give up, and to carry the cross than to hang upon it. But now they could not turn back, for they had come too close to the unseen cross of the spiritual life, and its virtues had pierced them too deeply. And the Lord was fulfilling this promise of His to them: “I, when I am lifted up from the earth, will draw all men to myself” (John 12:32).

Who “follow the Lamb wherever he goes” (Rev. 14:4).

Anonymous

October 18

Know for certain that your descendants will be strangers in a country not their own, and they will be ... mistreated four hundred years. But ... afterward they will come out with great possessions. (Genesis 15:13-14)

I can be sure that part of God's promised blessing to me is delay and suffering. The delay in Abraham's lifetime that seemed to put God's promise well beyond fulfillment was then followed by the seemingly unending delay experienced by Abraham's descendants. But it was indeed only a delay—the promise was fulfilled, for ultimately they did “come out with great possessions.” God is going to test me with delays, and along with the delays will come suffering. Yet through it all God's promise stands. I have His new covenant in Christ, and His sacred promise of every smaller blessing that I need. The delays and the suffering are actually part of the promised blessings, so may I praise Him for them today. May I “be strong and take heart and wait for the Lord” (Ps. 27:14).

Charles Gallaudet Trumbull

October 19

The ark of the covenant of the Lord went before them. (Numbers 10:33)

Consider when Jeremiah felt God leading him to purchase the field at Anathoth. He did not act on his initial feeling but waited for God to completely fulfill His words to him before taking action. Then once his

的.....熬煉他們像金銀一樣。」(瑪3:3) 直至他們能反照自己；他們祈求有分背主的十字架，當祂舉向他們時，它割破他們的手。

他們發現順服比受苦還容易，擔起工作比放棄容易，背起十字架比擔起它容易。如今他們不能回頭，因他們已來到太接近屬靈生命那不可見的十字架，它的益處已深刺他們。主向他們所應許的也達成了。「我若從地上被舉起來，就要吸引萬人來歸我。」(約12:32)

「羔羊無論往哪裏去，他們都跟隨祂」(啟14:4)。

佚名

十月十八日

「你要的確知道，你的後裔必寄居別人的地.....那地的人要苦待他們四百年.....後來他們必帶着許多財物從那裏出來。」(創15:13-14)

我肯定的是有部分神應許我的祝福遲來而叫我苦惱。亞伯拉罕生命中的遲延似乎說神的應許離應驗很遠，而亞伯拉罕得後裔的應驗也似乎無盡的延遲。但這真的只是延遲，應許終也應驗，至終他們真的「帶着許多財物從那裏出來。」神用遲延試驗我，隨着延遲而來的是苦痛。但經過這些之後神一切的應許也真的實現了。我有的是在基督裏的新命令，和我所需要每項較小祝福的神聖應許，延遲和苦痛事實上是所應許祝福的一部分，因此我今日就可為這些來讚美祂。我好應「壯膽，堅固你的心。我再說：要等候耶和華。」(詩27:14)

查理士·哥洛地·湛布

十月十九日

「耶和華的約櫃在前頭行。」(民10:33)

看看耶利米如何感受到神帶領他置買亞拿突的那塊地。他不是即時在感覺初期作出回應，而是等到祂完全成就祂的話時才採取行

cousin came to him, bringing the external evidence of God's direction by making a proposal for the purchase, he responded and said, "I knew that this was the word of the Lord" (Jer. 32:8).

We are not to ignore the Shepherd's personal voice to us, but like "Paul and his companions" (Acts 16:6) at Troas, we are to listen and also examine His providential work in our circumstances, in order to glean the full mind of the Lord.

A. B. Simpson

Wherever God's finger points, His hand will clear a way.

selected

October 20

The peace of God, which transcends all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus. (Philippians 4:7)

There is a part of the sea known as "the cushion of the sea." It lies beneath the surface that is agitated by storms and churned by the wind. It is so deep that it is a part of the sea that is never stirred. When the ocean floor in these deep places is dredged of the remains of plant or animal life, it reveals evidence of having remained completely undisturbed for hundreds, if not thousands, of years.

The peace of God is an eternal calm like the cushion of the sea. It lies so deeply within the human heart that no external difficulty or disturbance can reach it. And anyone who enters the presence of God becomes a partaker of that undisturbed and undisturbable calm.

Arthur Tappan Pierson

Pilgrim was taken to a large upper room that faced the sunrise. And the name of the room was Peace.

from Pilgrim's Progress

October 21

Now we know that if the earthly tent we live in is destroyed, we have a building from God, an eternal house in heaven, not built by human hands. (2 Corinthians 5:1)

The words of Jesus during His last days on earth vividly express His desire to go "back to the Father"

動。所以當他侄兒一來找他，作出置買的提議作為神旨意的外在證明時，他回應說：「我耶利米就知道這是耶和華的話。」(耶32:8)

我們不是要忽略牧羊人給我們的體己聲音，而是要像「保羅和他同伴」(徒16:6)在特羅亞般要聽和同時以環境來驗證祂的旨意，為的要查明神全盤的意思。

宣信

每當神指點動時，祂的手也必開路。

選

十月二十日

「神所賜出人意外的平安，必在基督耶穌裏，保守你們的心懷意念。」(腓4:7)

有海洋的一部分稱為「海洋坐墊」的，處於海面之下風浪不能攪動之處，因為在海極深的部分，以致不被攪擾。在這些極深海床之處所撈獲的動植物的殘餘物中，顯明他們完全不受干擾上百千年了。

神的平安也像海洋坐墊般的永恆寧靜，它位於人心內極深極深處，因此沒有外來的困難或干擾能觸及它。任何進到神所在那處的人都可有分於不受干擾和不能干擾的平靜。

亞瑟·塔斌·皮爾遜

天路客被帶進樓上望向日出的一所大房子，這所房子的名字是「平安」。

摘自《天路歷程》

十月二十一日

「我們原知道，我們這地上的帳棚若拆毀了，必得神所造，不是人手所造，在天上永存的房屋。」(林後5:1)

耶穌在地上最後幾天的話生動表達祂「往父那裏去」(約16:28)

(John 16:28). We, as His people, also have a vision of something far beyond the difficulties and disappointments of this life and are traveling toward fulfillment, completion, and an enriched life. We too are going "to the Father." Much of our new home is still unclear to us, but two things are certain. Our "Father's house" (John 14:2) is our home. And it is in the presence of the Lord. As believers, we know and understand that we are all travelers and not permanent residents of this world.

R. C. Gillie

October 22

Now Moses was tending the flock of Jethro his father-in-law, the priest of Midian, and he led the flock to the far side of the desert and came to Horeb, the mountain of God. There the angel of the Lord appeared to him in flames of fire from within a bush. (Exodus 3:1-2)

The vision of the Angel of the Lord came to Moses while he was involved in his everyday work. That is exactly where the Lord delights in giving His revelations. He seeks a man traveling an ordinary road, and "suddenly a light from heaven" (Acts 9:3) shines on him. And a "stairway resting on the earth" (Gen. 28:12) can reach from the marketplace to heaven, transforming a life from one of drudgery to one of grace.

Those high spiritual times and wonderful communication with the unseen world are not promised to us, but a daily life of communion with Him is. And it is enough for us, for He will give us those times of exceptional revelation if it is the right thing for us.

There were only three disciples allowed to see the Transfiguration, and the same three also experienced the darkness of Gethsemane. No one can stay on the mountaintop of favor forever, for there are responsibilities in the valley. Christ fulfilled His life's work not in the glory but in the valley, and it was there He was truly and completely the Messiah. The value of the vision and the accompanying glory is its gift of equipping us for service and endurance.

selected

October 23

Not one word has failed of all the good promises

的渴望。作祂子民的我們該有越過今生艱苦和失望的視野，我們且正朝實現和完成那豐富的生命而進發。我們是「往父那裏去」。新家的大部分東西我們都不清楚，但有兩件事是肯定的：一、我們「父的家」(約14:2)就是我們的家；二、這家有主的同在。作為信徒，我們知道和明白我們都是客旅，不是世上的永久住客。

R. C. 基利

十月二十二日

「摩西牧養他岳父米甸祭司葉忒羅的羊群，一日領羊群往野外去，到了神的山，就是何烈山。耶和華的使者從荊棘裏火焰中向摩西顯現。」(出3:1-2)

摩西得見耶和華的使者時他正進行日常事務，這也正是神喜悅發出祂啟示之所。祂尋找那個在尋常路上行走的人，「忽然從天上發光」(徒9:3)照向他。循那「立在地上的梯子」(創28:12)就可以從市集往天上去了，從苦工的生活搖身一變成為蒙恩的生活。

應許我們的並不是那些高超屬靈的時刻和與不可見世界的超然經歷，而是每天與祂交通的生命。這對我們已足夠了，因為祂會在看我們合適時來叫那些額外啟示的時刻來到。

只有三個門徒蒙恩得見主變像，也是這相同的三個門徒得經歷客西馬尼園的黑暗。無人可永遠留在稱心的峰頂，因山谷下有該盡的責任。基督的生命工作不是在榮耀而是在山谷中作成的，真正成為彌賽亞也是在那裏。異象和所附帶之榮耀的價值只是用來裝備我們事奉和忍耐的禮物吧了。

選

十月二十三日

「凡.....應許賜福的話，一句都沒

he gave. (1 Kings 8:56)

Someday we will understand that God has a reason behind every no He gives us through the course of our lives. Yet even in this life, He always makes it up to us. When God's people are worried and concerned that their prayers are not being answered, how often we have seen Him working to answer them in a far greater way! Occasionally we catch a glimpse of this, but the complete revelation of it will not be seen until later.

If only we had the faith not to rush into things but to "be still before the Lord and wait patiently for him" (Ps. 37:7)—waiting for His full explanation that will not be revealed until Jesus Christ comes again!

selected

October 24

I will make you into a threshing sledge, new and sharp. (Isaiah 41:15)

Around the turn of the twentieth century, a bar of steel was worth about \$5. Yet when forged into horseshoes, it was worth \$10; when made into needles, its value was \$350; when used to make small pocketknife blades, its worth was \$32,000; when made into springs for watches, its value increased to \$250, 000. What a pounding the steel bar had to endure to be worth this much! But the more it was shaped, hammered, put through fire, beaten, pounded, and polished, the greater its value. May we use this analogy as a reminder to be still, silent, and long-suffering, for it is those who suffer the most who yield the most. And it is through pain that God gets the most out of us, for His glory and for the blessing of others.

selected

October 25

Until now you have not asked for anything in my name. Ask and you will receive, and your joy will be complete. (John 16:24)

During the American Civil War, a certain man had a son who enlisted in the Union army. Once his son had left, he became deeply interested in the plight of soldiers, often to the neglect of his business, he began spending his time and money to care for the soldiers who came home disabled.

A young private in a faded, worn uniform

有落空。」(王上8:56)

終有一日我們會明白神在祂給我們走過的生命過程中說不的背後原因，然而在這生命中，祂總讓這作為我們的責任。當神的子民擔憂他們的禱告未蒙垂聽時，我們經常看見祂以一好不知多少倍的方法來回應！偶爾我們得瞥見這個，但這個的完整啟示要遲些才能得見。

但願我們有不冒失的信心，要「默然倚靠耶和華，耐性等候祂。」(詩37:7)等到耶穌基督再來時便得到祂全面解釋的揭示！

選

十月二十四日

「看哪，我已使你成為有快齒打糧的新器具。」(賽41:15)

二十世紀末時，一條鋼條值五元。若煉製成馬蹄鐵，它值十元；若作成針，它值三百五十元了；若用來製成摺合小袋刀的刀片，它值三萬二千元；若製成手表的彈簧時，它的價值會增至二十五萬元。這條鋼條能得着這巨大的價值要忍受何等的連續鎚打！它越被模造、鎚打、火煉、打造、重擊和打磨，便得越大的價值。讓我們以這比擬作為我們要安穩、平靜和長久忍耐的提醒，因為那些忍受得最多的人所產生的價值也越大。神是藉着痛苦來從我們身上得着最多，得的是祂的榮耀和別人所得的祝福。

選

十月二十五日

「向來你們沒有奉我的名求甚麼，如今你們求就必得着，叫你們的喜樂可以滿足。」(約16:24)

在美國內戰期間，某銀行家的兒子徵召入聯軍中。他的兒子一離開，他時常忽略他的生意，卻開始花時間和金錢來照顧那些因傷殘而歸家的士兵。

一個穿著褪色破舊制服的二

stepped into the bank, pulled out a scrap of dirty paper with the following words written in pencil:

Dear Father,

This is one of my friends, who was wounded in the last battle and is coming to you directly from the hospital. Please receive him as you would me.

Charlie

The banker quickly flew away. He took the young man to his own magnificent home and gave him Charlie's room and seat at the dinner table. He cared for him until the food, rest, and love had returned him to health, and then sent him back to his place of service to again risk his life for his country's flag.

selected

Now you will see what I will do. Exodus 6:1

October 26

He went up on a mountainside by himself to pray. When evening came, he was there alone. (Matthew 14:23)

Christ Jesus, in His humanity, felt the need of complete solitude—to be entirely by Himself, alone with Himself. Each of us knows how draining constant interchange with others can be and how it exhausts our energy. God desires that every servant of His would understand and perform this blessed practice, that His church would know how to train its children to recognize this high and holy privilege, and that every believer would realize the importance of making time for God alone.

Oh, the thought of having God all alone to myself and knowing that God has me all alone to Himself!

Andrew Murray

Jesus said, "Go into your room, close the door and pray" (Matt. 6:6), for it is in quiet solitude that we catch the deep and mysterious truths that flow from the soul of the things God allows to enter our lives.

A Meditation

"When he was alone with his own disciples, he explained everything" (Mark 4:34). Let them "go away one at a time ... until only Jesus [is] left" (John 8:9)

等兵步入銀行，抽出一細片骯髒的紙條，在上寫着：

親愛的父親：

這是我的一個朋友，他在上一場戰役中受傷，從醫院直接來到你處，請你收納他如同收納我一樣。

查理

那銀行家速離銀行，帶這年輕人到他華麗的家，給他住上查理的房間，同坐餐桌進餐。他照顧他直至那些食物、休息和愛使他回復健康，之後把他送返軍處，再次為國家的旗幟而冒生命的危險。

選

「現在你必看見我.....所行的事。」(出6:1)

十月二十六日

「祂就獨自上山去禱告。到了晚上，只有祂一人在那裏。」(太14:23)

人子基督耶穌感到有完全獨處——只得祂自己，獨自一人——的需要。我們每個都知不斷與人交往如何筋疲力竭和耗盡精力。神渴望每一個祂的僕人明白和實行這蒙福的操作，也渴望祂的教會知道如何去訓練其兒女得認清這高尚和神聖的殊榮，並渴望每一個信徒可明瞭抽時間與神獨處的重要性。

噢，獨有神與我一起和神獨有我與祂一起，這是何等的蒙福！

慕·安德烈

耶穌說：「進你的內屋，關上門，禱告」(太6:6)，在獨處中我們能抓住神容許流進我們生命的高深和神秘真理。

默想

「沒有人的時候，就把一切的道講給門徒聽。」(可4:34)讓他們「一個一個的出去，只剩下耶穌

with you.

George Matheson

October 27

All your waves and breakers have swept over me.
(Psalm 42:7)

Stand firmly in the place where your dear Lord has put you, and do your best there. God sends us trials or tests, and places life before us as a face-to-face opponent. It is through the pounding of a serious conflict that He expects us to grow strong. The tree planted where the fierce winds twist its branches and bend its trunk, often nearly to the point of breaking, is commonly more firmly rooted than a tree growing in a secluded valley where storms never bring any stress or strain. The same is true of human life. The strongest and greatest character is grown through hardship.

selected

October 28

Because of his great love for us, God, who is rich in mercy, made us alive with Christ even when we were dead in transgressions And God raised us up with Christ and seated us with him in the heavenly realms in Christ Jesus. (Ephesians 2:4-6)

This is our rightful place—"seated ... with him in the heavenly realms in Christ Jesus," yet seated and still.

There is tremendous power in stillness. All things come to him who knows how to trust and to be silent, we would "sit down" inwardly before the Lord, allowing the divine forces of His Spirit to silently work out the means to accomplish our goals and aspirations. You may not see or feel the inner workings of His silent power, but rest assured it is always mightily at work. And it will work for you, if you will only quiet your spirit enough to be carried along by the current of its power.

Hannah Whitall Smith

October 29

He will sit as a refiner and purifier of silver. (Malachi 3:3)

It is with the most precious metals that a metallurgist will take the greatest care. He subjects the metal to a hot fire, for only the refiner's fire will melt

一人」(約8:9)和你一起。

喬治·馬得勝

十月二十七日

「祢的波浪洪濤漫過我身。」(詩42:7)

在你親愛的主所安放你之處牢牢站穩，在那裏竭盡所能。神賜我們試煉或試驗，擺在我們面前的人生就像一個面對面的對手。祂叫我們經歷一連串衝擊的拍打，是期望我們長得強壯。種植在樹枝經常有烈風紐扯和樹身壓彎以至幾乎折斷的樹，植根常比種植在從來沒有風暴帶來脅迫和拉扯的幽靜山谷的樹來得穩固。這於人的生命也是對的，最強和最偉大的性格是經歷困難長成的。

選

十月二十八日

「然而神既有豐富的憐憫，因祂愛我們的大愛，當我們死在過犯中的時候，便叫我們與基督一同活過來。祂又叫我們與基督耶穌一同復活，一同坐在天上。」(弗2:4-6)

「與基督耶穌.....一同坐在天上」是我們當然且穩坐的地位，但我們真有這樣經驗的人何等少！

在靜中有驚人的力量，一個懂得信靠的人就在任何事臨到時都能平靜安穩，我們可在裏頭「坐在」主面前，蒙聖靈將那聖潔的能力運行出來，以致我們的目標和願望得以達成。你也許見不到感覺不到祂靜中能力的作為，但因確信於祂大能的作為而心安。只要你的靈安靜至任讓那浪濤之力來帶動，這大能大力便會來為你工作。

漢娜·韋滔·史勿夫

十月二十九日

「祂必坐下如煉淨銀子的。」(瑪3:3)

冶金者會以極大的留心來處理那些最貴重的金屬，他使那金屬經受熱火，因為只有煉金者的火才

the metal, release the dross, and allow the remaining, pure metal to take a new and perfect shape in the mold.

A good refiner never leaves the crucible but, as the above verse indicates, “will sit” down by it so the fire will not become even one degree too hot and possibly harm the metal. And as soon as he skims the last bit of dross from the surface and sees his face reflected in the pure metal, he extinguishes the fire.

Arthur Tappan Pierson

October 30

Let us run with patience. (Hebrews 12:1 KJV)

Running suggests the absence of patience, or an eagerness to reach the goal. Yet we often associate patience with lying down or standing still. We think of it as an angel who guards the bed of the disabled. The patience that runs is harder to obtain. Lying down during a time of grief, or being quiet after a financial setback, certainly implies great strength. The power to continue working after a setback suggests even greater strength, and the power to perform your daily tasks with deep sorrow in your spirit. This is a Christlike thing!

Many of us could tearlessly deal with our grief if only we were allowed to do so in private. Yet what is so difficult is that most of us are called to exercise our patience not in bed but in the open street, for all to see. No other way of burying our sorrow is as difficult as this, for it is truly what is meant by running “with patience.”

Dear Son of Man, I see You at Cana of Galilee, turning water into wine so the marriage feast would not be ruined. I see You in the desert, feeding the multitude with bread, simply to relieve a temporary need. Yet all the time, You were bearing a mighty grief—not shared or spoken. Others may ask for a “rainbow in the clouds” (Gen. 9:13), but I would ask for even more from You. Make me, in my cloud, a rainbow bringing the ministry of joy to others. My patience will only be perfect when it works in Your vineyard.

George Matheson

October 31

In the same way, the Spirit helps us in our weakness. We

能熔解那金屬，釋出滓渣，致使所存留的純正金屬適用模中所帶來的嶄新和完美的形狀。

一個好的煉金者不會離開熔罐，卻如文首經文所說在熔罐旁「坐」下，不使一度太熱而傷害那金屬。一旦從金屬表面上撇去最後一點渣滓，得從那純正的金屬反照自己的面貌時，他才會把火熄滅。

亞瑟·塔班·皮爾遜

十月三十日

「我們就當存心忍耐，奔……」(來12:1)

奔跑意味着沒有忍耐，或者達至目標的殷切；我們卻常將忍耐聯繫上臥下或站穩。我們會想到忍耐就是一個守護在殘廢之人床邊的天使。奔跑的忍耐更難達成。在憂傷之時臥下，或在經濟倒退下的安靜肯定意味着更大的力量。在倒退下仍繼續工作有更大的力量，當心靈中有極深的傷痛下仍去履行日務，這力量像基督。

若容許我們私下落淚，我們多人能夠在處理憂傷時不流淚。然而對我們大多數人來說，真正的困難不在床上而在公開的街上來行使忍耐。沒有埋藏我們的憂傷比這個更困難，因為這是「存心忍耐」來奔跑的真正意義。

親愛的人子啊，在加利利的加拿我見祢將水變酒為叫婚宴不被破壞。我也見祢在曠野到用餅餵飽那群眾，是為了舒減那臨時的需要。然而任何時候祢肩負無人可分享或訴說這極大的憂傷。他人或會祈求「雲中的彩虹」(創19:13)，我卻向祢求取更多，在我的雲中使我成為一道帶給別人喜樂之事奉的彩虹。惟有在祢葡萄園的忍耐才會作得完美。

喬治·馬得勝

十月三十一日

「況且我們的軟弱有聖靈幫助，我

do not know what we ought to pray for, but the Spirit himself intercedes for us with groans that words cannot express. And he who searches our hearts knows the mind of the Spirit, because the Spirit intercedes for the saints in accordance with God's will. (Romans 8:26-27)

Prayers are "groans that words cannot express." We cannot always express them ourselves, and often all we understand is that God is praying in us for something that only He understands and that needs His touch. So we can simply pour from the fullness of our heart the burden of our spirit and the sorrow that seems to crush us. We can know that He hears, loves, understands, receives, and separates from our prayer everything that is in error, imperfect, or wrong. And then He presents the remainder, along with the incense of the great High Priest, before His throne on high. We may be assured that our prayer is heard, accepted, and answered in His name.

A. B. Simpson

It is not necessary to be continually speaking to God, for there is an unspeakable fellowship that is sweeter than words. A little child can sit all day long beside his mother, totally engrossed in his playing, while his mother is consumed by her work, and although both are busy and few words are spoken by either, they are in perfect fellowship. The child knows his mother is there, and she knows that he is all right.

selected

November 1

When the cloud remained ... the Israelites ... did not set out. (Numbers 9:19)

Floating ahead seems pleasant. Yet having to wait was another story altogether.

"I waited patiently for the LORD; he turned to me and heard my cry" (Ps. 40:1). And what God did for the Old Testament saints, He will do for believers down through the ages, yet He will often keep us waiting.

When God sends no answer and "the cloud remain[s]," we must wait. Yet we can do so with the full assurance of God's provision of manna, water from the rock, shelter, and protection from our enemies.

from Daily Devotional Commentary

November 2

們本不曉得當怎樣禱告，只是聖靈親自用說不出來的歎息，替我們禱告。鑒察人心的，曉得聖靈的意思，因為聖靈照着神的旨意替聖徒祈求。」(羅8:26-27)

禱告是「說不出來的歎息」。我們本身不能說這個，人所常能明白的是神在我們裏面祈求，只祂明白和需祂觸動的東西。因此我們只需將塞滿心靈裏的重擔和那些似乎壓扁我們的憂傷盡數傾訴。我們所能知道的就是祂聆聽、愛護、明白、接納和將每樣誤解、不完全、和錯誤祈禱的東西分隔出來，之後祂會將餘下的，隨着那偉大的大祭司所獻的香上升到祂寶座面前。我們確實知道我們奉祂名而作的祈禱必蒙垂聽，接納和得回應的。

宣信

要與神有交通和契合是不需要持續不停向神說話，說不出來的契合比言語更甜美。一個小孩子可以整天坐在媽媽身旁，完全埋首玩耍，而媽媽也耗盡心神在她的工作上，雖然他們二人都因忙碌而任何一方也不多說話，然而他們是在完美的契合中的，那小孩知道媽媽在那裏，她也知道他凡事安好。

選

十一月一日

「雲彩在帳幕上停留……，以色列人就……不起行。」(民9:19)

起行看起來是歡快的；等待卻又是另一回事了。

「我曾耐性等候耶和華，祂垂聽我的呼求。」(詩40:1)神作在舊約聖徒身上的，也必作在歷世歷代信徒身上，但祂常叫我們等待。

若神未垂聽，而「雲彩在帳幕上停留」時，我們定須等待。然而這等待是有神供應嗎哪、磐石出水、蔭庇和脫離敵人的確據。

摘自《每日靈修註釋》

十一月二日

Peter was kept in prison, but the church was earnestly praying to God for him. (Acts 12:5)

“But the church was earnestly praying to God for him.” So what was the outcome? The prison was miraculously opened, the apostle freed, the Jews bewildered, and as a display of God’s punishment, wicked King Herod “was eaten by worms and died.” And rolling on to even greater victory, “the word of God continued to increase and spread” (vv. 23-24).

God baptizes us with holy boldness and divine confidence, for He is looking not for great people but for people who will dare to prove the greatness of their God! “But the church was earnestly praying.”

A. B. Simpson

In your prayers, above everything else, beware of limiting God, not only through unbelief but also by thinking you know exactly what He can do. Learn to expect the unexpected, beyond all that you ask or think.

So each time you intercede through prayer, first be quiet and worship God in His glory. Think of what He can do, how He delights in Christ His Son, and of your place in Him—then expect great things.

Andrew Murray

Our prayers are God’s opportunities.

Prayer can make your time of affliction one of strength and sweetness. Prayer can add a heavenly fragrance to your time of joy. Prayer can place an angel by your side whose very touch could shatter a millstone into smaller grains of dust than the flour it grinds, and whose glance could destroy an entire army. Everything that God can do for you. “Ask for whatever you want me to give you” (2 Chron. 1:7).

Frederick William Farrar

November 3

You who bring good tidings to Zion, go up on a high mountain. (Isaiah 40:9)

Toys and trinkets are easily earned, but the most valuable things carry a heavy price. The highest places of power are always bought with blood, and you can attain those pinnacles if you have enough blood to pay. That is the condition of conquering holy heights everywhere. The story of true heroics is always the story of sacrificial blood. The greatest values and

「於是彼得被囚在監裏。教會卻為他切切的禱告神。」(徒12:5)

「教會卻為他切切的禱告神」。結果是監門奇蹟地開啟，使徒得自由，猶太人手足無措，邪惡的希律王亦「被蟲所咬，氣就絕了」(徒12:23)來顯示神的懲罰，而「神的道日見興旺，越發廣傳」(徒12:24)是更大勝利的擂鼓。

神用神聖的勇敢和確信替我們施浸，為的不是尋找偉大的人，而是敢於證明他們的神是偉大的人！「教會卻為他切切的禱告神。」
宣信

若在你的禱告中察覺在凡事上限制神(不單止藉着不信，且也藉認為你完全知道神所能作的)時，學習期待那意料之外的，就是超過一切你所求所想的。

每次你禱告代求時，先安靜向榮耀的神敬拜，想想祂所能作的，祂如何喜悅基督祂的兒子，和你在基督裏的位置，之後期待大事吧。
慕·安德烈

我們的禱告替神製造機會。

禱告能使你憂傷的時刻變成為得力和甜美。禱告能使你喜樂的時間增添屬天的香氣。禱告能將天使放在你身旁，他的每一觸碰都能碾碎一磨石成為比它所磨麵粉更幼細，他的一瞥能摧毀全軍。神能為你作每一樣的事。「你願我賜你甚麼，你可以求。」(代下1:7)

弗特烈·威廉·法拉

十一月三日

「報好消息給錫安的阿，你要登高山。」(賽40:9)

玩具和小裝飾品容易賺取，但最貴重的東西乘載巨大價值。最高位置的權力總要用血買來，若你能付出足夠的血，便能獲得那些高位，每處征討神聖高位的常是這樣，真正勇士的故事常也是捨身流血的故事。生命中的偉大價值和品

character in life are not blown randomly across our path by wayward winds, for great souls experience great sorrows.

November 4

I was among the exiles by the Kebar River, the heavens were opened and I saw visions of God....There the hand of the Lord was upon [me]. (Ezekiel 1:1, 3)

We have seen the Lord deliver us from captivity and “restore our fortunes, ... like streams in the Negev” (Ps. 126:4).

A person who has experienced great difficulties, over the old and tear-stained pages of his Bible, he has time and again come to the pillars of the house of God and “to Elim, where there were ... palm trees” (Ex. 15:27). And each of those pillars and trees have become a remembrance for him of some critical time in his life.

No calamity will ever bring only evil to us, if we will immediately take it in fervent prayer to God.

Like Jacob, we must cross “the ford of the Jabbok” (Gen. 32:22) if we are ever to arrive at Peniel, where he wrestled with the Lord, was blessed by Him, and could say, “I saw God face to face, and yet my life was spared” (Gen. 32:30).

God will give you “songs in the night” (Job 35:10) and will turn your “blackness into dawn” (Amos 5:8).

Nathaniel William Taylor

November 5

Is anything too hard for the Lord? (Genesis 18:14)

This is God’s loving challenge to you and me each day. He wants us to think of the deepest, highest, and worthiest desires and longings of our hearts.

As long as it aligns with what we know to be His expressed will, if we will let Him, God will do that very thing, even if we know it is such an utter impossibility that we would simply laugh at the absurdity of anyone ever suggesting it could come to pass.

“Is anything too hard for the Lord?” The only thing “too hard for the Lord” is our deliberate and continual disbelief in His love and power, and our ultimate rejection of His plans for us. Nothing is impossible for Jehovah to do for those who trust Him.

from Messages for the Morning Watch

格不是由無定向的風任意地吹過我們走過的路徑上的，因為只有偉大的靈魂才能經歷偉大的創傷。

十一月四日

「我在迦巴魯河邊被擄的人中，天就開了，得見神的異象.....耶和華的手降在他身上。」（結1:1, 3）

我們已見到耶和華使「被擄的人歸回，好像南地的河水複流。」（詩126:4）

曾經歷重大困難的人，他老舊的聖經的書頁上滿有淚痕，他有時來到神家的柱子，來到「了以琳，在那裏有.....棕樹」（出15:27）。每一根這些柱子和樹都成為他人生某些值得記念危急時刻。

從沒只帶來不幸的困苦，只要我們立即為此熱切禱告神。

我們定須如雅各般經過「雅博渡口」（創32:22）才能到達與神摔跤的毘努伊勒，因而受祝福，和能夠說：「我面對面見了神，我的性命仍得保全。」（創32:30）

神必會使你「夜間歌唱」（伯35:10），也必會使你的「死蔭變為晨光。」（摩5:8）。

尼坦尼爾·威廉·泰萊

十一月五日

「耶和華豈有難成的事麼？」（創18:14）

你我每日接受的挑戰出於神的愛，祂想我們想及心中最深、最高和最有價值的熱愛和渴望。

只要與我們所認識祂曾說過的旨意一致，只要我們讓祂來作，祂必會作成這個，那怕我們認為絕對沒有可能，連我們也會平白地嘲笑任何說這樣話路過之人的荒謬。

「耶和華豈有難成的事麼？」唯一難成的事是我們在祂的愛和能力上蓄意和持續不信，和極力抗拒祂給我們的計劃。對於信祂的人有耶和華作不來的事。

摘自《晨更信息》

November 6

Those whom I love I rebuke and discipline. (Revelation 3:19)

God selects the best and most notable of His servants for the best and most notable afflictions, for those who have received the most grace from Him are able to endure the most afflictions. He does not haphazardly aim His arrows, for each one is on a special mission and touches only the heart for whom it is intended. It is not only the grace of God but also His glory that is revealed when a believer can stand and quietly endure an affliction.

Joseph Caryl

Dear Lord, do not punish me by removing my cross from me. Instead, comfort me by leading me into submission to Your will and by causing me to love the cross.

a captive's prayer

November 7

Whatever was to my profit I now consider loss for the sake of Christ. (Philippians 3:7)

George Matheson, the blind Scottish preacher, who was so beautifully and significantly honored, wrote the "the most severe mental suffering," hymn in 1882 in five minutes.

There is a legend of an artist who had found the secret of a wonderful red that no other artist could imitate. He never told the secret of the color, but after his death an old wound was discovered over his heart. It revealed the source of the matchless hue in his pictures.

No great achievement can be made, no lofty goal attained, nor anything of great value to the world accomplished, except at the cost of the heart's blood.

November 8

He took Peter, John and James with him and went up onto a mountain to pray. As he was praying, the appearance of his face changed, and his clothes became as bright as a flash of lightning.... Peter and his companions ... saw his glory. (Luke 9:28-29, 32)

If you are pleased with me, teach me your ways. (Exodus 33:13)

十一月六日

「凡我所疼愛的，我就責備管教他。」(啟3:19)

神揀選祂最好和最觸的僕人經歷最大和最顯著的苦難，因為那些從祂得着最多恩惠的人才能夠忍受那些最嚴峻的苦難。神的箭不會偶發，每一枝箭都有一特別任務，只瞄向那些心會受感動的人。這不單止是神的恩典，且是向能站穩和靜靜忍受苦難信徒之神的榮耀。

約瑟·卡利奧

親愛的主啊，不要從我身上移走我的十字架來懲罰我，反而要領我順服於祢的旨意和使我愛上十字架來安慰我。

《一個被擄者的祈禱》

十一月七日

「只是我先前以為與我有益的，我現在因基督都當作有損的。」(腓3:7)

備受尊崇的瞎眼傳道者喬治·馬得勝在1882年寫了這首五分鐘內寫成「最嚴峻精神上痛苦」的聖詩。

傳說中有一藝術家找到其他藝術家不能模仿得出奇妙紅色的秘訣。他從沒有告訴人這顏色的秘密，直至他死後有人發現他心上的傷口，這揭示出他畫作中無比顏色的來源。

偉大的成就作不成，崇高的目標達不到，世上任何高價值的東西也作不來，除非付上心血的代價。

十一月八日

「耶穌帶着彼得、約翰、雅各，上山去禱告。正禱告的時候，祂的面貌就改變了，衣服潔白放光。……彼得和他的同伴都……看見耶穌的榮光。」(路9:28-29,32)

「我如今若在祢眼前蒙恩，求祢將祢的道指示我。」(出33:13)

The three disciples “saw his glory” and said, “It is good for us to be here” (Luke 9:32-33). Heaven is never far from those who linger on a mountain with their Lord.

Who of us in certain moments of meditation and prayer has not caught a glimpse of the heavenly gates? Who has not in the secret place of holy communion felt a surging wave of emotion—a taste of the blessed joy yet to come?

Every Christian should have his own Mount of Olives. Even Daniel needed to have his Mount of Olives in his room amid the roar of idolatrous Babylon. Peter found a rooftop in Joppa, and Martin Luther found an “upper room” in Wittenberg, a place that is still considered sacred.

And this is the world’s need today—people who have seen their Lord.

from *The Lost Art of Meditation*

November 9

Men will dwell again in his shade. He will flourish like the grain. He will blossom like a vine. (Hosea 14:7)

The plants in my garden were beaten down by the pelting storm. Yet the night passed, the sun shone again, and the morning brought strength to my favorite plant. The light looked at its flowers and the flowers looked at the light. There was contact and communion, and power passed into the flowers. They lifted their heads, opened their petals, regained their glory, and seemed more beautiful than before.

I cannot explain exactly how we are able to receive the power to serve and to endure through communion with God, but I know it is a fact. God has promised, “I will strengthen you” (Isa. 41:10).

November 10

Against all hope, Abraham in hope believed. (Romans 4:18)

It is simply to your advantage to rely with confidence upon the Word of God. And although He may delay in sending His help, and the evil you are experiencing may seem to become worse and worse, do not be weak. Instead, be strong and rejoice, for God usually steps forward to save us when we least expect it, fulfilling His most glorious promises in a miraculous way.

「看見耶穌的榮光」的三門徒說：「我們在這裏真好」（路 9:32-33）。天堂對那些與主在山上徘徊的人來說永不會是遠的。

我們可在默想或祈禱的時刻中得瞥見天堂之門，在與主有神聖相交的密室中感受過那股情感洶湧的巨浪，預嘗要來的屬天喜樂。

每一個基督徒都該有自己的橄欖山。在鼓譟拜偶像的巴比倫國中的但以理需在他房子裏有橄欖山。彼得的在約帕的屋頂，馬丁·路德的在威騰堡的樓上房子裏，那處現今仍被看為神聖之所。

今天世界所需要的，就是曾看見他們主的人。

摘自《失落的默想藝術》

十一月九日

「曾住在祂蔭下的必歸回，發旺如五穀，開花如葡萄樹，祂的香氣如利巴嫩的酒。」（何14:7）

我花園中的植物被盛怒的暴風雨打倒了。但那晚過後，陽光再次照耀，早晨將力量帶給我喜愛的植物。日光看着花兒，花兒看着日光，當中有接觸有交流，能力傳送入花兒裏。他們抬起他們的頭，重新得着他們的榮耀，似乎比之前更美麗。

我不能確切解釋我們如何能得事奉的能力和持久與神相交，但我知這是一事實。神曾應許：「我必堅固你。」（賽41:10）

十一月十日

「他（亞伯拉罕）在無可指望的時候，因信仍有指望。」（羅4:18）

以信來靠賴神的話就是對你有益，雖然祂也許會延遲送來幫助，而你所體驗的不幸似乎越發變差，但不要軟弱，反要剛強和歡欣，因為神會在我們最意想不到的時候步近來拯救我們，以最不可思議的方法來達成祂榮耀的應許。

He generally waits to send His help until the time of our greatest need, so that His hand will be plainly seen in our deliverance. He chooses this method so we will not trust anything that we may see or feel, as we are so prone to do, but will place our trust solely on His Word—which we may always depend upon, no matter our circumstance.

C. H. Von Bogatzky

Remember, the very time for faith to work is when our sight begins to fail. And the greater the difficulties, the easier it is for faith to work, for as long as we can see certain natural solutions to our problems, we will not have faith. Faith never works as easily as when our natural prospects fail.

George Mueller

November 11

He will be like rain falling on a mown field. (Psalm 72:6)

Amos tells of “the king’s mowings” (Amos 7:1 KJV). Our King also has many scythes and is constantly using them to mow His lawns. In human life, we try to take a brave stand before the scythe of pain, the shears of disappointment, or the sickle of death. And just as there is no way to cultivate a lawn like velvet without repeated mowings, there is no way to develop a life of balance, tenderness, and sympathy for others without enduring the work of God’s scythes.

But do not dread God’s scythe—for it is sure to be followed by His shower.

F. B. Meyer

November 12

These were the potters, and those that dwelt among plants and hedges: there they dwelt with the king for his work. (1 Chronicles 4:23 KJV)

We may be called to serve Him in the most unlikely places and under the most adverse conditions. It may be “among plants and hedges” of all kinds—hindrances that surround us, blocking our way. Perhaps we will be one of “the potters,” with our hands full of all types of pottery, accomplishing our daily tasks.

Frances Ridley Havergal

The most saintly souls are often those who have

祂常等到我們最大需要時才送來祂的幫助，為叫我們得見祂拯救的手。祂選用這方法，好叫我們不再如傾向的來信靠任何可見可感的任何東西，卻獨獨將我們的信靠放在祂的話語上，就是我們無論在任何環境都可以常常倚靠的。

C.H.旺·保加斯基

謹記，信心生效的非常時期就在當我們的視力開始失效時。困難越大，信心越能生效，因為只要我們還有問題的天然解決辦法，我們總不會有信心。信心生效不會像我們天然的前景都失效時來得容易。

慕勒

十一月十一日

「祂必降臨，像雨降在已割的草地上。」(詩72:6)

阿摩司論到「為王割菜」(摩7:1)。我們的王有很多常用來修剪祂草地的鐮刀。生活上我們嘗試勇敢地站着忍受鐮刀之痛、失望的割切、死亡的揮鐮。若不是一次又一次的修剪，便不能養植這如天鵝絨的草坪；若沒有神持續鐮刀的工作，便沒方法發展出一鎮靜、受感和同情他人的生命。

不要恐懼祂的揮鐮，因為肯定隨之而來的是祂的愛。

邁爾

十一月十二日

「這些人都是窯匠，是尼他應和基低拉(或植物和樹籬中)的居民。與王同處，為王作工。」(代上4:23)

我們也可能被召來到最不可能之處，在最不利的環境下來服事祂。可能在各種各類的「植物和樹籬中」，四圍都是障礙物，堵塞我們的路。也許我們是其中一個「窯匠」，滿手都是各式各樣的陶器，在進行我們每日的生計中。

法蘭西斯·雷利·夏法高

最神聖的生命是那些過着內

led a quiet inner life of holiness.

Kenelm Digby

November 13

I have chosen him, so that he will direct his children.
(Genesis 18:19)

The Lord can be depended upon, and He desires for us to be just as reliable, determined, and stable. This is simply the meaning of faith.

God is looking for people on whom He can place the weight of His entire love, power, and faithful promises. And His engines are strong enough to pull any weight we may attach to them.

A. B. Simpson

No trial has ever been given to anyone that was greater than that person's strength, through God, to endure it.

November 14

Unless a kernel of wheat falls to the ground and dies, it remains only a single seed. But if it dies, it produces many seeds. (John 12:24)

In Northampton, Massachusetts, stands the old cemetery where David Brainerd is buried. Brainerd, a pioneer American missionary, died in 1747 at the age of twenty-nine after suffering from tuberculosis. His grave is beside that of Jerusha Edwards, the daughter of Jonathan Edwards, a Puritan theologian of that day.

Jonathan Edwards, that majestic old Puritan saint, who had hoped to call Brainerd his son, began to write the story of that short life in a little book.

In spite of his education, brilliance, and great opportunities, after Henry Martyn reading that little book on the life of Brainerd, threw his own life away! Afterward, what had he accomplished once he set his course toward home from India in 1812? With his health then broken, he dragged himself as far north as the town of Tokat, Turkey, near the Black Sea. There he lay in the shade of a pile of saddles, to cool his burning fever, and died alone at the age of thirty-one.

Leonard Woolsey Bacon

November 15

We were under great pressure. (2 Corinthians 1:8)

裏聖別的安靜生活之人。

凱內爾姆·笛比

十一月十三日

「我眷顧他，為要叫他吩咐他的眾子和他的眷屬。」(創18:19)

耶和華是足可倚靠的，祂也渴望我們能夠一樣的可信，有決斷力和穩重，這平白就是信心的意思。

神正尋找那些祂能將祂全部的愛、權柄和信實應許的重任託負的人，祂的引擎有足夠能量來拉動我們依附在它上面的任何重量。

宣信

從來沒有一個由神給人的試煉是超出那人的承受能力的。

十一月十四日

「一粒麥子不落在地裏死了，仍舊是一粒；若是死了，就結出許多子粒來。」(約12:24)

麻薩諸塞州北安普敦市是大衛·布萊納古舊墳場所在。布萊納這美國傳教士先驅於1747二十九歲之年死於肺結核。他的墳墓就在耶路沙·愛德華滋墓旁，後者是當時清教徒神學家約拿單·愛德華滋的女兒。

渴望稱布萊納為兒子的莊嚴老清教徒聖人約拿單·愛德華滋寫一本小書記下這短暫生命的故事。

亨利·馬田不理會他的教育、才華和大好機會，讀罷布萊納生平小書的他便捨棄他自己的生命！之後，他於1812年出發遠赴印度，健康破損的他拖着身子北往最遠去到黑海附近土耳其的托卡特城。在那裏他臥在馬鞍堆的蔭下來使他那像火燒一樣的發燒得以降溫，就在三十一歲之年孤獨地死去。

里安納·胡士里·培根

十一月十五日

「我們.....被壓太重。」(林後1:8)

... so that Christ's power may rest on me. (2 Corinthians 12:9)

God allowed the crisis in Jacob's life at Peniel to totally surround him until he ultimately came to the point of making an earnest and humble appeal to God Himself. That night, he wrestled with God and literally came to the place where he could take hold of Him as never before.

Through those difficult years, David also grew in his knowledge of faith and godliness, which were indispensable principles for his glorious career as the king of Israel.

Nothing but the most dangerous circumstances in which Paul was constantly placed could ever have taught him, and thus the church through him, the full meaning of the great promise of God he learned to claim: "My grace is sufficient for you" (2 Cor. 12:9).

Sometimes we may have to wait and realize that "perseverance must finish its work" (James 1:4). But ultimately we will surely find "the stone rolled away" (Luke 24:2) and the Lord Himself waiting to bestow a double blessing on us for our time of testing.

A. B. Simpson

November 16

They overcame him by the blood of the Lamb ...; they did not love their lives so much as to shrink from death. (Revelation 12:11)

When James and John came to Christ with their mother, asking Him to give them the best place in His kingdom, He did not refuse their request. He told them that the place would be given to them if they could do His work, drink His cup, and be baptized with His baptism. (See Mark 10:38.)

Rise today to face the circumstances in which the providence of God has placed you. Your crown of glory is hidden in the heart of these things—the hardships and trials pressing in on you this very hour, week, and month of your life. Yet the most difficult things are not those seen and known by the world but those deep within your soul, unseen and unknown by anyone except Jesus.

selected

November 17

Listen to what the unjust judge says. And will not God bring about justice for his chosen ones, who cry out to

「好叫基督的能力覆庇我。」(林後12:9)

神容許雅各在毘努伊勒的生命被危機重重圍困，直至他最終來到對神作出最誠摯和謙卑的祈求那點。那晚他與神摔跤，他便來到那照字面解釋從來未曾抓住神的地方。

經過那些艱難的年日，大衛漸漸在對信心和敬虔的認識上加增，這些都是他作為以色列王那榮耀位分所必不可少的素質。

能夠叫保羅得教訓的沒有別的，惟有是他最恆常落到最危險的環境，因此教會因他的緣故學習到神最偉大應許的全面意思，且宣告：「我的恩典夠你用的。」

我們也許有時要等候和明白「忍耐也當成功」(雅1:4)。我們至終必發現「石頭已經從墳墓滾開」(路24:2)，和主等候為我們受試煉的日子加倍施恩。

宣信

十一月十六日

「弟兄勝過他，是因羔羊的血，和自己所見證的道。他們雖至於死，也不愛惜性命。」(啟12:11)

當雅和和約翰帶同母親來到基督面前要求祂給他們在祂國中最重要的位置時，祂沒有拒絕他們的要求。祂告訴他們那位置是給那些能作祂的工，喝祂的杯和受祂的洗的人。(參可10:38)

今天就起來面對神定旨放置你的環境。你榮耀的冠冕埋藏在這些裏面，在艱難和試煉人生中的這刻，這週，這月來迫近。但最困難的不是那些可見和世界已知的，而是那些在你靈魂深處，除了耶穌之外無人見過和知道的。

選

十一月十七日

「你們聽這不義之官所說的話。神的選民，晝夜呼籲祂，祂縱然為他

him day and night? Will he keep putting them off? I tell you, he will see that they get justice, and quickly. (Luke 18:6-8)

God's timing is not ours to command. If we do not start the fire with the first strike of our match, we must try again.

When it comes to faith, we have more certainty of success than we could ever have had with flint and steel, for we have God's promises as a foundation.

May we, therefore, never despair. God's time for mercy will come—in fact, it has already come, if our time for believing has arrived. Ask in faith without wavering, but never cease to petition the King simply because He has delayed His reply..

Charles H. Spurgeon

November 18

Blessed is he, whosoever shall not be offended in me. (Luke 7:23 KJV)

The Lord knows what is best for me, and my surroundings are determined by Him. I must believe that when difficulties remain, it is that I may learn to trust Him completely—to trust and not be afraid. And it is through my mental and emotional struggles that I am being trained to tutor others who are being tossed by the storm.

The offense causing me to turn away may be spiritual. I had imagined that once within His fold, I would never again suffer from the stinging winds of temptation. Yet it is best for me the way it is, for when I endure temptation His grace is magnified, my own character matures, and heaven seems sweeter at the end of the day.

Once I arrive at my heavenly home, I will look back across the turns and trials along my path and will sing the praises of my Guide. So whatever comes my way, I will welcome His will and refuse to be offended in my loving Lord.

Alexander Smellie

November 19

Though you have made me see troubles, many and bitter, you will restore my life again. (Psalm 71:20)

God makes you “see troubles.” Sometimes, as part of your education being carried out, you must “go down to the depths of the earth” (Ps. 63:9). And ultimately, from the depths, He “will restore [your] life

們忍了多時，豈不終久給他們伸冤麼？我告訴你們，要快快的給他們伸冤了。」(路18:6-8)

神的時間不由我們支配。我們若果第一次擦動火柴不能劃出火時，必須再次嘗試。

我們若有信心，我們肯定比舊日用火石和火鑷更加成功，因為我們有神的應許作為我們的基礎。

因此，我們不要絕望，神施憐憫的時間必會來臨，事實上若我們相信的時刻已來臨，它早已來到。要在信中求，一點不動搖，只要當王遲遲未答覆時仍不止歇的求祂。

司布真

十一月十八日

「凡不因我跌倒的，就有福了。」(路7:23)

主知道甚麼是對我最好的，和我的周遭是由祂決定的。我定須在困難還在時仍相信，好叫我學習完全信靠祂，信靠而不害怕。我是藉精神上和情緒上的掙扎來鍛煉自己作那些被風暴動搖之人的導師。

致使我轉離神的原因可能是屬靈的。我以為只要在我的羊圈中，我便永不再受試探之風欺哄。然而於我這是最好的方法，因為當我忍受試煉時，祂的恩典是加倍的，我一己的品格得以成熟，在那日結束時天也看起來更加甜美。

當到達天家時，我必回望沿途上我曾經過的轉捩和試煉，也會頌唱引導者的讚歌。因此無論我前路如何，我必會欣然接受祂的旨意和拒絕得罪我親愛的主了。

亞歷山大·史美利

十一月十九日

「祢是叫我們多經歷重大急難的，必使我們復活。」(詩71:20)

神使你經歷急難，有時為要成為你受教的一部分，你定須「往地底下去」(詩63:9)，最終從那深處祂必使你復活。

again.”

Never doubt God! Never say that He has forsaken or forgotten you or think that He is unsympathetic. He “will restore [your] life again.”

Be steadfast, “because you know that your labor in the Lord is not in vain” (1 Cor. 15:58). “My tongue will sing of your righteousness” (Ps. 51:14).

selected

November 20

Blessed is the one who waits. (Daniel 12:12)

Waiting may seem like an easy thing to do, but it is a discipline that a Christian soldier does not learn without years of training. Marching and drills are much easier for God’s warriors than standing still.

Wait in faith. Express your unwavering confidence in Him. And believe that even if He keeps you waiting until midnight, He will come at the right time to fulfill His vision for you.

Wait in quiet patience. Never complain about what you believe to be the cause of your problems, as the children of Israel did against Moses. Accept your situation exactly as it is and then simply place it with your whole heart into the hand of your covenant God. And while removing any self-will, say to Him, “Lord, ‘Not my will, but yours be done’ [Luke 22:42]. I do not know what to do, and I am in great need. But I will wait until You divide the flood before me or drive back my enemies. I will wait even if You keep me here many days, for my heart is fixed on You alone, dear Lord. And my spirit will wait for You with full confidence that You will still be my joy and my salvation, ‘for you have been my refuge, [and] a strong tower against the foe’ [Ps. 61:3].”

from Morning by Morning

November 21

Commit your way to the Lord. (Psalm 37:5)

Do this so that you will be free from the confusion, conflicts, and cares that fill the world today.

R. Leighton

You will find it impossible to “commit your way to

永不要懷疑神！永不要說祂已捨棄或忘記你，也不要以為祂是不同情了。祂必會使你復活。

要堅定，「因為知道你們的勞苦，在主裏面不是徒然的。」(林前15:58)「我的舌頭就高聲歌唱祢的公義。」(詩51:14)

選

十一月二十日

「等.....的，那人便為有福。」(但12:12)

等待似乎是一件易做的事，但這是基督精兵不花年計的訓練學不來的。步操和排練對於神的戰士來說比起站穩容易得多。

在信中等待。表達你對祂不動搖的信心，也要相信即使祂要你一直等至午夜，祂必會及時來到來為你成就祂的異象。

在靜中忍耐等待。不要像以色列民敵擋摩西般埋怨你想當然的問題成因。接受你所在的處境，隨後全心將這交在與你立約之神的手中。除去任何己意下向祂說：

「主啊，不要成就我的意思，只要成就祢的意思。」(路22:42)我不知可作甚麼，我正大大缺乏。但我會等到祢在我面前將洪水分開，驅散敵人。祢要若在那裏多日我必仍等待，因我心單單注目恩主祢。我的靈必完全信靠等待祢，因祢仍是我的喜樂和拯救，「因為祢作過我的避難所，作過我的堅固台，脫離仇敵。」(詩61:3)

摘自《每朝早》

十一月二十一日

「當將你的事交託耶和華。」(詩37:5)

這樣作是為了叫你得在今天世界的混亂、衝突、和憂愁中得自由。

R · 禮頓

你會發覺「將你的事交託耶和

the Lord," unless your way has met with His approval. It can only be done through faith. This committing of your way to Him must be continuous, not just one isolated action.

selected

November 22

Do you believe that I am able to do this? (Matthew 9:28)

God deals with impossibilities. It is never too late for Him to do so, as long as that which is impossible is brought to Him in complete faith by the person whose life and circumstances would be impacted if God is to be glorified. God "will repay you for the years the locusts have eaten" (Joel 2:25), and He is trustworthy to do it unreservedly. He does so not because of what we are but because of who He is. God forgives and heals and restores, for He is "the God of all grace" (1 Peter 5:10). May we praise Him and trust Him.

from Sunday School Times

We have a God who delights in impossibilities and who asks, "Is anything too hard for me?" (Jer. 32:27).

Andrew Murray

November 23

You have shown your people desperate times. (Psalm 60:3)

Rock flowers grow and bloom only on rocks where you can see no soil.

Margaret Bottome

The trials of life are sent to make us, not to break us. Financial troubles may destroy a person's business but build up his character. And a direct blow to the outer person may be the greatest blessing possible to the inner person. So if God places or allows anything difficult in our lives, we can be sure that the real danger or trouble will be what we will lose if we run or rebel against it.

Maltbie D. Babcock

November 24

Be still, and know that I am God. (Psalm 46:10)

華」是不可能的，除非你與祂同步。惟有藉信來作成。同時，將你的路呈獻給祂定必要持續，不單只是偶一為之的舉動。

選

十一月二十二日

「你們信我能作這事麼？」(太 9:28)

神專門作「不可能」的事。祂這樣作永不太遲，只要將「不可能」帶給祂的人有完全的信，因神的得榮耀叫他的生命和環境被提升。神會將「蝗蟲那些年所吃的補還你們。」(珥2:25)在無保留地作這個上神值得信賴。祂這樣作非因我們而是祂的所是。神原諒，醫治和重建，因為祂是「那賜諸般恩典的神」(彼前5:10)。讓我們稱讚祂和信靠祂。

適自《主日學報》

我們有的神喜作不可能的事，祂也是問「豈有我難成的事麼？」(耶32:27)的神。

慕·安德烈

十一月二十三日

「祢叫祢的民遇見艱難。」(詩 60:3)

石頭花只在你看不見泥土的石上生長和開花。

瑪嘉烈·博滕美

生命的試煉是要作成，而非破損我們。財務問題也許摧毀人的生意，卻也建立他的品格。一個人外在正面衝擊也許是他內在最大可能的蒙福。因此神若放置或容許我們的人生遇上任何困難時，我們可以肯定的是真正的危險和艱難就是我們因逃避或反叛時所失去的。

麥比·D·白確

十一月二十四日

「你們要休息，要知道我是神。」(詩46:10)

Is there any note in all the music of the world as mighty as the grand pause? Is there any word in the Psalms more eloquent than the word “Selah,” meaning pause? Is there anything more thrilling and awe-inspiring than the calm before the crashing of the storm, or the strange quiet that seems to fall upon nature before some supernatural phenomenon or disastrous upheaval? And is there anything that can touch our hearts like the power of stillness?

There is “the peace of God, which transcends all understanding” (Phil. 4:7); “quietness and trust” (Isa. 30:15) is the source of all strength; a “great peace” that will never “make them stumble” (Ps. 119:165). Deep within the center of the soul is a chamber of peace where God lives and where, if we will enter it and quiet all the other sounds, we can hear His “gentle whisper” (1 Kings 19:12).

And even in the busiest life, there is a place where we may dwell alone with God in eternal stillness.

There is only one way to know God: “Be still, and know.” “The Lord is in his holy temple; let all the earth be silent before him” (Hab. 2:20).

selected

All-loving Father, Your soft whisper of eternal love spoke more sweetly to our bruised and bleeding souls than any winds that breathe across a wind harp. And when we heard Your voice and saw Your face, new life returned to us.

November 25

“Take the arrows....Strike the ground.” He struck it three times and stopped. The man of God was angry with him and said, “You should have struck the ground five or six times.” (2 Kings 13:18-19)

Jehoash, king of Israel did receive more than any human could have offered, but he did not receive God’s best. How important it is for us to learn to pray through our circumstances and to fully examine our hearts with God’s message to us! Otherwise, we will never claim all the fullness of His promise or all the possibilities that believing prayer offers.

A. B. Simpson

To him who is able to do immeasurably more

世上音樂有否任何音符比全休止更強而有力？在詩篇中否任何字詞比起「細拉」更意味深長？有否任何事比起暴風來臨前的平靜，或一些超自然現象或災難性的突變前臨到大自然出奇的寧靜更驚心動魄和激起驚懼？有沒有任何東西比靜止的能力更能觸動我們的心靈？

有「神所賜出人意外的平安」（腓4:7），「平靜安穩」（賽30:15）是一切能力的來源。一個「極大的平安」永不「使他們絆腳」（詩119:165）。靈魂最深處是神所住和所在的平安之所，我們若進去，屏息所有其他聲音時，便能聽到祂「微小的聲音。」（王上19:12）。

就是在最繁忙的生活中，總有一處可與神進到永恆的寧靜中。

「要安靜，要知道」是認識神的唯一方法。「惟耶和華在祂的聖殿中。全地的人都當在祂面前肅敬靜默。」（哈2:20）

選

全愛的父啊，祢永恆之愛的微聲於我們受損流血的生命比任何風奏豎琴更柔美。當我們聽見祢的聲音和看見祢的臉面時，新生命重新回到我們那裏。

十一月二十五日

「『取幾枝箭來.....打地吧。』他打了三次，便止住了。神人向他發怒，說：『應當擊打五六次』。」（王下13:18-19）

以色列王約阿施所得的真的多過任何人所能給的，但他得不着神最好的東西。透過環境學習祈禱和用神對我們說的信息來全面檢視我們的心對我們何等重要！否則我們永不能獲得祂全足的應許，也不能得着信心祈禱所有的一切可能性。

宣信

「神能照着運行在我們心裏的

than all we ask or imagine, according to his power that is at work within us, to him be glory. Ephesians 3:20-21 “according to his power that is at work within us.” He will only do as much for us as we will allow Him to do in us.

The Alliance

November 26

Caleb asked her, “What can I do for you?” She replied, “Do me a special favor. Since you have given me land in the Negev, give me also springs of water.” So Caleb gave her the upper and lower springs. (Joshua 15:18-19)

These springs flow through the low places, the difficult places, the desert places, the lonely places, and even the ordinary places of life. Abraham found them amid the hills of Canaan. Moses found them among the rocks of Midian. David found them among the ashes of Ziklag, when his property was gone and his family had been taken captive. And although his “men were talking of stoning him ... David found strength in the Lord his God” (1 Sam. 30:6).

Isaiah found them in the terrible days when King Sennacherib of Assyria invaded Judah. His faith could still sing: “There is a river whose streams make glad the city of God, the holy place where the Most High dwells. God is within her, she will not fall” (Ps. 46:4-5).

The Christian martyrs found them amid the flames, the church reformers amid their enemies and struggles, and we can find them each day of the year if we have the Comforter in our hearts and have learned to say with David, “All my springs of joy are in you” (Ps. 87:7 NASB).

A. B. Simpson

November 27

Nothing is impossible with God. (Luke 1:37)

High in the snow-covered Alpine valleys, the soldanelle plant blooms unblemished. During the past summer the little plant spread its leaves wide and flat on the ground in order to soak up the sun's rays, and it kept that energy stored in its roots throughout the winter. At last the icy covering of the air compartment gave way, and the blossom burst into the sunshine. The crystalline texture of its mauve-colored petals sparkled like the snow itself, as if it still bore the marks

大力充充足足的成就一切，超過我們所求所想的。但願祂得着榮耀。」（弗3:20-21）「照着運行在我們心裏的大力」，祂只會照我們容許祂為我們作的多少來作在我們身上。

宣道報

十一月二十六日

「迦勒問她說：你要甚麼。她說：求你賜福給我，你既將我安置在南地，求你也給我水泉。她父親就把上泉下泉賜給她。」（書15:18-19）

這些泉水流經低下之地、困苦之地、沙漠之地、孤單之地，甚至乎平凡人生之地。亞伯拉罕在迦南山中找到，摩西在米甸石頭之間找到，大衛在洗革拉的頹垣敗瓦中找到，那時他的家人和財物都被擄去。雖然「眾人.....要用石頭打死他，大衛卻倚靠耶和華他的神，心裏堅固。」（撒下30:6）

在亞述王西拿基立攻打猶大的可怖日子中以賽亞找到，他的信心仍能唱：「有一道河，這河的分汊，使神的城歡喜。這城就是至高者居住的聖所。神在其中。城必不動搖。」（詩46:4-5）基督徒殉教士在火焰中找到，更正教者在敵人和掙扎中找到，我們在年中的每一日也能找到，只要我們有保惠師在心中，學懂與大衛同說：「我（喜樂）的泉源都在祢裏面。」（詩87:7）

宣信

十一月二十七日

「因為出於神的話，沒有一句不帶能力的。」（路1:37）

在舖滿冷雪的阿爾卑斯山谷高地，潔白無瑕的高山鐘花海甘藍在過去的夏天把它的葉片廣闊地平放在地上，為的是吸收陽光，貯存在根部的能量使它熬過冬天。最終，空氣中的冷意讓路，花兒在陽光下盛放。紅紫花瓣如水晶的質地就像冰雪般閃耀，就像它仍刻有它所經煉過旅程的痕跡。

of the journey it had endured.

For even if we took our circumstances and cast all the darkness of human doubt upon them and then hastily piled as many difficulties together as we could find against God's divine work, we could never move beyond the blessedness of His miracle-working power. May we place our faith completely in Him, for He is the God of the impossible.

selected

November 28

Where morning dawns and evening fades you call forth songs of joy. (Psalm 65:8)

The clear, pure light of the morning made me yearn for the truth in my heart, which alone could make me pure and clear as the morning itself and tune my life to the concert pitch of nature around me. And the breeze that blew from the sunrise made me hope in God, who had breathed into my nostrils the breath of life. He had so completely filled me with His breath, mind, and Spirit that I would only think His thoughts and live His life. Within His life I had found my own, but now it was eternally glorified.

What would we poor humans do without our God's nights and mornings!

George MacDonald

November 29

Later on, however ... (Hebrews 12:11)

A German baron who, at his castle on the Rhine, stretched a wind harp in the air from tower to tower. Yet as the soft breezes swirled around the castle, no music was born.

One night a fierce storm arose, and the wind harp was filling the air with melodies that rang out even above the noise of the storm. It had taken a fierce storm to produce the music!

Haven't we all known people whose lives have never produced any pleasing music during their days of calm prosperity?

You can always count on God to make the "later on" of difficulties a thousand times richer and better than the present, if we overcome them correctly. "No discipline seems pleasant at the time.... Later on, however, it produces a harvest of righteousness and peace" (Heb. 12:11). What a yield!

就算我們將我們將人所顧慮的一切黑暗全投進我們所處環境，之後草率地將盡多與神的聖工相反的困難堆在一起，這也永不能超越神奇妙工作能力的恩福。讓我們將我們的信完全放在祂身上，因為祂是不可能之事的神。

選

十一月二十八日

「祢使日出日落之地都歡呼。」(詩 65:8)

清晨清純之光使我心憧憬真理，獨有它能使我像清晨般純淨清徹，調校我人生之音配合四周自然管絃樂的音域。日出吹來的微風使我對神心生盼望，是祂將生命氣息吹進我鼻孔。祂曾以祂的呼氣、心思和聖靈使我完全得充滿，叫我因此只想祂想，和活出祂的生命。在祂的生命中我找到我自己的生命，如今是永遠榮耀的了。

若沒有我們神的晚上和早晨，我們可憐的人類會如何？

喬治·麥當勞

十一月二十九日

「.....後來卻.....」(來12:11)

萊茵城堡的德國男爵在塔樓與塔樓之間拉設風之豎琴。然而若只有柔弱微風吹過城堡時，音樂是不能生成的。

一個晚上有厲害風暴來臨，風之豎琴的琴音使空中滿佈旋律音調，樂聲比暴風之聲更響亮，原來要兇猛的暴風才能生出音樂！

我們豈不知人在平順的日子是永不能生出任何悅耳音樂的。

我們的困難若解決得正確，總能認定神的「後來」比「如今」的解決豐富和好千倍。「凡管教的事當時不覺得快樂.....後來卻結出平安的果子，就是義。」(來12:11) 何等的果子！

November 30

Should you then seek great things for yourself? Seek them not. For I will bring disaster on all people, declares the Lord, but wherever you go I will let you escape with your life. (Jeremiah 45:5)

“escape with your life” means your life will be snatched from the jaws of the Enemy, as David snatched the lamb from the lion. It does not mean you will be spared the heat of the battle and confrontation with your foes, but it means “a table before [you] in the presence of [your] enemies” (Ps. 23:5), a shelter from the storm, a fortress amid the foe, and a life preserved in the face of continual pressure. It means comfort and hope from God, such as Paul received when he and his friends “were under great pressure, far beyond [their] ability to endure, so that [they] despaired even of life” (2 Cor. 1:8). And it means the Lord’s divine help, such as when Paul’s “thorn in the flesh” (2 Cor. 12:7 KJV) remained, but the power of Christ came to rest upon him, and he learned that God’s “grace is sufficient” (2 Cor. 12:9).

from Days of Heaven upon Earth

The Savior endured an especially difficult test in the wilderness while in the presence of Satan for forty days and nights, the three Hebrew young men were kept for a time in the flames of “the furnace heated seven times hotter than usual” (Dan. 3:19); after surviving an entire night sitting among the lions, “when Daniel was lifted from the den, no wound was found on him, because he had trusted in his God” (Dan. 6:23). They were able to endure in the presence of their enemies because they dwelt in the presence of their God.

December 1

There remains, then, a Sabbath-rest for the people of God. (Hebrews 4:9)

That rest includes victory: “The Lord gave them rest on every side....The Lord handed all their enemies over to them” (Josh. 21:44). “Thanks be to God! He gives us the victory through our Lord Jesus Christ” (1 Cor. 15:57).

A prominent believer once told of his mother, who was a very anxious and troubled Christian. Then one morning his mother came to breakfast with a

十一月三十日

「你為自己圖謀大事麼？不要圖謀，我必使災禍臨到凡有血氣的。但你無論往哪裏去，我必使你以自己的命為掠物，這是耶和華說的。」(耶45:5)

「你以自己的命為掠物」是說你的生命從敵人的牙縫中奪回，如大衛從獅子的口奪回羊羔一樣。這不是說你可免於戰火和與敵對，而是說「在敵人面前為你擺設筵席」(詩23:5)，暴風中的蔭庇所，敵人中的堅城，面對不斷壓力下生命得保存。它說到從神來的安慰和盼望，也就是「遭遇苦難，被壓太重，力不能勝，甚至連活命的指望都絕了」(林後1:8)中保羅所得到的。它是說到耶和華的幫助，就如保羅說「加在我肉體上的一根刺」(林後12:7)仍在，但基督的能力來安息在他處，他便學會了神的「恩典是夠用的」(林後12:9)。

摘自《地上若天的日子》

救主在曠野四十晝夜接受撒但尤其厲害的試探；那三個希伯來少年人被關在「比尋常更加七倍燒熱的」(但3:19)火焰中一段時間；整夜坐在獅子群中仍存活下，「但以理從坑裏被繫上來，身上毫無傷損，因為信靠他的神。」(但6:23)他們能在敵人面前忍耐到底是因為他們安居在他們的神的同在中。

十二月一日

「這樣看來，必另有一安息日的安息，為神的子民存留。」(來4:9)

這安息包含得勝，「耶和華.....使他們四境平安.....耶和華把一切仇敵都交在他們手中。」(書21:44)「感謝神，使我們藉着我們的主耶穌基督得勝。」(林前15:57)

一個傑出信徒有一次談及他那十分焦慮和憂愁的基督徒母親。但有一個早上母親臉上裝着微

smile adorning her face. She began describing a dream she had in the night.

In her dream she noticed that more bundles were being dropped along the way by numerous repulsive-looking creatures that seemed quite demonic in nature. Like everyone else in her dream, she also carried her needless load. After a while, she looked up and saw a Man whose face was loving and bright. She realized it was her Savior. He smiled sadly and said, "My dear child, these bundles you carry are not from me. You need to drop them, and you will feel as if 'I carried you on eagles' wings' [Ex. 19:4]."

December 2

... perfect through suffering. (Hebrews 2:10)

A mother brought a crippled boy with a hunched back into her home as a companion for her own son. She warned her son to be very careful not to refer to the other boy's deformity. But after listening to her son play with him for a few minutes, she heard him ask his companion, "Do you know what that is on your back? It is the box that holds your wings, and someday God is going to break it open, and you will fly away to be an angel."

Someday God is going to reveal this fact to every Christian: the very things they now rebel against are the instruments He has used to perfect their character and to mold them into perfection, so they may later be used as polished stones in His heaven yet to come.

Cortland Myers

Suffering is a wonderful fertilizer for the roots of character. The great objective of this life is character, for it is the only thing we can carry with us into eternity. And gaining as much of the highest character possible is the purpose of our trials.

Austin Phelps

The mountain of vision is won by no other road than the one covered with thorns.

December 3

"Is your husband all right? Is your child all right?" "Everything is all right," she said. (2 Kings 4:26)

For sixty-two years and five months George Mueller's wife, in his ninety-second year, left. He turned to the ever present Jesus and said, "Lord Jesus, I am

笑來進早餐，她描述晚上所發的夢。

在夢中她發覺沿途上有很多似乎有魔鬼屬性醜惡的生物丟下更多的捆包。她在夢中像其他人一樣背負那些不需負的重擔。一會兒後她抬頭望見一人，祂臉面慈祥和光明，她立時知道這是她的救主。祂便傷心地微笑着說：「孩子啊，這些你背的捆包不是我的。你需丟下他們，你必會感覺到「我如鷹將你們背在翅膀上」（出19:4）。

十二月二日

「因受苦難得以完全。」(來2:10)

一個婦人收養一個跛腳駝背的男孩回去作她兒子的陪伴。她千叮萬囑兒子要當心不要提及那男孩的殘障。但兒子與他玩了一會兒後便聽見他問同伴：「你知否在你背上的是甚麼？這是一個盛着你雙翼的盒子，有一日神會打開它，那你便會像天使般飛翔。」

有一日神會向每個基督徒揭露這事實：他們今日所抗拒的東西是神用來使他們品格完美和模造成完全工具的，因此他們不久在要來的神國中作打磨好的活石。

哥蘭·邁亞斯

受苦是品格之根的奇妙肥料。品格是我們今生的偉大目標，因為這是我們唯一隨身帶進永恆的東西，而我們所受試煉的目的就是盡可能獲取最多的崇高品格。

岳士亭·斐爾潑斯

飽覽山頂風景的路徑別無他選，惟有那一條鋪滿荊棘之路。

十二月三日

「你丈夫平安麼？孩子平安麼？她說：平安。」(王下4:26)

結婚六十二年零五個月的慕勒太太在他九十二歲之年離他而去。他在房子裏對常在的耶穌說：

alone. Yet I am not alone, for You are with me and are my Friend. Now, Lord, please comfort me, strengthen me, and give to Your poor servant everything that You see I need.”

George Mueller

December 4

He went up on a mountainside by himself. (Matthew 14:23)

One of the blessings of the old-time Sabbath day was the calmness, restfulness, and holy peace that came from having a time of quiet solitude away from the world. There is a special strength that is born in solitude. Strength is found not in busyness and noise but in quietness. For a lake to reflect the heavens on its surface, it must be calm. Our Lord loved the people who flocked to him, but there are numerous accounts in the Scriptures of His going away from them for a brief period of time. On occasion He would withdraw from the crowd and quite often would spend His evenings alone in the hills. Most of His ministry was performed in the towns and cities by the seashore, but He loved the hills more and at nightfall would frequently seclude Himself in their peaceful heights. The one thing we need today more than anything else is to spend time alone with our Lord, sitting at His feet in the sacred privacy of His blessed presence. Oh, how we need “the secret place” (Ps. 91:1 KJV) as part of our lifestyle!

selected

December 5

I know, O Lord, that a man's life is not his own; it is not for man to direct his steps. (Jeremiah 10:23)
Lead me in a straight path. (Psalm 27:11)

Many people want to direct God instead of surrendering themselves to be directed by Him. They want to show Him the way instead of submissively following where He leads.

Madame Guyon

December 6

I am coming soon. Hold on to what you have, so that no one will take your crown. (Revelation 3:11)

In July 1829 it pleased God to reveal to George Mueller's heart the truth regarding the return of the Lord Jesus and to show him that he had made a great

「主耶穌，我孤單；卻也不孤單，因祢與我一起，祢是我朋友。主啊來安慰我，加我力量，給我這可憐的僕人祢看為需要的每樣東西。」

慕勒

十二月四日

「祂就獨自上山去禱告。」(太14:23)

古時安息日其中一樣福就是平靜、安息和神聖的平安，是來自遠離世界而有一刻獨處的寧靜。獨處能產生特別的能力。力量不在忙碌中，而是在寧靜中找到。若一湖面能反映天空，定必是平靜的。我們的主喜愛人們擁擠祂，但在聖經多處記載祂有短暫遠離他們的一刻。有時祂從群眾中抽離，頗常在山間度過那些晚上。祂大部分的事奉是在海邊的城鎮或城市中進行，但祂更喜愛來到山上，在高山的和平安靜中常使自己獨自度過深宵。今天我們所需比一切更要緊的是與我們的主單獨相交，在祂賜恩同在的神聖之地，坐在祂腳前。噢，我們所需的是以那「隱密處」(詩91:1)作為我們人生的一部分！

選

十二月五日

「耶和華阿，我曉得人的道路不由自己，行路的人也不能定自己的腳步。」(耶10:23)

很多人想指揮神而不是降服自己來被神指揮，他們想向神指示當行的路而不是順服地跟隨祂的帶領。

蓋恩夫人

十二月六日

「我必快來，你要持守你所有的，免得人奪去你的冠冕。」(啟3:11)

在1829年7月神樂意在慕勒心中顯明主耶穌再來的真理，和叫他見到他犯了一個大錯，就是退去留

mistake by sitting back and watching for the complete conversion of the world. Deep within his soul, he was moved to feel compassion for perishing sinners and for a world lulled to sleep by the wicked Enemy. And he began to think, 'Should I not do whatever I can for the Lord Jesus and try to awake His slumbering church before He returns?'"

There may still be many difficult years of hard work ahead of us before the fulfillment of His prophetic return, but the signs of His coming today are very encouraging.

Thomas De Witt Talmage

December 7

You will see neither wind nor rain, yet this valley will be filled with water, and you, your cattle and your other animals will drink. This is an easy thing in the eyes of the Lord; he will also hand Moab over to you. (2 Kings 3:17-18)

"The next morning ... there it was ... ! And the land was filled with water....The sun was shining on the water....[And it] looked red—like blood" (vv. 20, 22).

The greatest triumph of a person's faith is to "be still, and know that [He is] God" (Ps. 46:10). The greatest victory of faith is to stand at the shore of the impassable Red Sea and to hear the Master say, "Stand firm and you will see the deliverance the Lord will bring you today" (Ex. 14:13), and "Move on" (Ex. 14:15).

It is the role of faith not to question but to simply obey. Are you desiring some spiritual blessing? Then dig the ditches and God will fill them. But He will do this in the most unexpected places and in the most unexpected ways. May the Lord grant us the kind of faith that acts "by faith, not by sight" (2 Cor. 5:7), and may we expect Him to work although we see no wind or rain.

A. B. Simpson

December 8

As God's chosen people ... clothe yourselves with ... kindness. (Colossians 3:12)

In this world, there are many lives that painfully creak and grate as they go about their daily work. Often it seems that nothing goes right with them and that they need lubricating with "the oil of joy" (Ps.

意世人全部的對話。在他靈魂的深處，因見到失喪的罪人和被那惡毒的敵人催眠沉睡的世人而感到同情。他開始想：「我豈不應為主耶穌竭盡所能，和盡力去在祂回來之前喚醒祂沉睡的教會麼？」

在祂預言的再來得應驗之前還有很多艱難工作的歲月在我們前頭，而且祂再來的徵兆今天看來是十分振奮人心的。

多瑪士·底域·他馬治

十二月七日

「你們雖不見風，不見雨，這谷必滿了水，使你們和牲畜有水喝。在耶和華眼中這還算為小事，祂也必將摩押人交在你們手中。」(王下 3:17-18)

「次日早晨，.....遍地就滿了水.....次日早晨，日光照在水上.....對面水紅如血。」(王下 3:20, 22)

人信心最偉大的勝利就在於「你們要休息，要知道我是神」(詩 46:10)上，信的最大勝利就在於站在不可能渡過的紅海岸邊聽神所說：「只管站住，看耶和華今天向你們所要施行的救恩」(出 14:13)，和「往前走」(出 14:15)。

信的角色不是發問而是單單順從。你是否渴慕屬靈祝福？那麼挖溝來讓神充滿他們吧，但祂要在最想不到的地方和以最想不到的方法來作。願神賜我們那種信心，「是憑着信心，不是憑着眼見。」(林後 5:7)，讓我們在看不見風和雨的情形下來期待祂來作工。

宣信

十二月八日

「所以你們既是神的選民，.....就要穿憐憫。」(西 3:12)

在今世有很多人是痛苦地咿呀作聲來作他們的日務。他們似乎處處碰壁，正需要溫柔、體貼的「喜樂油」(詩 45:7)滋潤。你若將你

45:7), gentleness, or thoughtfulness. If you offer your oil to the person nearest you, it may just lubricate the entire day for him. Your oil of cheerfulness will mean more than you know to someone who is downhearted. Or the oil may be a word of encouragement to a person who is full of despair. Never fail to speak it, for our lives may touch others only once on the road of life, and then our paths may diverge, never to meet again. The oil of kindness has worn the sharp, hard edges off many a sin-hardened life and left it soft and pliable, ready to receive the redeeming grace of the Savior. A pleasant word is a bright ray of sunshine on a saddened heart. Therefore give others the sunshine and tell Jesus the rest.

Be devoted to one another in brotherly love.
Romans 12:10

December 9

Our light and momentary troubles are achieving for us an eternal glory that far outweighs them all. (2 Corinthians 4:17)

These “momentary troubles are achieving for us” something very precious. They are teaching us not only the way to victory but, better still, the law of victory—there is a reward for every sorrow, and the sorrow itself produces the reward.

Joy sometimes needs pain to give it birth.

Fanny Crosby could never have written the beautiful words “I shall see Him face to face” if not for the fact that she had never gazed upon green fields, evening sunsets, nor even the twinkle in her mother’s eye. It was the loss of her own vision that helped her to gain her remarkable spiritual discernment and insight.

“Weeping may remain for a night, but rejoicing comes in the morning” (Ps. 30:5).

from Songs in the Night

December 10

But if we are afflicted, it is for your comfort and salvation; if we are comforted, it is for your comfort that you experience in your patient endurance of the same sufferings that we also suffer. And our hope for you is steadfast because we know that as you share in our sufferings, so also you will share in our comfort. (2

的油給你最接近的人，這可能正能滋潤他的一整天。歡快的油對於那些消沉的人是超乎你所能理解的。這油可以是充滿失望之人的一句鼓勵的話。不要不說，因為在人生路上遇見的人可能只有一次，從此便要分道揚鑣，永不再會。仁慈的油能磨掉眾多犯罪極深生命的尖銳和堅硬的邊稜，變得柔滑和鬆軟，隨時準備好接受救主的救恩。一句歡愉的話就像破損心靈的一襲陽光。所以先將陽光給人，後才把耶穌介紹。

「愛弟兄，要彼此親熱。」(羅 12:10)

十二月九日

「我們這至暫至輕的苦楚，要為我們成就極重無比永遠的榮耀。」(林後4:17)

那些「至暫的苦楚為我們成就」的東西十分寶貴。他們不單止教導我們得勝的方法，更重要的是那得勝之律——每個憂傷總有回報，是憂傷本身產生出回報。

有時需要痛苦來生出喜樂。

若非芬妮·哥斯比從未親見翠綠田野、日落黃昏、甚至連母親的眨眼，便永不能寫出「我必能面對面見」這優美詞句。就是失去一己視力來幫助她獲得這出類拔萃屬靈的識別能力和靈感。

「一宿雖然有哭泣，早晨便必歡呼。」(詩30:5)

摘自《夜間歌唱》

十二月十日

「我們受患難呢，是為叫你們得安慰得拯救。我們得安慰呢，也是為叫你們得安慰。這安慰能叫你們忍受我們所受的那樣苦楚。我們為你們所存的盼望是確定的，因為知道你們既是同受苦楚，也必同得安

Cor 1:6-7)

Are there not some in your circle to whom you naturally betake yourself in times of trial and sorrow? They always seem to speak the right word, to give the very counsel you are longing for; you do not realize, however, the cost which they had to pay ere they became so skillful in binding up the gaping wounds and drying tears. But if you were to investigate their past history you would find that they have suffered more than most. They have watched the slow untwisting of some silver cord on which the lamp of life hung. They have seen the golden bowl of joy dashed to their feet, and its contents spilt. They have stood by ebbing tides, and drooping gourds, and noon sunsets; but all this has been necessary to make them the nurses, the physicians, the priests of men. Do not fret, or set your teeth, or wait doggedly for the suffering to pass; but get out of it all you can, both for yourself and for your service to your generation, according to the will of God.

Selected

December 11

Praise the Lord, all you servants of the Lord who minister by night in the house of the Lord....May the Lord, the Maker of heaven and earth, bless you from Zion. (Psalm 134:1, 3)

It is easy for me to worship in the summer sunshine. But when the songbirds cease and the fruit falls from the trees, will my heart continue to sing? Will I remain in God's house at night? Will I love Him simply for who He is? Am I willing to "keep watch for one hour" (Mark 14:37) with Him in His Gethsemane? Will I help Him carry His cross up the road of suffering to Calvary? Will I stand beside Him in His dying moments, with Mary, His mother, and John, the beloved disciple? Would I be able, with Joseph of Arimathea and Nicodemus, to take the dead Christ from His cross?

My faith has seen Him in His lowest state, and yet my heart has recognized His majesty through His humble disguise. And at last I truly know that I desire not the gift but the Giver.

George Matheson

December 12

I am already being poured out like a drink offering,

慰。」(林後1:6-7)

在你圈子中有否一些人當你遇上試煉和憂傷時你便自然投身他們而去？他們似乎常能說合適的話，給予你正想望的輔導。但你不曾明瞭他們能熟練地包裹爆烈的傷口和拭乾眼淚所曾付出的代價。他們曾看着懸在生命之燈的銀芯慢慢熄滅，他們曾見着喜樂金碗的破裂，太陽正值當午便落下。但這些都是使他們成為護士、醫生和牧者的必需。不要煩躁，也不要咬牙切齒，頑強地等待苦痛的過去，而是按神的旨意盡你所能從痛苦中出來，是為你自己也同時是為你所服事的世代。

選

十二月十一日

耶和華的僕人，夜間站在耶和華殿中的，你們當稱頌耶和華.....願造天地的耶和華，從錫安賜福給你們。」(詩134:1,3)

在陽光普照的夏日下敬拜於我是容易的；當唱鳥住聲，樹果掉下，我的心會否繼續歌唱？會否留在神的殿中守夜？會否只因祂所是而愛祂？願否跟祂在客西馬尼園「儆醒片時」(可14:37)？願否在受苦的路上背起祂的十字架往各各他？在祂快要死亡一刻我願否與祂的母親馬利亞和祂所愛的門徒約翰站在祂旁邊？我能否與亞利馬太的約瑟和尼哥底母從十字架取下死去基督的身體來？

我在信中得見最卑微的祂，就算在祂謙卑的遮弊下我心還能辨識祂的尊榮，至終我真知道我所渴慕的不是恩賜而是賜恩者了。

喬治·馬得勝

十二月十二日

「我現在被澆奠，我離世的時候到

and the time has come for my departure. I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith. (2 Timothy 4:6-7)

When we arrive at our heavenly home, we will tell of the goodness and faithfulness of God, who brought us through every trial along the way. I would not like to stand with the multitude clothed in robes made “white in the blood of the Lamb” (Rev. 7:14)

May we be content to share in the battle, for we will soon wear a crown of reward and wave a palm branch of praise.

Charles H. Spurgeon

An American Civil War wounded soldier was not thinking of his gaping wound but was only remembering that he had won the ground near the top of the mountain. “I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith.”

What nobler medal of honor could any godly person seek than the scars of service, personal loss for the crown of reward, disgrace for the sake of Christ, and being worn out in the Master’s service!

December 13

I will give you the treasures of darkness. (Isaiah 45:3)

In the famous lace shops of Brussels, lace is always more beautifully and delicately woven when the weaver himself is in the dark, with only his work in the light.

Sometimes the darkness in our lives is worse, because we cannot even see the web we are weaving or understand what we are doing. Therefore we are unable to see any beauty or any possible good arising from our experience. Yet if we are faithful to forge ahead and “if we do not give up” (Gal. 6:9), someday we will know that the most exquisite work of our lives was done during those days when it was the darkest.

J. R. Miller

December 14

One of his disciples said to him, “Lord, teach us to pray...” He said to them, “When you pray, say: “... Your kingdom come.” (Luke 11:1-2)

How do we pray when we follow the desires of our own hearts? We say, “Lord, bless me, then my

了。那美好的仗我已經打過了，當跑的路我已經跑盡了，所信的道我已經守住了。」（提後4:6-7）

當我們來到我們的天家時，便會談到沿途領我們經過每個試煉之神的美善和信實。我不喜歡與「用羔羊的血把衣裳洗白淨」（啟7:14）之群眾站在一起。

讓我們滿意於有戰事的分享，皆因我們必快得戴上作為獎賞的冠冕和搖動那讚美的棕樹枝。

司布真

一個美國內戰受傷的士兵沒有想到他的傷口，只想到他近山頂處所贏得的土地。「那美好的仗我已經打過了，當跑的路我已經跑盡了，所信的道我已經守住了。」

敬虔人追求的榮耀勳章中沒有比事奉中的傷痕、為得賜冠冕而有的個人損失、為基督受的恥辱和服事主而得的勞累更尊貴！

十二月十三日

「我要將暗中的寶物.....賜給你。」（賽45:3）

在布魯塞爾著名的飾帶商店中，飾帶若要編織得更美麗和更精巧，就只有織造者坐在黑暗中，聚精會神在光線中工作。

有時我們生命中的黑暗更惡劣，因我們連所織造的也看不見，也不明白在作甚麼。因此我們不能從經驗中得見任何美麗或美善之物。我們若忠誠地前進，「若不灰心」（加6:9），終有一日我們可知道我們生命中最精美的工夫就是在我們最黑暗的日子中所作的。

J.R.米勒

十二月十四日

「有個門徒對他說：求主教導我們禱告。耶穌說：你們禱告的時候，要說.....願祢的國降臨。」（路11:1-2）

當我們隨心所欲時會怎樣祈禱呢？我們說：「主啊，賜福我，

family, my church, my city, and my country.” We start with those closest to us and gradually move outward, ultimately praying for the expansion of God’s kingdom throughout the world.

Our Master’s prayer, however, begins where we end. He taught us to pray for the world first and our personal needs second. Only after our prayer has covered every continent, every remote island of the sea, every person in the last hidden tribe, and every desire and purpose of God for the world are we taught to ask for a piece of bread for ourselves.

Dr. Francis

“His kingdom will never end” (Luke 1:33), an old Moravian version says, “His Kingdom shall have no frontier.” Missionary work should never be an afterthought of the church, because it is Christ’s forethought.

Henry Jackson Van Dyke

December 15

Trust in him. (Psalm 37:5)

The word “trust” is the heart of faith and is the Old Testament word given to the infant, or early, stages of faith. The word “faith” conveys more an act of the will, while the word “belief” conveys an act of the mind or intellect, but trust is the language of the heart.

Trust implies more than this, for it sees and feels and it leans on those who have a great, living, and genuine heart of love. Therefore let us “trust also in Him” (Ps. 37:5 KJV), through all the delays, in spite of all the difficulties, and in the face of all the rejection we encounter in life. And in spite of our feelings and evidence to the contrary, and even when we cannot understand our way or our situation, may we still “trust also in him; [for] he shall bring it to pass.”

December 16

There was also a prophetess, Anna....She never left the temple but worshiped night and day, fasting and praying. (Luke 2:36-37)

People who pray in spurts are never likely to attain to the kind of prayer described in the Scriptures as “powerful and effective” (James 5:16). Great power in prayer is within our reach, but we must work to obtain it. We should never even imagine

之後賜福我的家庭、我的教會、我的城市、和我們國家。」我們從最親近我們的人開始，逐漸向外移，最終擴展至神遍佈世界的神之國。

但我們主的禱告以我們的結尾為開始。祂教導我們先為世界祈禱，我們個人需要次之。我們的禱告要覆蓋每個洲、每個海外的離島、最後隱秘民族的每一個人、和神為世人的每個渴想和目的而教導我們為我們自己求取一片麵包。

法蘭西斯博士

「祂的國也沒有窮盡。」(路 1:33) 一個古老的莫拉維亞版本說：「祂的國也沒有疆界。」傳教工作從不是教會的後知後覺，而是基督的先知先覺。

亨利·積臣·凡第

十二月十五日

「倚靠祂。」(詩37:5)

「倚靠」一詞是信的中心，也是說到信心的早期或雛階的舊約詞彙。「信靠」多傳遞意志之舉，而「相信」傳遞心思或理智之舉，但「倚靠」發自內心。

倚靠所指比這更多，因它看見和感受到，依附那些有偉大、活潑和真心去愛的人。因此，不管一切的延遲，不計較困難，和面對人生所遇的一切反對，讓我們「也倚靠祂」。不論我們的感覺如何，證據如何相反，甚至當我們不能明白我們的前路和處境時，讓我們仍「倚靠祂，因祂必會帶領我們經過。」

十二月十六日

「又有女先知名叫亞拿，.....並不離開聖殿，禁食祈求。」(路2:36-37)

突發祈禱的人永不可能達至聖經所描述「大有功效」(雅5:16)的祈禱。有功效的祈禱唾手可得，但我們須努力才能獲得。我們永不要以為亞伯拉罕在沒有經年累月

that Abraham could have interceded so successfully for Sodom if he had not communed with God throughout the previous years of his life. Jacob's entire night of wrestling at Peniel was certainly not the first encounter he had with his God. And we can even look at our Lord's most beautiful and wonderful prayer in John 17, before His suffering and death, as the fruit of His many nights of devotion, and of His rising often before daybreak to pray. The prayer of Elijah, which stopped the rain from heaven and later opened heaven's floodgates, was only one example of a long series of his mighty pleadings with God.

The great intercessors, who are seldom mentioned in connection with the heroes and martyrs of the faith, were nevertheless the greatest benefactors of the church.

Charles H. Spurgeon

December 17

May God himself, the God of peace, sanctify you through and through. May your whole spirit, soul and body be kept blameless at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ. The one who calls you is faithful and he will do it. (1 Thessalonians 5:23-24)

I began following this truth "without holiness no one will see the Lord" (Heb. 12:14), and encouraging everyone with whom I spoke to do the same.

John Wesley in 1771

When I gave Jesus my will, He came to my heart and removed everything that would not stay pleasant, patient, and kind. And then He shut the door.

George Fox

At this very moment, my entire heart does not have even a hint of thirst after my acceptance by God. I am alone with Him and He fills every void. I do not have one wish, one will, or one desire, except in Him.

Lady Huntington

Suddenly I felt as if a hand—not weak but omnipotent, and not of wrath but of love—were laid on my forehead. Yet I did not feel it as much outwardly as inwardly. It seemed to be pressing in on

與神的相交下能成功地為所多瑪來代求。雅各整夜在毘努伊勒與神摔跤肯定不是他首次與神的接觸。在約17章我們的主在受苦前最美麗和奇妙的祈禱中我們得見，這是祂多晚與神親近的果子，祂常時在日出之前便起來禱告。以利亞叫天不下雨和後來叫天開啟那暴雨天門的祈禱只是向神發出那有力的懇求長長系列中的一個例子。

很少與信心英雄和殉教士相提並論的代禱者卻是使教會獲益最多的人。

司布真

十二月十七日

「願賜平安的神，親自使你們全然成聖。又願你們的靈、與魂、與身子，得蒙保守，在我主耶穌基督降臨的時候，完全無可指摘。那召你們的本是信實的，祂必成就這事。」
(帖前5:23-24)

我多年來遵照「非聖潔沒有人能見主」(來12:14)這真理而行，並鼓勵每個我交通的人這樣。

約翰·衛斯理1771年

當我將我的意志交給耶穌時，祂進入我心來除去一切叫我不快樂、不耐煩和不仁慈的東西，之後祂也把門關上。

喬治·霍克斯

在我被神接納那刻，我整個心一絲乾渴也沒有了。獨有祂與我一起，祂把我的每個空虛都充滿。我一個願望、一個渴望也沒有，惟獨想要祂。

肯定頓夫人

忽爾我感覺到有一隻手放在我的額上，不是軟弱而是全能的手，不是憤怒而是愛的手，但我不能知道這是外在的還是內裏的。它

my entire being and sending a holy, sin-consuming energy throughout me. As it moved downward, my heart as well as my head was aware of the presence of this soul-cleansing energy. Under its power I fell to the floor, and in the joyful wonder of the moment, I cried out in a loud voice. This hand of power continued to work without and within me, and wherever it moved, it seemed to leave the glorious influence of the Savior's image. And for several minutes, the deep ocean of God's love swallowed me, as all its waves and billows rolled over me.

Bishop Hamline

December 18

In all these things we are more than conquerors through him who loved us. (Romans 8:37)

The gospel and the gift of God are structured so wonderfully that the very enemies and forces that are marshaled to fight against us actually help pave our way to the very gates of heaven and into the presence of God.

When Dr. Moon, of Brighton, England, was suddenly struck with blindness, he said, "Lord, I accept this 'talent' of blindness from You. Help me to use it for Your glory so that when You return, you may receive it 'back with interest' [Matt. 25:27]." Then God enabled him to invent the Moon Alphabet for the blind, through which thousands of blind people were enabled to read the Word of God and thereby come to the glorious saving knowledge of Christ.

selected

December 19

This will result in your being witnesses to them. (Luke 21:13)

Life is a steep climb, and it is always encouraging to have those ahead of us "call back" and cheerfully summon us to higher ground. We all climb together, so we should help one another. And as our view becomes better as we gain altitude, and as we discover things of importance, we should "call back" our encouragement to others.

December 20

I am not alone, for my Father is with me. (John 16:32)

似乎是按壓在我的整個人身上，送來一個神聖、消滅罪的能量貫徹全身。當它向下移時，我的心和我的頭是覺知有這潔除靈魂之能力的存在。在它的能力之下我倒在地上，在這欣喜的一刻中，我大聲喊叫出來。這能力之手繼續在我身外身內來工作，無論它到何處，似乎都要留下救主形像的榮耀印記。為期幾分鐘，神愛的極深洋海把我吞噬，它的所有浪濤漫過我全身。

含連主教

十二月十八日

「然而靠着愛我們的主，在這一切的事上，已經得勝有餘了。」(羅 8:37)

神的福音和恩賜是建構得那麼奇妙，以致排山倒海地來與我們作戰的仇敵和勢力卻成為我們引往天門和神所在之路的幫助。

當英國布列頓的滿恩博士突然瞎眼時，他說：「主啊，我接受這從祢而來的『才幹』。幫助我用這來榮耀祢，因此當祢再來時，祢收回它時是附有利息的(太25:27)。」之後神使他發明給盲人用的滿恩氏字母，使成千上萬的盲人能夠閱讀神的話語和得着對基督榮耀拯救的認識。

選

十二月十九日

「但這些事終必為你們的見證。」(路21:13)

生命是陟坡攀登，前頭之人的「向後呼叫」總鼓舞我們，且鼓起我們的勇氣樂意向高處行。我們既一起攀登，好應互相幫助。我們上得越高，觀景越壯麗。當我們發現重要事物時，好應向後呼叫來鼓勵後上之人。

十二月二十日

「其實我不是獨自一人，因為有父

The person who will ultimately soar like an eagle to the heights of the cloudless day and live in the sunshine of God must be content to live a relatively lonely life.

No one ever comes into the full realization of the best things of God in his spiritual life without learning to walk alone with Him. We see Abraham alone “in the land of Canaan, while Lot lived among the cities ... near Sodom” (Gen. 13:12). Moses, although educated in all the wisdom of Egypt, had to spend forty years alone with God in the desert. And Paul, who was filled with all the knowledge of the Greeks and who sat “at the feet of Gamaliel” (Acts 22:3 KJV), was required, after meeting Jesus, to go “immediately into Arabia” (Gal. 1:17) to learn of the desert life with God.

We must dare to be alone, in the way that Jacob had to be alone for the Angel of God to whisper in his ear, “Your name will no longer be Jacob, but Israel” (Gen. 32:28); in the way that Daniel had to be left alone to see heavenly visions; and in the way that John had to be banished to the Isle of Patmos to receive and record “the revelation of Jesus Christ, which God gave him” (Rev. 1:1).

He has “trodden the winepress alone” (Isa. 63:3) for us. Therefore, are we prepared for a time of “glorious isolation” rather than to fail Him?

December 21

I will give him ... the land he set his feet on, because he followed the Lord wholeheartedly. (Deuteronomy 1:36)

Every difficult task that comes across your path—every one that you would rather not do, that will take the most effort, cause the most pain, and be the greatest struggle—brings a blessing with it.

Every difficult stretch of road on which you see the Master’s footprints and along which He calls you to follow Him leads unquestionably to blessings.

J. R. Miller

December 22

A thick and dreadful darkness came over him. (Genesis 15:12)

Abraham “fell into a deep sleep” (v. 12). During his sleep, his soul was oppressed with “a thick and

與我同在。」(約16:32)

那些終能如鷹在無雲日子高飛，活在神的歡快中的人定必要樂於在一個相對孤單的生命中活。

人若未學會單獨與祂同行，便永不能在他的屬靈生命中全然明白神最佳美的事物。我們見到亞伯拉罕孤單地「住在迦南地，羅得住在平原的城邑……直到所多瑪」(創13:12)。摩西雖在埃及的一切智慧中受教育，卻四十年之久單獨與神在曠野中。而那個充滿一切希臘知識和「在迦瑪列門下」(徒22:3)的保羅遇上耶穌後，便「往亞拉伯去」(加1:17)學習與神一起的曠野生活。

我們須敢於按雅各的方法孤單，天使在他耳中低語：「你的名不要再叫雅各，要叫以色列」(創32:28)；學但以理般離群獨處來看見天上的異象；學約翰般被放逐到拔摩海島得聽和記錄「耶穌基督的啟示，就是神賜給祂的啟示」(啟1:1)。

祂已為我們「獨自踰酒醅」(賽63:3)，因此，我們準備好度「榮耀隔離」的時光還是要叫祂失望？

十二月二十一日

「我要將他所踏過的地賜給他……因為他專心跟從我。」(申1:36)

每一項你路上遇見的困難工作，就是你寧願，要花你最大精力，造成最大痛苦，要最大奮鬥的工作，其實也是帶來福分的工作。

每段你見到主人足跡難行的路程，也是祂呼召你來跟隨祂的路程，毫無疑問也會帶來祝福。

J.R.米勒

十二月二十二日

「忽然有驚人的大黑暗落在他身上。」(創15:12)

「亞伯蘭沉沉的睡了」。當他睡着時，他的魂受壓於驚人的大黑

dreadful darkness,” which seemed to smother him and felt like a nightmare in his heart.

And know that He who endured the “dreadful darkness” of Calvary and the feeling of having been forsaken on the cross is ready to accompany you “through the valley of the shadow of death” (Ps. 23:4) until you can see the sun shining on the other side.

May we realize that “we have this hope as an anchor for the soul, firm and secure” and that “it enters the inner sanctuary behind the curtain” (Heb. 6:19). And may we know that although it is unseen within His sanctuary, our anchor will be grounded and will never yield. It will hold firm until the day He returns, and then we too will follow it into the safe haven guaranteed to us in God’s unchangeable Word.

F. B. Meyer

Your unbelieving heart cries out, as Gideon once did, “If the Lord is with us, why has all this happened to us?” (Judg. 6:13). God has allowed the difficulty to come upon you, in order to bring you closer to Himself. It has come not to separate you from Jesus but to cause you to cling to Him more faithfully, more firmly, and more simply.

F. S. Webster

December 23

The journey is too much for you. (1 Kings 19:7)

What did God do with Elijah, His tired servant? He allowed him to sleep and then gave him something good to eat. Elijah had done tremendous work and in his excitement had run “ahead of Ahab[’s chariot] all the way to Jezreel” (1 Kings 18:46). But the run had been too much for him and had sapped his physical strength, ultimately causing him to become depressed. Just as others in this condition need sleep and want their ailments treated, Elijah’s physical requirements needed to be met. There are many wonderful people who end up where Elijah did—“under a juniper tree” (1 Kings 19:4 KJV)! “Get up and eat, for the journey is too much for you.”

Therefore may we never confuse physical weariness with spiritual weakness.

December 24

He went out to the field one evening to meditate. (Genesis 24:63)

暗中，似乎要使他透不過氣來，像是心中的噩夢似的。

要認識那位忍受加略山「驚人黑暗」和在十字架上被離棄之感覺的那位已準備好陪伴你「經過死蔭的幽谷」(詩23:4)，直至你能見到那一邊的普照陽光。

讓我們認識「我們有這指望如同靈魂的錨，又堅固又牢靠，且通入幔內的至聖所。」(來6:19)讓我們也認識在祂至聖所內雖看不見，但我們的錨必拋牢和永不誤事。它必會牢靠直至祂回來之日，我們之後便跟隨它進入那神不變的話語所向我們保證的安全港口。

邁爾

你不信的心像基甸有一次曾呼喊的說：「耶和華若與我們同在，我們何至遭遇這一切事呢？」(士6:13)神容許困難來到你處，為帶你與祂更親近。它的來到不是來使你與耶穌分離，而是使你更忠誠，更牢固和更單純地連於祂。

F.S.韋伯士打

十二月二十三日

「你當走的路甚遠。」(王上19:7)

神向祂的疲倦僕人以利亞作甚麼？祂容許他睡一覺，後給他好東西吃。以利亞作罷偉大工作，在興奮中跑在亞哈的馬車前頭一直到耶斯列(王上18:46)。這次跑步對他來說過多了，致使他力氣衰竭，至終他變得沮喪。以利亞如同其他人一樣需要睡眠和處理失調之處，他在這情況下身體得着所需滿足。有很多行大事的人最終來到以利亞所到之地，「一棵羅騰樹下」(王上19:4)。「起來吃吧，因為你當走的路甚遠。」

因此讓我們不要將身體的疲累和靈性的軟弱混為一談。

十二月二十四日

「天將晚，以撒出來在田間默想。」(創24:63)

Meditation is the Sunday of the mind. A Sunday is a time in which it will do no work but instead will simply be still, look heavenward, and spread itself before the Lord like Gideon's fleece, allowing itself to be soaked with the moisture of the dew of heaven, and plan nothing but simply lie on the green lap of nature and "rest a while" (Mark 6:31 KJV).

Time spent in this way is not lost time. A fisherman does not say he is losing time when he is mending his nets, nor does a gardener feel he has wasted his time by taking a few minutes to sharpen the blades on his mower. And people living in cities today would do well to follow the example of Isaac and as often as possible visit the fields of the countryside, away from the hustle and bustle of the city. After having grown weary from the heat and noise of the city, communion with nature is very refreshing and will bring a calming, healing influence. A walk through a field, a stroll by a seashore, or a hike across a meadow sprinkled with daisies will purge you of the impurities of life and will cause your heart to beat with new joy and hope.

December 25

"They will call him Immanuel" —which means, "God with us." (Matthew 1:23)

Prince of Peace. (Isaiah 9:6)

A minister falling asleep in his study on Christmas morning and then dreaming of a world into which Jesus had never come. And when he came back and sat down in his library, he realized that every book about our Savior had disappeared. A messenger asked him to visit a friend's poor dying mother. He opened his Bible to look for a familiar promise, but it ended with Malachi. There was no gospel and no promise of hope and salvation.

Two days later he stood beside her coffin and conducted her funeral service, but there was no message of comfort, no words of a glorious resurrection, and no thought of a mansion awaiting her in heaven. There was only "dust to dust, and ashes to ashes," and one long, eternal farewell. Finally he realized that Christ had not come, and burst into tears, weeping bitterly in his sorrowful dream.

Then suddenly he awoke with a start, and a great shout of joy and praise burst from his lips as he heard

默想是我們思想的星期日。這個時間是不用工作，只是靜止不動，往上仰望，在主面前像基甸的羊毛般攤放着，讓它泡滿天上的露水，只要單單臥在大自然的青草地上「歇一歇」（可6:31）。

這樣的使用時間不是浪費。漁夫不會說補網是浪費時間，園丁不會覺得花幾分鐘來磨利剪草機的刀葉是浪費時間。今時今日活在城市中的人若能學效以撒的榜樣盡量抽時間到田間，遠離城市的擠逼和喧鬧是好的。經過城市的熱哄而變得疲累時，親一親大自然是使人十分蘇醒，也會帶來寧靜和醫治效果的。在田間走動，在海濱流連，或是在滿佈雛菊的草原遠足會洗清生命的雜質，使你心跳動着新的喜樂和盼望。

十二月二十五日

「人要稱祂的名為以馬內利。（以馬內利翻出來，就是神與我們同在。）」（太1:23）

「和平的君。」（賽9:6）

有一傳道者在他聖誕節早晨的講台上睡着了，之後夢到耶穌未曾來過的世界。當他回家坐在藏書室，發現所有關於基督的書都失蹤。有傳訊人求他去探望一個朋友將亡的可憐母親。他打開聖經來找一個熟悉的應許，但這聖經在瑪拉基書便完結了，沒有福音書，沒有盼望和救恩的應許。

兩日後他站在棺木旁主持她的殯葬儀式，但當中沒有安慰的信息，沒有榮耀復活的說話，沒有天上等待她去的住處。只有「塵歸塵，土歸土」和一長長的永別。最後他知悉基督沒有來過，便號咷大哭，在他難過的夢中苦苦哭泣。

之後，他突然被鄰近教堂詩班的歌聲驚醒，便衝口而出高呼歡欣

his choir singing these words in his church nearby:

Let us be glad and rejoice today, because He has come. And let us remember the proclamation of the angel: "I bring you good news of great joy that will be for all the people. Today in the town of David a Savior has been born to you; he is Christ the Lord" (Luke 2:10-11).

December 26

Sit here while I go over there and pray. (Matthew 26:36)

In the Garden of Gethsemane, eight of the eleven remaining disciples were left behind to do nothing.

You and I have certainly had that experience and felt the same disappointment. Perhaps you have seen a great opportunity for Christian service arise, and some people are sent immediately to the work, while still others are being trained to go. Yet you are forced to do nothing but sit and wait. Or perhaps sickness and poverty has come your way, or you have had to endure some terrible disgrace. Whatever your situation, you have been kept from service, and now you feel angry and do not understand why you should be excluded from this part of the Christian life.

Remember, it is Christ himself who says to you, "Sit here." Your place in the garden has also been set apart. God has selected it especially for you, and it is not simply a place of waiting. There are some lives He brings into this world neither to do great work nor to bear great burdens. Their job is simply to be—they are the neuter verbs, or the flowers in the garden that have no active mission. They have won no major victories and have never been honored with the best seats at a banquet—they have simply escaped the sight of people like Peter, James, and John.

However, Jesus is delighted by the sight of them, for through their mere fragrance and beauty, they have brought Him joy.

selected

December 27

His neck was put in irons. (Psalm 105:18)

The irons of sorrow and loss, the burdens carried as a youth, and the soul's struggle against sin all contribute to developing an iron tenacity and strength of purpose, as well as endurance and fortitude.

和讚美：

讓我們今天就喜樂歡欣吧，因為祂已來到，也讓我們謹記天使的宣佈：「我報給你們大喜的訊息，是關乎萬民的。因今天在大衛的城裏，為你們生了救主，就是主基督。」（路2:10-11）

十二月二十六日

「你們坐在這裏，等我到那邊去禱告。」（太26:36）

在客西馬尼園中，十一個門徒中有八個留下無所事事。

你和我也肯定曾經歷過和感受過相同的失望。或者你見到一個大好服事基督的職事來到，有一些人立即被派去工作，而有人仍在接受訓練中，而你卻只是強逼坐下等待，一事也不能作。又或者疾病和窮困在你路上攔阻，又或者你必須忍受一些凌厲的恥辱。無論你在甚麼處境，你不能事奉，如今你感到憤怒，不明為何你被排拒於這基督徒生命的分兒外。

謹記是基督親自對你說「坐在這裏」的。你在園子的位置已被設置，這是神特特為你所揀選的，這不只是一個等待的地方。有一些祂帶進這世界的生命既不是作大事，也不是擔負大痛苦的，他們的工作就是簡單作他們的不及物動詞，或是作園中沒有積極行動的花兒。他們未曾贏取主要的勝利，未曾爭取到筵席上的首席，他們只是在值得注目之彼得、雅各和約翰以外的人。

但是，耶穌卻喜悅見到他們，因為他們藉着香氣和美麗將喜樂帶給祂。

選

十二月二十七日

「他被鐵鍊捆拘。」（詩105:18）

憂傷和損失的鐵鍊，少年時背負的重擔，和與罪搏鬥全都促成鐵的頑強和決心的力度，也促成忍耐力和剛毅。

God is looking for iron saints, and since there is no way to impart iron into His people's moral nature except by letting them suffer, He allows them to suffer.

Your time is not wasted, for God is simply putting you through His iron regimen. Your iron crown of suffering precedes your golden crown of glory, and iron is entering your soul to make it strong and brave.

F. B. Meyer

December 28

Rejoice in the Lord always. I will say it again: Rejoice! (Philippians 4:4)

And when He hears you sing, He will bend down with a smile on His kind face. As He cheerfully listens, He will say, "Sing on, dear child. I hear you and I am coming to deliver you. I will carry that load for you. So just lean hard on Me, and the road will get smoother by and by."

December 29

Come on ... ! We have seen that the land is very good. Aren't you going to do something? Don't hesitate to go there and take it over....God has put into your hands, a land that lacks nothing whatever. (Judges 18:9-10)

"Come on!" "The children of Joseph, Manasseh and Ephraim, took their inheritance" (Josh. 16:4 KJV). "The house of Jacob will possess its inheritance" (Obad. 17). "The upright shall have good things in possession" (Prov. 28:10 KJV).

Appropriating faith is taking a pencil and underlining every 'me,' 'my,' and 'mine' in the Bible."

Pick any word you want that He has spoken and say, "That word is my word." Put your finger on a promise and say, "It is mine." "My son, ... you are always with me, and everything I have is yours" (Luke 15:31).

December 30

So Peter was kept in prison, but the church was earnestly praying to God for him. (Acts 12:5)

So the church gave themselves to fervent and persistent prayer. And God sent an angel, who "struck Peter on the side and woke him up" (v.7). Then the angel led him past "the first and second guards and [they] came to the iron gate leading to the

神是尋找鐵的聖徒，沒有方法可以將鐵注入祂子民的屬靈品格中，除非讓他們受苦，是祂容許他們受苦的。

你的時間沒浪費，因神只是把你放進祂鐵的政權中。你受苦的鐵冠冕在你榮耀金冠冕之先，鐵進入你的靈魂來使你強壯和勇敢。

邁爾

十二月二十八日

「你們要靠主常常喜樂。我再說：你們要喜樂。」(腓4:4)

當祂聽到你的歌聲時，祂會以慈愛臉上的微笑來俯聽。當祂歡欣聆聽時，必會說：「親愛的孩子，繼續唱，我聽見你，我來拯救你。我必替你背負那重擔，因此只要緊緊靠着我，前路必會越來越平順。」

十二月二十九日

「起來.....我們已經窺探那地，見那地甚好。你們為何靜坐不動呢？要急速前往得那地為業，.....神已將那地交在你們手中。那地百物俱全，一無所缺。」(士18:9-10)

「起來！」「約瑟的兒子瑪拿西、以法蓮就得了他們的地業。」(書16:4)「雅各家必得原有的產業。」(俄17)「惟有完全人，必承受福分。」(箴28:10)

取用信就是用鉛筆間低聖經的每個「我」和「我的」。

選揀你想要而又是祂曾說過的字來說：「這個屬我。」指着一個應許說：「這個屬我。」「兒阿，你常和我同在，我一切所有的，都是你的。」(路15:31)

十二月三十日

「於是彼得被囚在監裏。教會卻為他切切的禱告神。」(徒12:5)

神便差派一個天使，「拍彼得的肋旁，拍醒了他」(徒12:7)。之後天使領他「過了第一層，第二層監牢，就來到臨街的鐵門。那門自己開了。」(徒12:10)你有一

city. It opened for them by itself” (v. 10). There is a secret for you to learn—the secret of believing prayer. Then when you come to the iron gate, it will open.

How much wasted energy and painful disappointment will be saved once you learn to pray as the early church did in the “upper room” (Acts 1:13 KJV)!

C. H. P.

Emergencies call for intense prayer. When the person himself becomes the prayer nothing can resist its touch, and was aligned with Him against the powers of evil. This kind of prayer is greatly needed today.

from The Bent-knee Time

“Groans that words cannot express” (Rom. 8:26) are often prayers that God cannot refuse.

Charles H. Spurgeon

December 31

Thus far has the Lord helped us. (1 Samuel 7:12)

“Be strong and take heart” (Ps. 27:14), and with thanksgiving and confidence lift your voice in praise, for: The Lord who “thus far” has helped you Will help you all your journey through.

Charles H. Spurgeon

Let us also call out to one another through the darkness until the night becomes alive with the sound of many voices, encouraging God’s weary travelers. And may the echoes grow into a storm of hallelujahs that will break in thundering waves around His sapphire throne. Then as the morning dawns, we will find ourselves on the shore of the “sea of glass” (Rev. 4:6), crying out with the redeemed hosts of heaven, “To him who sits on the throne and to the Lamb be praise and honor and glory and power, for ever and ever!” (Rev. 5:13).

AND AGAIN THEY SHOUTED: “HALLELUJAH!”
Revelation 19:3

要學的秘訣——信靠禱告的訣要，那麼，當你來到鐵門時，它會「自己開了」。

你一旦學會了初期教會在「樓房」上的禱告（徒1:13），便省卻多少浪費的精力和痛苦的失望！

C.H.P.

危急事故需求迫切的禱告。當當事人成為禱告者時，便沒有東西能阻止其與神接觸，與神站在同一對抗邪惡勢力的陣線上，這也是今時今日極之需要的祈禱。

摘自《屈膝時刻》

「說不出來的歎息」(羅8:26) 常是神不能拒絕的祈禱。

司布真

十二月三十一日

「到如今耶和華都幫助我們。」(撒 上7:12)

「當壯膽，堅固祢的心。」(詩 27:14) 用感恩和信心來高聲讚美，因為那位「到如今」的主曾幫助你，必會一路上幫助你。

司布真

讓我們在黑暗中彼此叫喚名字，直至多人的聲音使這夜回復生機，鼓勵着疲乏的神之旅者。讓這唱和演變成阿利路亞的爆發，發出雷聲般的聲浪來環繞着祂藍寶石的寶座。之後到朝早黎明時，我們必發現我們來到「玻璃海」(啟4:6)的岸邊，與天上被救贖的群眾一起高呼：「但願頌讚、尊貴、榮耀、權勢，都歸給坐寶座的和羔羊，直到永永遠遠。」(啟5:13)

他們再次高呼：「阿利路亞。」
(啟19:3)

Streams in the Desert 2

荒漠甘泉下

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非拉鐵非書簡 (Books of Philadelphia) 14B 《荒漠甘泉》下

因方便印刷，本書分為上下二冊。

信主初期，教會兄姊都鼓勵以本書作為靈修輔助讀物。這確實是不可多得的屬靈寶藏，作者閱讀眾多屬靈書籍，將感動她的結集成書。

信主多年，才懂得某些真理，才感受到作者靈命之深。坊間已有本書的不同譯本，惟望神也用上本書，叫讀者們一同沾上前人的信心。

「人因為先知的名接待先知，必得先知所得的賞賜；人因為義人的名接待義人，必得義人所得的賞賜。」(太10:41) 這給我們讀屬靈書籍的亮光。屬靈人得神的話，便是先知。聽他們的話就是聽神的話，世上肯聽先知的少之又少。聽後要「接待」，留在生命中。讓神的話發光發力，認罪除黑暗，得力奔天路，與先知同等賞賜，這是「上算」。以屬靈人為義人，一同走義路，得本於信以至於信，豐盛生命的賞賜。

在這荒漠中真需要神供給的甘泉，若神許可，還有別的靈修輔助讀物會跟大家分享。

本書簡網頁：<https://chowwoonkuen.github.io/philadelphia.github.io>